MEAL PREP SYSTEM

# The Sunday Sheet

## Meal prep in about 2 hours, with the protein counted

60 recipes, 48 plates, 4 weeks planned



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START HERE

# Start Here

How This Book Works

> **"way easier than trying to find random recipes online"**
>
> — reader review

That line comes from someone who bought a different meal prep book. It names the problem this one is built for. You don't need more recipes. You need to know what to cook on Sunday, in what order, how much of it, and how long it keeps.

So this is a system first and a recipe book second.

## What's inside

**Part 1 · The System** (Chapters 1-7). How a plate is built, how to read your Sunday Sheet, portions, storage, cost, protein, pantry. About 20 pages. You read it once.

**Part 2 · The 4-Week Plan** (Chapters 8-11). Each week is one Sunday Sheet, one shopping list sorted by store aisle (for 1 or 2 people) and five plates.

**Part 3 · Recipes** (Chapters 12-19). 60 recipes, written as parts you combine: 10 proteins, 6 bases, 6 vegetables, 12 sauces, plus 8 breakfasts, 10 one-pot freezer meals and 8 snacks. Then 48 signature plates and the Mix & Match chart.

**Part 4 · Reference** (Chapters 20-23). Storage chart, macro-cost-allergen index, fixes for things that go wrong, blank templates.

Every recipe card shows the same facts in the same spot: yield in grams and boxes, calories and protein per portion, allergens, days in the fridge and freezer, how to reheat, and what it goes with.

## Pick your path

**Path A · Follow Week 1**
For you if you want zero decisions this time.
Read Chapter 2 (the sheet) and Chapter 4 (storage). That's about 15 minutes. Then go to Chapter 8, shop from the list and cook from the sheet.
You end Sunday with 10 boxes and 5 breakfasts. That's lunch and dinner Monday to Friday for one person, or lunch for two.

**Path B · Build your own plates**
For you if you've prepped before and know what you like.
Read Chapters 1, 3 and 6. Then go to the sauces (Chapter 15) and the Mix & Match chart (Chapter 16). Plan your week on the blank sheet in Chapter 23.

**Path C · Freezer only**
For you if you can't give up a Sunday right now, or you get tired of the same box by day three.
Read Chapter 4. Then go to the Freezer Block (Chapter 18): 10 one-pot meals you cook on any free evening, portion and freeze. You build a stock and take out one box at a time.

Not sure? Take Path A. Week 1 uses the parts the rest of the book builds on.

## What "about 2 hours" means

The plan weeks are designed around a Sunday cooking session of about 2 hours for one person's week. That's a design target. It is not a promise.

Your first Sunday will probably run longer. You're reading as you go. Your oven may run cooler than the dial says. Shopping isn't counted, and neither is the last round of dishes.

Time your first Sunday and write the real number on your sheet. Your number is the one that matters. Write it down each week and see how it moves once the steps stop being new.



Everything you fill in or stick on the fridge is also in the printable pack (US Letter, black-and-white friendly).

## Before you cook: three notes

**1. This is not medical or nutrition advice.** Each recipe shows calories and protein per portion, calculated from USDA data (Chapter 6). The book does not tell you how much to eat. If you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or follow a diet set by a professional, talk to a registered dietitian or your doctor before you change how you eat.

**2. Allergens.** Each recipe lists which of the 9 major food allergens recognized in the US it contains: milk, eggs, fish, crustacean shellfish, tree nuts, peanuts, wheat, soybeans and sesame. Brands differ. Soy sauce usually contains wheat. Many tortillas and some gochujang do too. Products can also be made on shared lines. Read the label of the package you actually buy. This book can't see it.

**3. Food safety.** Storage times and cooking temperatures follow USDA Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS) guidance. Chapter 4 has the rules and the sources. Use a thermometer. If something smells off or you're unsure how old it is, follow the FSIS rule: when in doubt, throw it out.

### YOUR FIRST ACTION

Fill this in before you turn the page.

| | |
|---|---|
| **My path** | A · B · C |
| **My Sunday cooking window** | from _____ to _____ |
| **I cook for** | 1 person · 2 people |
| **Allergens or foods we avoid at home** | |
| **Day I'll shop** | |

*Sources: USDA FSIS, "Leftovers and Food Safety" and "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov). US FDA, "Food Allergies: What You Need to Know" (fda.gov), which lists the 9 major food allergens, sesame included since January 1, 2023.*

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PART 1

# The System


1 · Why Meal Prep Gets Old by Wednesday

2 · Your Sunday, One Sheet: How to Read It

3 · Portions That Add Up

4 · Will It Last Until Thursday? Storage, Freezing, Reheating

5 · What a Plate Really Costs

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CHAPTER 1

# Why Meal Prep Gets Old by Wednesday

> **"...the same ingredients precooked and rearranged in slightly different ways got really old really fast."**
>
> — reader review

Meal prep often doesn't fail at the stove. It fails on Wednesday, with you standing at the fridge, looking at box three of the same chicken and rice.

Here's what usually happens. You cook one protein with one seasoning. You make one carb. You steam one vegetable. You split it all into five boxes. Monday is fine. Tuesday is fine. By Wednesday your mouth knows exactly what's coming, and you order a burrito instead. Thursday's box goes in the trash on Saturday.

Moving the same food around the plate doesn't fix it. If the chicken tastes like lemon and garlic on Monday, it tastes like lemon and garlic on Thursday, whether it sits on rice or in a wrap.

What changes a meal the most is the flavor you add at the end: the sauce, the acid, the spice. So this book cooks the big parts plain-ish and puts the flavor in the sauces.

## The plate formula

Every lunch and dinner in this book is built the same way:

**1 PROTEIN + 1 BASE + 1 VEGETABLE + 1 SAUCE**

| Slot | What it does | Examples in this book | How it's cooked |
|---|---|---|---|
| Protein | Fills you up and carries most of the protein | Lemon-garlic chicken thighs, turkey taco crumble, baked salmon, crispy tofu | Seasoned lightly so it fits several sauces |
| Base | Energy and bulk | Oven rice, quinoa, roasted sweet potato, pasta, tortillas | Cooked to reheat well (Chapter 13) |
| Vegetable | Color, crunch, fiber | Charred broccoli, fajita peppers, slaw, cucumber-tomato salad | Roasted, or raw and added on the day |
| Sauce | Decides what the plate tastes like | Chipotle-lime yogurt, lighter teriyaki, lemon-tahini | Made cold in 5 minutes, stored apart |

The protein, base and vegetable are your batch. The sauce is your steering wheel.

## The four flavor families

The 12 sauces are grouped into four flavor families, three sauces each. Each family has proteins, bases and vegetables that fit it.

| Family | Code | Tastes like | Sauces | Fits well with |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mexican-inspired | **MEX** | Lime, chipotle, cumin, cilantro | Chipotle-Lime Yogurt · Tomatillo Salsa Verde · Quick Red Enchilada Sauce | Rice, tortillas, sweet potato, fajita peppers |
| Asian-inspired | **ASI** | Soy, ginger, sesame, chili | Lighter Teriyaki · Peanut-Ginger · Gochujang-Honey | Rice, quinoa, pasta, broccoli, slaw, green beans |
| Mediterranean | **MED** | Lemon, garlic, herbs, yogurt | Tzatziki · Lemon-Tahini · Chimichurri | Quinoa, rice, potatoes, cucumber-tomato salad |
| American comfort | **COM** | Smoky, sweet-tangy, creamy | Smoky BBQ · Honey-Mustard Yogurt · Creamy Tomato-Garlic | Potatoes, sweet potato, pasta, green beans |

Some proteins fit every family. The lemon-garlic chicken thighs, the baked chicken breast and the salmon are seasoned so any sauce works on them. Others fit two or three families. The turkey taco crumble is MEX only. Each recipe card tells you which.

## One tray, three different plates

This is how Week 1 uses one tray of lemon-garlic chicken thighs with three sauces:

| Day | Protein | Base | Vegetable | Sauce | Family |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Plate 1 | Lemon-garlic chicken | Oven rice | Fajita peppers | Chipotle-lime yogurt | MEX |
| Plate 2 | Lemon-garlic chicken | Oven rice | Charred broccoli | Lighter teriyaki | ASI |
| Plate 3 | Lemon-garlic chicken | Roasted sweet potato | Charred broccoli | Lemon-tahini | MED |

Same chicken. Same Sunday. Three meals that don't taste alike. Add a second protein (the turkey crumble) and Week 1 gets to five different plates from two proteins, two bases, two vegetables and three sauces.

That's the whole trick. You cook a small number of parts and change the combination.

## Two rules that keep the week interesting

**Rule 1: no sauce two days in a row.** If Monday is chipotle-lime, Tuesday is something else. This one rule does most of the work.

**Rule 2: something crunchy at least twice a week.** Roasted food softens in the fridge. A raw slaw or a cucumber-tomato salad added on the day gives the box a different texture. Chapter 4 shows how to store those parts apart.

## What "48 plates" and "Mix & Match" mean

Chapter 16 has 48 signature plates: combinations worked out in full, with calories, protein, allergens and cost for the assembled plate. Twelve per flavor family.

It also has a Mix & Match chart. It shows which parts go together by flavor family; 1,815 combinations follow the rules above. Those combinations were not each cooked one by one. They're a map of what should go together, built from the rules. You'll use it once you're ready to plan your own weeks (Week 4 walks you through it).

YOUR ACTION

### The 5-box test

Plan any five boxes, on paper, before you cook anything. Use the parts from the tables above or the ones you already like to cook.

| Box | Protein | Base | Vegetable | Sauce | Family |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |

Now check it:

- [ ] No sauce appears two days in a row.
- [ ] At least two boxes have something raw or crunchy.
- [ ] You use no more than 2 proteins, 2 bases and 2 vegetables in total. (More than that and Sunday gets long.)
- [ ] At least two different flavor families.

If a box fails a check, change the sauce first. It's the cheapest fix and it changes the most.

CHAPTER 2

# Your Sunday, One Sheet: How to Read It

> **"...this was more frustration than I wanted to put into a day off."**
>
> — reader review

Sunday is your day off. If meal prep eats all of it, you'll stop doing it.

Most lost Sundays look alike. You read recipe one and start it. Then you read recipe two and find out it needed the oven at a different temperature. The oven sits empty while you chop. Three things finish at the same minute, or one thing finishes 40 minutes after everything else. You don't know how much goes in each box, so the last box is half empty.

None of that is about cooking skill. It's about order.

The Sunday Sheet fixes the order. It takes every recipe for the week and merges them into one timeline on one page. You read the sheet, not the recipes.

## What's on the sheet, top to bottom

**1. The header.** Week number. Cooking for 1 or 2. Number of boxes. Oven temperature. Estimated time, which is about 2 hours for one person's week. Plus an empty box where you write your real time.

**2. Before minute 0.** About 10 minutes of setup. Clear the counter. Empty the dishwasher or the drying rack. Line the sheet pans. Take out the scale, the thermometer and every container you'll fill. Set the containers on the table with their lids off.

**3. The timeline.** Four blocks, always in the same order:

| Order | Block | Why it goes here |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **OVEN** | It takes longest and needs you least. Start it first and it works while you do the rest. |
| 2 | **STOVE** | It needs you at the pan, in short bursts. It fits in while the oven runs. |
| 3 | **COLD** | Sauces, slaw, cutting raw vegetables. No heat. Fills the gaps while hot food cooks and cools. |
| 4 | **ASSEMBLY** | Weighing into boxes, labeling, into the fridge or freezer. Last, when everything is done. |

The blocks overlap. The oven block starts first, but the stove and cold work happen while it's still running. The sheet marks those tasks with ⏱ **while the oven runs.**

**4. The assembly table.** How many grams of each part go in each box, for 1 or 2 people. Which boxes go to the fridge. Which go to the freezer (the day-5 rule, Chapter 4).

## How to read one row

Each line of the timeline has five columns:

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | OVEN | Heat oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Line 2 sheet pans with parchment. | *Oven signals it's hot* | — |
| 0:05 | PREP ⏱ | Cut sweet potatoes into ¾-inch (2 cm) cubes. | *Cubes about the same size* | see list |
| 0:15 | OVEN | Chicken and sweet potatoes in, on separate pans. Set a timer for each pan. | — | — |
| 0:20 | STOVE ⏱ | Brown the ground turkey in a large skillet, breaking it up. | *No pink left. 165 °F / 74 °C* | see list |
| 0:35 | COLD ⏱ | Stir the chipotle-lime yogurt sauce. Spoon into small cups. | *Smooth, no lumps* | 50 g per cup |
| … | ASSEMBLY | Weigh each part into the boxes. Sauce stays in its cup. | *Every box closed and labeled* | see assembly table |

*These rows show the layout. The real minutes and amounts for each week are in Chapters 8 to 11.*

**Clock** is minutes from when you start, not time of day. If you start at 10:00, 0:35 means 10:35.

**Done when** is the most important column. Ovens differ, pans differ, cuts of meat differ. A timer tells you when to look. The done signal tells you when to stop. For meat, the signal is a temperature, read with a thermometer in the thickest part.

## Safe internal temperatures

These are the USDA FSIS minimums. They're printed on every sheet where meat or fish cooks.

| Food | Safe minimum |
|---|---|
| Chicken and turkey: whole pieces **and ground** | 165 °F / 74 °C |
| Ground beef and ground pork | 160 °F / 71 °C |
| Pork chops, roasts, shoulder | 145 °F / 63 °C, then rest 3 minutes |
| Fish, including salmon | 145 °F / 63 °C, or flesh flakes easily and is opaque |
| Egg dishes (egg bites, casseroles) | 160 °F / 71 °C |

Ground turkey trips people up. It's poultry, so it's 165 °F, not 160 °F.

Pulled pork is different again. It's safe at 145 °F, but it only pulls apart when you cook it much longer, so its recipe gives a higher target for texture.

## Five habits that save time

1. **Read the whole sheet the night before.** It takes 5 minutes. You'll spot what needs thawing or what you forgot to buy.

2. **One timer per pan, with a name.** Phone timers can be labeled: "chicken", "rice". Three unlabeled beeps in a row is how food burns.
3. **Tick each row as you finish it.** Use a pencil. If you get interrupted, you know where you were.
4. **Wash as you wait.** Each ⏱ gap longer than 5 minutes with nothing listed is a good time for the cutting board and bowls.
5. **Don't start a new block early because you're bored.** The order is there so the oven and the fridge aren't fighting each other.

## About "about 2 hours"

The plan weeks are built to fit a cooking session of about 2 hours for one person. That's a target, not a stopwatch result you're guaranteed to hit. Your first Sunday will likely take longer. Cooking for two adds mostly cutting and portioning time.

The oven time stays close to the same, as long as the food still fits in a single layer on the pans. If pieces overlap, they steam instead of browning. Use another pan.

YOUR ACTION

### The dry run

The night before your first Sunday:

- [ ] Read the sheet from top to bottom once.
- [ ] Check you own every pan on the setup list (Chapter 7).
- [ ] Count your containers. You need one per box, plus the sauce cups.
- [ ] Check the fridge has room for 10 boxes. Make room now, not with hot food in your hands.
- [ ] Write your start time here: _____

When you finish on Sunday:

| | |
|---|---|
| Real finish time | |
| Total minutes | |
| The step that took longest | |
| One thing to change next week | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

*Source: USDA FSIS, "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov).*

CHAPTER 3

# Portions That Add Up

> **"recipe portions are inconsistent. Sometimes we got a scant 4 servings, sometimes 6, sometimes more."**
>
> — reader review

"Serves 4" is a guess. It depends on whose plate, how hungry, and how big the potatoes were. When you cook for a week, a wrong guess shows up on Thursday as one box with half the chicken.

This book doesn't use "serves". It uses grams and boxes.

## What every recipe tells you

Each recipe card starts with one line like this:

**Makes:** 5 portions · about 700 g cooked in total · about 140 g per portion

That line answers two questions before you start: how much food comes out, and how many boxes it fills.

The calories and protein on the card are for one of those portions. That means one fifth of the batch if it makes 5, one tenth if it makes 10.

## The batch-divide method

Cooked weight is never exact. Chicken loses water in the oven. Rice soaks it up. Ten minutes more or less changes the number.

So don't trust the raw weight to tell you the box weight. Weigh what came out.

1. Put a bowl on your kitchen scale and press **tare** so it reads 0.
2. Tip the whole cooked batch into the bowl. Write down the weight.
3. Divide by the number of boxes. That's your grams per box.

4. Put an empty box on the scale, tare, and fill it to that number. Repeat.

Example: the chicken comes out at 690 g and you need 5 boxes. 690 ÷ 5 = 138 g per box.

Every box ends up with the same share of the batch. And the calories and protein per portion on the card stay right, because each box really is one fifth.

Weighing 10 boxes takes a few minutes once the scale is out. It's the step most people skip and the one that stops the half-empty Thursday box.

## The reference portion

When you build your own plates (Path B), start from this box. It's the size used across the 48 signature plates. You can scale it up or down, but change one slot at a time.

| Slot | Per box (cooked) | Roughly from (raw or dry) | Kitchen picture |
|---|---|---|---|
| Protein | 130-140 g (about 4½-5 oz) | 180 g raw boneless meat | A deck of cards, a bit thicker |
| Base | 150-170 g cooked rice, quinoa or pasta | 60 g dry rice or quinoa, 70 g dry pasta | About 1 cup cooked |
| Base, potato | 170-200 g roasted | about 200 g raw | A fist and a half |
| Vegetable | 100 g roasted, or 80-100 g raw | 120-140 g raw before roasting | A packed cup |
| Sauce | 40-50 g | — | About 3 tablespoons |

The raw column is a rough guide for shopping. The cooked column is what you weigh. If they disagree, the scale wins.

## ×1 or ×2: how many boxes

Every shopping list and every Sunday Sheet has two columns.

| Column | Boxes | Covers | Breakfasts |
|---|---|---|---|
| **×1** | 10 | One person: lunch + dinner, Monday to Friday. Or two people: lunch only. | 5 |
| **×2** | 20 | Two people: lunch + dinner, Monday to Friday. | 10 |

The amounts in the ×2 column are worked out for you. Two things don't double:

- **Cooking time.** A pan with twice the food doesn't need twice the minutes. It needs the same done signal. Use more pans, not more time.
- **Pan space.** Food has to sit in one layer to roast. If it doesn't fit, use a third pan or cook a second round. The ×2 sheets note where that happens.

## How the boxes split across the week

With the ×1 column, 10 boxes come out on Sunday. They don't all go in the fridge.

| | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boxes | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 |
| Stored in | fridge | fridge | fridge | fridge | **freezer** |

The two Friday boxes go to the freezer on Sunday. Chapter 4 explains why, and when to move them back.

YOUR ACTION

## The portion plan

Fill this before you shop. It tells you how many containers you need and catches mistakes before they cost money.

| | |
|---|---|
| People | |
| Lunches per person | |
| Dinners per person | |
| Boxes this week | |
| Of those, fridge (Mon-Thu) | |
| Of those, freezer (Fri) | |
| Sauce cups | |
| Breakfasts | |

On Sunday, use this for each batch:

| Part | Cooked batch weight (g) | ÷ boxes | = grams per box |
|---|---|---|---|
| Protein 1 | | | |
| Protein 2 | | | |
| Base 1 | | | |
| Base 2 | | | |
| Vegetable 1 | | | |
| Vegetable 2 | | | |

CHAPTER 4

# Will It Last Until Thursday? Storage, Freezing, Reheating

> **"...the taste of the food we cooked ended up being so bad that we ended up throwing away food every single week..."**
>
> — reader review

Two things send prepped food to the trash. You're not sure it's still safe. Or it's safe but tastes tired. This chapter handles both.

Among the top threads of the year in a large meal prep forum was one titled: "is it fine to store my food like this for four-five days?" Four is fine. Five is where the answer changes.

## The day-5 rule

USDA FSIS says cooked leftovers keep **3 to 4 days** in the fridge, at 40 °F (4 °C) or colder.

Count from Sunday:

| Sun | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| cook (day 0) | day 1 | day 2 | day 3 | day 4 | **day 5** |

Thursday is day 4. Friday is day 5, outside the window.

So the rule in this book is:

**ANYTHING YOU'LL EAT ON DAY 5 GOES IN THE FREEZER ON SUNDAY.**

Then on **Thursday morning**, move Friday's boxes from the freezer to the fridge. They thaw during the day and they're ready for Friday. Every Sunday Sheet ends with this step, and the printable fridge card has a Thursday reminder.

Two more rules:

- **Salmon is eaten on day 1 or 2.** It's safe for the same 3-4 days, but cooked fish dries out and smells stronger as days pass. The plan puts it at the start of the week.

- **Freeze on Sunday, not on Wednesday.** Freezing doesn't reset the clock. A box that has already spent three days in the fridge comes out of the freezer as a day-3 box.

## Cool it fast

Bacteria grow fastest between 40 °F and 140 °F (4-60 °C). FSIS calls it the Danger Zone. The rule is to get cooked food into the fridge **within 2 hours** of cooking. If the room is above 90 °F (32 °C), within 1 hour.

You don't have to wait for food to cool before it goes in the fridge. FSIS says hot food can go straight in. What matters is that it cools quickly, and that means shallow.

- **Spread it out.** A deep pot of chili cools slowly in the middle. Split it into shallow containers, about 2 inches (5 cm) deep or less.
- **Leave space.** Don't stack ten hot boxes in a tight block. Leave gaps so cold air moves.
- **Lids on loosely for the first 20-30 minutes**, then close them.

### Rice needs extra care

Rice can carry spores of a bacterium called *Bacillus cereus*. Cooking doesn't kill the spores. If cooked rice sits warm on the counter for hours, they can grow and make a toxin that reheating won't destroy.

So, as soon as the rice is done:

1. Spread it in a thin layer on a sheet pan or in wide, shallow containers.
2. Let the steam escape for about 10 minutes.
3. Into the fridge. **All of it within 2 hours of coming off the heat.**

The same goes for quinoa and pasta. Cooling rice fast also keeps the grains apart, so it reheats better.

## Freezer basics

- Set the freezer at **0 °F (-18 °C)**. At that temperature, food stays safe for as long as it stays frozen.
- **Quality** is a different clock. Most cooked dishes taste best if eaten within **2-3 months** (soups, stews, casseroles) and cooked meat within about **2-6**

**months**. Each recipe card gives its own number. Write the date on every box.

- **Thaw in the fridge.** A single box needs about a day. Never thaw on the counter.
- If you forget: thaw in the microwave on defrost, then reheat and eat right away.

## Reheat to 165 °F

FSIS says leftovers should be reheated to **165 °F (74 °C)**. Microwaves heat unevenly, so:

- Cover the box loosely (a lid set on top, not snapped shut).
- Heat, stir or turn the food, heat again.
- Check the thickest piece. Steaming all the way through is the visual sign. A thermometer is the sure one.

## Keep the taste: store parts apart

Food tastes tired by Thursday for reasons you can control.

| Part | What goes wrong | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| Sauces and dressings | They soak into rice and pasta, which turn soggy | Separate small cup. Add after reheating. |
| Yogurt sauces (tzatziki, chipotle-lime) | They split and turn grainy if heated | Never heat. Add cold, on top of the hot food. |
| Raw crunch (slaw, cucumber-tomato salad) | Goes limp, gets watery | Slaw: own container, keeps its crunch a few days. Cucumber-tomato: cut on the day, 3 minutes. |
| Pasta | Turns mushy | Cook 2 minutes short of the package time, toss with a little oil. |
| Roasted potatoes | Go soft in the microwave | Reheat in an air fryer or oven, 5-8 minutes. |
| Rice | Dries out and goes hard | Sprinkle 1 tablespoon of water on top, cover, then heat. |
| Chicken | Dries out | 1 tablespoon of water or sauce, cover, medium power. |

**The two-zone box.** Many boxes have a hot side and a cold side. Take the sauce cup and any raw parts out. Heat the rest. Put the cold parts back on top. It takes 20 seconds and it's the difference between a Thursday lunch and a sad one.

**Wake it up.** Flavors fade in the fridge. A squeeze of lime or lemon, a pinch of salt or a few fresh herbs right before you eat bring them back. The recipe cards suggest one for each plate.

To print: the fridge cards (day-5 rule, reheating by part) are pages 20-21 of the printable pack.

YOUR ACTION

## The fridge map

Sunday night, before you close the fridge:

- [ ] Fridge thermometer reads 40 °F (4 °C) or lower: _____ °F
- [ ] Freezer reads 0 °F (-18 °C) or lower: _____ °F
- [ ] Every box has an "eat by" label (Mon-Thu) and the cook date.
- [ ] Friday's boxes are in the freezer.
- [ ] Salmon boxes are labeled Mon or Tue.
- [ ] Sauce cups are in the fridge door or next to their boxes.
- [ ] Phone reminder set for **Thursday morning: move Friday's boxes to the fridge.**

**This week: eaten or thrown out?**

| Day | Eaten | Thrown out | Reason, if thrown out |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | |
| Tue | | | |
| Wed | | | |
| Thu | | | |
| Fri | | | |

At the end of the week, count what you threw away and why. If the same part keeps coming back, check its row in the table above.

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*Sources: USDA FSIS (fsis.usda.gov), "Leftovers and Food Safety", "Refrigeration and Food Safety", "Freezing and Food Safety", "The Big Thaw: Safe Defrosting Methods" and "Danger Zone (40 °F-140 °F)". US FDA, Bad Bug Book, 2nd ed., chapter on* Bacillus cereus *(fda.gov).*

CHAPTER 5

# What a Plate Really Costs

> **"This book calls for 4-5 lbs of meat minimum, each week."**
>
> — reader review

Meat is the biggest line on almost any meal prep receipt. A plan that quietly asks for 4 or 5 pounds of it every week gets expensive fast, and you only notice at the register.

This chapter gives you a way to know the cost before you shop. It also tells you how much meat each week of the plan uses, so nothing is hidden.

## Prices change. Read our numbers that way.

Food prices move every week. They differ by store, by city and by brand. Any price printed in a book is old by the time you read it.

So every cost in this book comes with a **store type, a region and a date**. Treat it as a reference point, not a quote. Your receipt is the real number. The method below lets you work out your own in a few minutes.

The table below uses the recipes of each weekly sheet. "One batch" is the full shopping for that week as written in the recipes; "double batch" is the same plan cooked twice. A plate is one protein + one base + one vegetable + one sauce, one portion each.

| Week | Plates (avg. per plate) | One batch | Double batch (x2) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | $3.65 | $43.70 | $87.45 |
| 2 | $3.65 | $47.15 | $94.30 |
| 3 | $4.85 | $71.35 | $142.70 |
| 4 | $3.25 | $39.65 | $79.25 |

Across all 48 signature plates the average is about **$3.75 per plate** (cheapest $1.80, priciest $6.65).

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ. Pantry items, spices and sauces without a USDA figure are our own reference estimates (about 36% of the total comes from USDA data). Rounded to the nearest 5 cents; no yield loss from trimming is applied.*

## The method: cost per portion

**Cost per portion = price you paid for the package ÷ number of portions you get from it**

That's it for anything you use up in one week: meat, a bag of broccoli, a tub of yogurt.

For things you use a little of at a time (oil, spices, soy sauce), work out the share:

**Cost of what you used = package price ÷ package size × amount used**

Example with made-up numbers, only to show the math:

| Item | Package price | Gives | Cost per portion |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pack of chicken thighs | $10.00 | 5 portions | $10.00 ÷ 5 = **$2.00** |
| Bag of rice, 2 lb (907 g) | $3.00 | about 15 portions of 60 g | $3.00 ÷ 15 = **$0.20** |
| Olive oil: 7 g from a 500 g bottle | $8.00 | — | $8.00 ÷ 500 × 7 = **$0.11** |

*These are not real prices. They're round numbers so the steps are easy to follow.*

Add up the parts of one plate and you have the plate's cost. Add up the shopping list, plus the share of pantry items used, and you have the week.

## Read the shelf tag, not the sticker

US grocery shelf tags usually show a **unit price** next to the price: per pound, per ounce, per count. It's smaller print, often on the left. That's the number to compare.

The big pack isn't always cheaper per pound. The store brand often is. Compare unit prices, not package prices.

## How much meat the plan uses

Raw meat and fish per week, from each week's shopping list:

| Week | Main proteins | Raw meat or fish, ×1 |
|---|---|---|
| 1 · Starter | Chicken thighs, ground turkey | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |
| 2 · Slow-cooker | Beef stretched with lentils, slow-cooker chicken | about 3.2 lb (1.45 kg) |
| 3 · Freezer-ahead | Turkey meatballs ×2, salmon | 6 lb (2.7 kg), of which 2 lb of turkey becomes a 4-portion freezer reserve |
| 4 · Mix-it-yourself | Tofu, pulled pork | about 3.5 lb (1.6 kg), plus 2 lb tofu |

Week 1 keeps things familiar for your first Sunday. Week 3 is the biggest shop because a third of it goes to the freezer for later. If that's too much for your budget, start with Week 4 instead: at average US prices it's the cheapest of the four. It uses the same sheet layout.

## Five ways the plan keeps cost down

1. **Stretch ground meat with lentils.** The Beef & Lentil Power Mince replaces part of the beef with cooked lentils. You get more portions per pound of beef, plus fiber, and the sauce carries the flavor.
2. **Thighs before breasts.** Boneless thighs are often cheaper per pound and stay juicier when reheated. Check the unit price at your store.
3. **Use whole packages.** The recipes aim to use standard package sizes, and each shopping list notes leftovers you can use the next week. A half-used pack of meat at the back of the fridge is money in the trash.
4. **Frozen vegetables are fine.** Frozen broccoli or green beans cost the same in January as in June and never wilt in the drawer. They roast well if you spread them out and give them a few extra minutes.
5. **Buy the pantry once.** Spices and sauces are a big cost the first week and almost nothing after. Chapter 7 lists what to keep, so the weekly list stays short.

What the plan skips: precut vegetables. They save time, and they often cost noticeably more per pound. Cutting is built into the Sunday Sheet, during oven time.

YOUR ACTION

### The cost sheet

Keep your receipt from your first shop. Fill this in on Sunday night. It takes about 10 minutes.

Store: _____ Date: ____ / ____ / ____

| Item | Package price | Package size | Used this week | Portions it gave | Cost per portion |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Pantry share (oil, spices, sauces) | | | | | |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Total for the week** | $ |
| **÷ number of boxes** | |
| **= Cost per box** | $ |

Next week, change one thing (store brand, thighs, lentils) and compare.

CHAPTER 6

# Protein You Can Count

> **"The recipes don't feel overly 'healthy' in a bad way. they just taste like normal food"**
>
> — reader review

High-protein food has a reputation: dry chicken, plain rice, no sauce, eaten because you have to. That's not the food in this book. These are normal plates, the kind you'd order, with the numbers worked out so you don't have to guess.

This chapter shows where those numbers come from, how to read them, and how to add them up when you build your own plate.

## Where the numbers come from

Every calorie and protein figure in this book is **calculated**, not estimated.

1. **The data.** USDA FoodData Central, the SR Legacy dataset. It's the US Department of Agriculture's public food composition database.
2. **The weights.** Each ingredient is entered in grams, **raw or dry, as you buy it**: raw chicken, dry rice, raw broccoli. It's matched to the USDA entry in the same state ("chicken thigh, meat only, raw", not "roasted").
3. **Everything counts.** Oil, sauce, honey, cheese. If it goes in the pan, it's in the total.
4. **Divide.** The batch total is divided by the number of portions on the card.
5. **Round.** Calories to the nearest 10. Protein to the nearest gram.

**Why raw weights?** Raw is what you buy and can weigh before cooking. Cooked weight changes with oven time, because cooking mostly drives off water. The protein stays in the pan. So a total built from raw weights stays the same however long the chicken

roasted. That's also why Chapter 3 tells you to divide the cooked batch evenly: each box then carries its share of the raw total.

#### WHAT THIS CAN'T DO.

- **Some fat melts off.** With fattier cuts (thighs, pork shoulder), part of the fat stays in the pan. The real calories in your box can be a little lower than the card.
- **Your brand isn't the USDA average.** For packaged foods (yogurt, tortillas, sauces, protein-added products), the label on your package is more accurate than our figure. If they differ a lot, use the label.

## How to read the line on a card

Every recipe and plate shows a line like this:

**Per portion:** 560 kcal · 48 g protein · 56 g carbs · 15 g fat · *USDA FoodData Central*

- **Per portion** means one box, one fifth of a 5-portion batch, split as in Chapter 3.
- **kcal** is food energy, what US labels call Calories.

- **Protein, carbs, fat** are in grams.

These numbers describe the food. They don't say how much of it you should eat. That depends on you, and it's a conversation for a registered dietitian or your doctor (see Start Here).

## One plate, worked out

Here's a simplified plate, calculated the same way as every recipe. It isn't a recipe card. The sauce is only its yogurt base, so the steps are easy to follow.

| Part | Raw or dry, per portion | kcal | Protein |
|---|---|---|---|
| Chicken thigh, boneless, skinless | 180 g raw | 220 | 35 g |
| White rice, long-grain | 60 g dry | 220 | 4 g |
| Broccoli + olive oil | 100 g raw + 7 g oil | 100 | 3 g |
| Plain nonfat Greek yogurt (sauce base) | 50 g | 30 | 5 g |
| **Plate, calculated as a whole** | | **560** | **48 g** |

*Calculated with USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Carbs 56 g, fat 15 g, fiber 3 g.*

The rows add up to 570 kcal and 47 g, not 560 and 48. That's rounding: each row is rounded on its own. The bottom line is calculated from the unrounded numbers, so it's the one to trust.

## Swap the protein, see the real number

Now replace the chicken with 150 g of raw firm tofu. Same rice, broccoli, oil and yogurt.

| Plate | kcal | Protein |
|---|---|---|
| With chicken thigh (180 g raw) | 560 | 48 g |
| With firm tofu (150 g raw) | 560 | 38 g |

Plant-based plates in this book usually land lower in protein than meat plates of the same size. We print the real figure for each one. We don't average it away or round it up.

If you want more protein on a plant plate, the usual moves are a bigger protein portion, a yogurt- or tofu-based sauce, or edamame on the side. Each changes the calories too, so recalculate with the sheet below.

## Allergens on a combined plate

Each component card lists its allergens, from the 9 major food allergens recognized in the US: milk, eggs, fish, crustacean shellfish, tree nuts, peanuts, wheat, soybeans, sesame.

When you combine parts, **the plate has every allergen of every part.** A plain chicken thigh has none. Add rice: still none. Add teriyaki made with regular soy sauce: now it has **soy and wheat.**

Common ones to watch in this book:

| Ingredient | Usually contains | Note |
|---|---|---|
| Soy sauce | Soy, wheat | Tamari is often wheat-free. Check the label. |
| Gochujang | Soy, often wheat | Varies by brand |
| Tahini, sesame oil | Sesame | |
| Peanut-ginger sauce | Peanuts, soy | |
| Tzatziki, yogurt sauces, feta | Milk | |
| Tortillas, pasta | Wheat | |
| Egg bites | Eggs, milk | |

YOUR ACTION

## The build-your-plate sheet

Use it any time you put together a plate that isn't one of the 48. Copy each part's **per-portion** line from its card.

| Part | Card ID | kcal | Protein (g) | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Protein | | | | |
| Base | | | | |
| Vegetable | | | | |
| Sauce | | | | |
| Extra (cheese, nuts, seeds) | | | | |
| **Plate total** | | | | |

The total will be off by up to about 10 kcal and 1-2 g from rounding. That's normal.

*Source: U.S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Research Service. FoodData Central, SR Legacy (April 2018), fdc.nal.usda.gov. Public domain. Allergen list: US FDA, "Food Allergies: What You Need to Know" (fda.gov).*

CHAPTER 7

# Your Pantry & Gear on One Page

> **"I love that the first few pages tell you all the essential spices, sauces, equipment, etc that you need to have."**
>
> — reader review

If every recipe sends you out for a new jar, your weekly list gets long and your cupboard fills with half-used bottles.

The 60 recipes in this book share a small pantry. Buy it once. After that, the weekly shopping list is mostly fresh food: meat, vegetables, yogurt, herbs, lemons and limes.

# The pantry: 26 items

The family codes show which flavor family uses each item (Chapter 1). If you only plan to cook one or two families at first, buy only those rows.

### OILS AND VINEGARS

| ✓ | Item | Used in | Allergen |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Olive oil | All | |
| ☐ | Neutral oil (canola or avocado) | All | |
| ☐ | Rice vinegar | ASI | |
| ☐ | Apple cider vinegar | COM, MEX | |

### SPICES AND DRIED HERBS

| ✓ | Item | Used in | Allergen |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Kosher salt | All | |
| ☐ | Black pepper | All | |
| ☐ | Garlic powder | All | |
| ☐ | Smoked paprika | COM, MEX, MED | |
| ☐ | Ground cumin | MEX, MED | |
| ☐ | Chili powder | MEX, COM | |
| ☐ | Dried oregano | MED, MEX | |
| ☐ | Red pepper flakes | ASI, MED | |

## SAUCES AND JARS

| ✓ | Item | Used in | Allergen |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Low-sodium soy sauce (or tamari) | ASI | Soy, usually wheat |
| ☐ | Toasted sesame oil | ASI | Sesame |
| ☐ | Gochujang | ASI | Soy, often wheat |
| ☐ | Natural peanut butter | ASI, breakfasts | Peanuts |
| ☐ | Tahini | MED | Sesame |
| ☐ | Honey | ASI, COM | |
| ☐ | Dijon mustard | COM, MED | |
| ☐ | Chipotle peppers in adobo (small can) | MEX | Check label |

## DRY GOODS AND CANS

| ✓ | Item | Used in | Allergen |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Long-grain white rice | All | |
| ☐ | Quinoa | ASI, MED, MEX | |
| ☐ | Rolled oats | Breakfasts, snacks | Check label (gluten) |
| ☐ | Dry lentils (brown or green) | Budget mince, soups | |
| ☐ | Canned chickpeas | MED, MEX, snacks | |
| ☐ | Canned crushed tomatoes | COM, MED, freezer meals | |

**Store them well.** Opened chipotles in adobo keep longer if you freeze the rest flat in a zip-top bag and break off a piece when needed. Natural peanut butter and tahini separate on the shelf. Stir them well once, then keep them in the fridge if the label says so.

## On the weekly list, not in the pantry

These spoil or get used up fast, so they're on each week's shopping list: garlic, fresh ginger, lemons, limes, cilantro, parsley, plain Greek yogurt, eggs, tortillas, pasta, potatoes, sweet potatoes and all meat, fish and tofu.

## The gear: 6 things

You probably own most of them.

| ✓ | Tool | Why you need it |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | **2 rimmed sheet pans** (half-sheet, about 18 × 13 in / 46 × 33 cm) | Two trays roast at the same time. Rims stop juices from dripping. |
| ☐ | **9 × 13 in (23 × 33 cm) baking dish** | Oven rice and bakes. |
| ☐ | **Large skillet**, about 12 in (30 cm) | Ground meat and sauces. Big enough not to crowd. |
| ☐ | **Pot with a lid**, 4 qt (4 L) or more | Quinoa, pasta, lentils, soups. |
| ☐ | **Digital kitchen scale** with a tare button, in grams | Equal boxes (Chapter 3). |
| ☐ | **Instant-read thermometer** | Safe temperatures (Chapters 2 and 4). The one tool you shouldn't skip. |

**Plus containers.** 10 meal containers and 5 small sauce cups for the ×1 week. Double for ×2. Check the bottom or the box: they should say microwave-safe and freezer-safe. Two-compartment boxes help keep sauce and raw parts apart.

**Small stuff:** parchment paper, foil, masking tape and a marker for labels, a fridge thermometer.

**Nice to have, not needed:** a slow cooker (Week 2 uses one; the recipe gives an oven option), an air fryer (best for reheating potatoes and tofu), a sharp chef's knife if yours is dull.

## One rule that keeps the pantry stocked

**When you open the last one, write it on next week's list.** Not when it runs out. When you open it. A taped note on the inside of the cupboard door works.

YOUR ACTION

### The pantry check

Go through the four tables above with a pencil, in your own kitchen. Tick what you have. Then fill this in:

| | |
|---|---|
| Pantry items I need to buy | |
| Gear I need to buy or borrow | |
| Containers I have / need | ___ / ___ |
| Flavor families I'll start with | MEX · ASI · MED · COM |

Add the missing items to the top of your Week 1 shopping list. That first shop costs more. The weeks after it are mostly fresh food.

# 2

PART 2

# The 4-Week Plan

8 · Week 1 · The Starter Week

9 · Week 2 · The Slow-Cooker Week

10 · Week 3 · The Freezer-Ahead Week

11 · Week 4 · The Mix-It-Yourself Week

CHAPTER 8

# Week 1 · The Starter Week

> **"I loved not having to figure out what to eat."**
>
> — reader review

This is the week for your first Sunday. Every decision is made. You shop from the list, cook from the sheet and fill the boxes.

**Who it's for:** you're new to batch cooking, or you tried it and got lost in five recipes at once. It uses one skillet, one small saucepan and the oven. No slow cooker, no blender.

**What comes out:** 10 boxes (lunch and dinner Monday to Friday for one person, or lunch for two) and 5 breakfasts.

**Raw meat this week:** 4 lb (1.8 kg) for one person: 2 lb chicken thighs and 2 lb ground turkey. That's the most of any week except Week 3. Week 2 drops to about 3.2 lb.

## The week at a glance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Proteins** | P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs · P4 Turkey Taco Crumble |
| **Bases** | B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice · B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes |
| **Vegetables** | V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli · V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions |
| **Sauces** | S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt · S4 Lighter Teriyaki · S8 Lemon-Tahini |
| **Breakfast** | D1 Spinach-Feta Egg Bites |
| **Oven** | 450 °F → 425 °F → 350 °F (one oven, two racks) |
| **Stove** | 1 large skillet, 1 small saucepan |
| **Session** | About 2 hours, plus 10 minutes of setup. Time yours. |
| **Freezer** | Friday's 2 boxes go in on Sunday |

# The Sunday Sheet · Week 1

**Before 0:00 (about 10 minutes):** clear the counter. Line 4 sheet pans with parchment. Grease a 12-cup muffin tin plus 3 cups of a second tin. Get out the scale, thermometer, an 8×8-inch (20 cm) baking dish with foil, 10 boxes, 6 small sauce cups and 5 breakfast containers. Fill the kettle.

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | OVEN | Heat to **450 °F / 230 °C**. | *Oven signals hot* | — |
| 0:00 | PREP ⏱ | Cut broccoli into florets with a flat side. Dry well. Toss with oil, salt, garlic powder on pan 1. | *Florets dry to the touch* | V1 |
| 0:05 | PREP ⏱ | Whisk the chicken marinade. Toss the thighs in it. Into the fridge. | *Every piece coated* | P1 |
| 0:10 | PREP ⏱ | Peel and cut sweet potatoes in ¾-inch (2 cm) cubes. Toss with oil and spices on pan 2. Slice peppers and onions ½ inch (1 cm). Toss with oil and spices on pan 3. | *Pieces the same size, one layer* | B4, V2 |
| 0:15 | OVEN | **Broccoli in** (top rack), cut sides down. Timer: 18 min. | — | V1 |
| 0:15 | STOVE ⏱ | Skillet, medium heat: onion 4-5 min, spices 30 sec, turkey 7-9 min, then tomato paste + ½ cup water 3-4 min. | *No pink. **165 °F / 74 °C.** Glossy, not soupy* | P4 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:35 | OVEN | **Broccoli out** (18-22 min). Turn oven to **425 °F / 220 °C**, door open 1 minute. | *Tips blackened in spots, stems pierce easily* | V1 |
| 0:35 | OVEN | **Chicken (pan 4) and sweet potatoes (pan 2) in.** Timers: chicken 22 min, sweet potato flip at 15 min. | — | P1, B4 |
| 0:35 | STOVE | Turkey off the heat. Spread in a wide dish to cool. Kettle on: 2¼ cups water. Rinse the rice. | — | P4, B1 |
| 0:40 | STOVE | Saucepan: teriyaki. Simmer, whisk in the cornstarch, 1-2 min more. Off heat, sesame oil. | *Glossy, coats a spoon* | S4 |
| 0:50 | OVEN | Flip the sweet potatoes. | — | B4 |
| 0:50 | COLD | Stir the chipotle-lime yogurt. Whisk the lemon-tahini. Into the fridge. | *Even pale orange · thick ribbon* | S1, S8 |
| 0:57-1:03 | OVEN | **Chicken out** when the thermometer says so. Rest 5 min on the pan. | ***165 °F / 74 °C** in the thickest piece. Edges browned* | P1 |
| 1:00 | OVEN | **Peppers & onions (pan 3) in.** Timer: stir at 15 min. | — | V2 |
| 1:05 | OVEN | **Sweet potatoes out** (12-15 min after the flip). **Rice in:** rice, oil, salt and boiling water in the dish, foil crimped tight. Timer: 25 min. | *Browned edges, fork slides in* | B4, B1 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1:05 | PREP | Slice the chicken. Wilt the spinach in the skillet 1-2 min, press out water, chop. Whisk eggs + cottage cheese + seasoning. Fill 15 muffin cups with spinach, feta, then egg to ¾. | *Spinach bright green. Cups ¾ full* | P1, D1 |
| 1:15 | OVEN | Stir the peppers. | — | V2 |
| 1:25-1:28 | OVEN | **Peppers out** (25-28 min). Lime juice on top. | *Onions soft and golden at the edges* | V2 |
| 1:30-1:35 | OVEN | **Rice out** (check at 25 min). Leave covered 10 min. | *Water gone, small steam holes* | B1 |
| 1:35 | OVEN | Oven to **350 °F / 175 °C**, door open 2-3 min. **Egg bites in.** Timer: 20 min. | — | D1 |
| 1:45 | ASSEMBLY | Fluff the rice and spread it thin on a pan. Into the fridge within 1 hour. Weigh each batch, divide by its box count (table below). Fill the boxes. | *All boxes filled* | all |
| 1:57-2:01 | OVEN | **Egg bites out** (20-24 min). Cool 5 min in the tin, lift out. | *Centers set, knife comes out clean. **160 °F / 71 °C*** | D1 |
| 2:05 | ASSEMBLY | Lids on. Labels on. Fridge for Mon-Thu, **freezer for Friday's 2 boxes** and 2 spare teriyaki cups. Egg bites: 3 per container once fully cool. | *Fridge 40 °F / 4 °C or below* | all |

**Write your real time here:** start _____ finish _____ total _____ min.

*Why this order:* the broccoli wants the hottest oven, so it goes first. Everything at 425 °F shares the next 50 minutes. The egg bites need the coolest oven, so they go last while you pack. The recipe cards say B1 cooks at 375 °F; at 425 °F it fits beside another tray if the foil is sealed tight, so check it at 25 minutes.

To print: this Sunday Sheet and the shopping list are in the printable pack (pages 2 and 7), one page each.

## The assembly table

Weigh each cooked batch, then divide it by the box count. The grams below are what that gives with the yields on the recipe cards. Your batch may weigh a little more or less. The scale wins.

| Part | Boxes it fills | Per box (×1) | Goes into |
|---|---|---|---|
| P1 chicken | 6 | about 113 g (4 oz) | M1, A1, D-8 |
| P4 turkey | 4 | about 175 g (6 oz) | M3, M10 |
| B1 rice | 6 | about 133 g (4¾ oz) | M1, M10, A1 |
| B4 sweet potato | 4 | about 212 g (7½ oz) | M3, D-8 |
| V1 broccoli | 6 | about 108 g (3¾ oz) | M10, A1, D-8 |
| V2 peppers & onions | 4 | about 162 g (5¾ oz) | M1, M3 |
| S1 chipotle-lime (cup) | 6 | about 35 g (2 Tbsp) | M1, M3, M10 |
| S4 teriyaki (cup) | 2 + 3 spare | 34 g | A1 |
| S8 lemon-tahini (cup) | 2 + 3 spare | 34 g | D-8 |
| D1 egg bites | 5 containers | 3 bites | breakfast |

**×2:** make every batch twice and fill 20 boxes with the same grams per box. You'll need more pan space, so expect a second oven round for the 425 °F trays. Time it once and write it on your sheet.

*Why some boxes get more than a card portion:* this week the chicken is shared by 6 boxes and the turkey by 4, so turkey boxes are bigger and chicken boxes smaller than the standard portion in Chapter 16. The menu below shows the numbers for your actual boxes.

# The menu

| Day | Lunch | Dinner | Breakfast | Stored |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | M1 | M10 | D1 | fridge |
| Tue | M3 | D-8 | D1 | fridge |
| Wed | M1 | M10 | D1 | fridge |
| Thu | M3 | D-8 | D1 | fridge · **move Friday's boxes to the fridge in the morning** |
| Fri | A1 | A1 | D1 | **freezer on Sunday**, thawed in the fridge from Thursday |

| Plate | Name | Parts | Your box: kcal · protein | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| M1 | Chipotle Lemon Chicken Fajita Bowl | P1 + B1 + V2 + S1 | 580 kcal · 39 g | milk |
| M3 | Turkey Taco Sweet Potato Bowl | P4 + B4 + V2 + S1 | 850 kcal · 54 g | milk |
| M10 | Turkey Taco Rice Bowl with Charred Broccoli | P4 + B1 + V1 + S1 | 720 kcal · 55 g | milk |
| A1 | Teriyaki Lemon Chicken & Broccoli Rice | P1 + B1 + V1 + S4 | 550 kcal · 39 g | soy, wheat, sesame |
| D-8 | Lemon Chicken, Sweet Potato & Tahini | P1 + B4 + V1 + S8 | 670 kcal · 40 g | sesame |
| D1 | Spinach-Feta Egg Bites (3 bites) | breakfast | 220 kcal · 18 g | egg, milk |

**Per day (2 boxes + breakfast):** Mon and Wed 1,530 kcal · 112 g protein. Tue and Thu 1,750 kcal · 112 g. Fri 1,320 kcal · 96 g. **Week average:** about 1,580 kcal and 109 g protein a day from this plan. That's what the boxes hold, not a target. The book doesn't tell you how much to eat (Chapter 0).

*All figures calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy with the gram weights on the recipe cards, for the box sizes above. Kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g.*

**Allergens this week:** milk, egg, soy, wheat, sesame. Soy sauce usually contains wheat. Read the labels of what you buy.

## The day-5 rule, applied

- Sunday is day 0. Friday is day 5, outside the 3-4 days USDA FSIS gives cooked leftovers in the fridge.
- **Friday = A1 ×2, frozen on Sunday.** Chicken, rice and teriyaki all freeze well. The broccoli is safe frozen but comes out softer (that's why the storage chart says "not recommended" for texture). Re-

crisp it 5 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer if you mind.

- **Thursday morning:** move both A1 boxes to the fridge. They thaw by Friday.
- No salmon this week, so no day-1-2 rule.
- S1 (chipotle-lime yogurt) doesn't freeze, and it's only on Monday-Thursday plates. That's why it isn't on Friday.

## Shopping list · Week 1

Amounts are what the recipes use, rounded up to what you can buy. **×1** = 10 boxes + 5 breakfasts. **×2** = 20 boxes + 10 breakfasts. Package sizes are common US sizes; yours may differ.

### MEAT

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Boneless skinless chicken thighs | 2 lb (907 g) | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |
| ☐ | 93% lean ground turkey | 2 lb (907 g) | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |

### PRODUCE

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Broccoli crowns | 2 lb (900 g), about 2 large | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Sweet potatoes | 2.2 lb (1 kg), about 3 medium | 4.4 lb (2 kg), about 6 medium |
| ☐ | Bell peppers, red and/or green | 3 | 6 |
| ☐ | Yellow onions | 3 medium (about 1 lb / 450 g) | 6 medium |
| ☐ | Baby spinach | 4 packed cups (about 4 oz / 120 g): one 5-oz bag | 8 packed cups: one 10-oz bag |
| ☐ | Lemons | enough for 6 Tbsp juice (about 3) | enough for 12 Tbsp (about 6) |
| ☐ | Limes | enough for 2 Tbsp juice (1-2) | enough for 4 Tbsp (2-3) |
| ☐ | Garlic | 10 cloves: 1 head | 20 cloves: 2 heads |
| ☐ | Fresh ginger | 1 small knob (1 tsp grated) | same knob (2 tsp) |

## DAIRY & EGGS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Large eggs | 10 | 20 |
| ☐ | Plain nonfat Greek yogurt | ¾ cup (6 oz / 170 g) | 1½ cups (12 oz): one 16-oz tub |
| ☐ | 2% cottage cheese | ½ cup (4 oz / 113 g) | 1 cup (8 oz) |
| ☐ | Crumbled feta | ½ cup (about 2.6 oz / 75 g): one 4-oz container | 1 cup: one 6-oz container |

### PANTRY, CANNED & CONDIMENTS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Long-grain white rice | 1½ cups (10 oz / 278 g) | 3 cups (20 oz) |
| ☐ | Olive oil | 10 Tbsp + 2 tsp | 1⅓ cups |
| ☐ | Tahini | ¼ cup | ½ cup |
| ☐ | Reduced-sodium soy sauce | ¼ cup | ½ cup |
| ☐ | Honey | 1½ Tbsp | 3 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Rice vinegar or cider vinegar | 1 Tbsp | 2 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Cornstarch | 2 tsp | 4 tsp |
| ☐ | Toasted sesame oil | ½ tsp | 1 tsp |
| ☐ | Tomato paste | 2 Tbsp | 4 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Chipotle peppers in adobo | 1 pepper + 1 tsp sauce: one 7-oz can | 2 peppers + 2 tsp sauce |
| ☐ | Canola oil or cooking spray | for the muffin tin | for 2 rounds |

**Spice check** (tick what you have; amounts are the week's total for ×1, double for ×2)

- [ ] Kosher salt: 6½ tsp · fine salt: about ⅝ tsp
- [ ] Chili powder: 2 Tbsp + 2 tsp
- [ ] Ground cumin: 3¼ tsp + a pinch
- [ ] Smoked paprika: 1 Tbsp
- [ ] Garlic powder: 2½ tsp
- [ ] Dried oregano: 2 tsp
- [ ] Black pepper: 1¼ tsp

### WHAT'S LEFT OVER AFTER THIS WEEK

- 3 cups each of teriyaki and lemon-tahini. Fridge 4 days; teriyaki freezes 3 months and tahini sauce 2 months. Freeze them flat in a small bag for Week 3 (S4 is on that list) or any plate.
- Most of the chipotle can: spoon the rest into an ice tray and freeze.
- The rest of the tahini jar, soy sauce, honey and vinegar: they're pantry items for later weeks.

## What this week costs

| Week 1 | 1 person | 2 people | Average per plate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shopping total | **$43.72** | **$87.43** | $3.67 |

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs and dairy: latest month available; fruit and vegetables: 2023 annual averages) plus reference prices for pantry items. Your store will differ.*

**YOUR ACTION**

Before Sunday:

- [ ] Read this sheet once, top to bottom (5 minutes).
- [ ] Shop from the list. Tick the spice check at home first.
- [ ] Count 10 boxes, 6 sauce cups, 5 breakfast containers.
- [ ] Make fridge space for 10 boxes. Make freezer space for 2.

After Sunday:

| |
|---|
| **Real total time** |
| **The slowest step** |
| **One thing to change for Week 2** |
| |
| |
| |

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition). USDA FSIS, "Leftovers and Food Safety" and "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov). Allergens: the 9 major food allergens defined by the US FDA.*

CHAPTER 9

# Week 2 · The Slow-Cooker Week

> **"Simply because it gets expensive and hard to source all the meat sometimes... especially the more expensive cuts."**
>
> — reader review

This week spends less on meat without cutting the protein. Two tricks do it. Lentils stretch 1 lb of ground beef into 5 portions. Chicken breast goes in the slow cooker with a jar of salsa and needs nothing from you for hours.

**Who it's for:** you did Week 1 and want a Sunday where the slow cooker does part of the work, and less meat on the list thanks to lentils.

**What comes out:** 10 boxes and 5 jars of overnight oats.

**Raw meat this week:** about 3.2 lb (1.45 kg) for one person: 1 lb ground beef and 2.2 lb chicken breast. That's 0.8 lb less than Week 1.

## The week at a glance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Proteins** | P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince · P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken |
| **Bases** | B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes · B6 Wraps & Tortillas (no cooking) |
| **Vegetables** | V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion · V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions |
| **Sauces** | S3 Quick Red Enchilada · S10 Smoky BBQ (less sugar) · S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde |
| **Breakfast** | D3 Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats |
| **Oven** | 425 °F the whole time, then the broiler |
| **Stove** | 1 large pot, 2 small saucepans · plus a slow cooker · a blender for the salsa verde |
| **Session** | About 2 hours at the counter. The slow cooker starts 2½ hours earlier and works alone. |
| **Freezer** | Friday's 2 boxes go in on Sunday |

**No slow cooker?** The P2 card doesn't have a tested oven method yet. Use P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast instead: same chicken, same weight. It roasts at

425 °F, so it shares the oven with this week's trays. Shred or slice it and stir in 2 Tbsp of jarred salsa per box. The numbers in the menu will change a little.

## The Sunday Sheet · Week 2

**2½ hours before 0:00 (10 minutes):** chicken breasts in the slow cooker in one layer. Cumin, chili powder, garlic powder and salt on top. Pour the salsa over. No water. Lid on, **HIGH**. Now go do something else.

**Before 0:00 (about 10 minutes):** line 2 sheet pans with parchment, keep a third pan bare for the potatoes. Get out the scale, thermometer, a large pot, 2 small saucepans, blender, 10 boxes, 10 sauce cups, 5 jars of at least 12 oz (350 ml).

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | OVEN | Heat to **425 °F / 220 °C** with the bare pan inside. | *Oven signals hot* | B3 |
| 0:00 | STOVE | Large pot, medium-high: oil, then the beef. Break it up. 6-8 min. | *No pink. **160 °F / 71 °C*** | P5 |
| 0:00 | PREP | Halve the potatoes (quarter big ones). Dry. Toss with oil and spices. Slice peppers and onions ½ inch. Toss with oil and spices on a lined pan. | *Same-size pieces* | B3, V2 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:10 | OVEN | **Potatoes onto the hot pan**, cut side down (lower rack). Timer: 20 min, then flip. **Peppers in** (top rack). Timer: stir at 15 min. | *They sizzle* | B3, V2 |
| 0:10 | STOVE ⏱ | Pot: onion + carrot 5 min, garlic + tomato paste + spices 1 min, then rinsed lentils, salt, 3 cups water. Boil, then simmer partly covered 22-28 min. Stir now and then. | — | P5 |
| 0:15 | STOVE ⏱ | Saucepan 1: whisk all the BBQ ingredients, bring to a gentle bubble, then low 10-12 min. | *Spoon leaves a clear trail* | S10 |
| 0:25 | OVEN | Stir the peppers. | — | V2 |
| 0:30 | OVEN | Flip the potatoes. Timer: 15 min. | — | B3 |
| 0:30 | PREP ⏱ | Cut zucchini in ½-inch half-moons, red onion in wedges. Toss with oil and spices on a lined pan. | — | V3 |
| 0:35 | STOVE ⏱ | Saucepan 2: oil, flour + spices 45-60 sec, then tomato sauce, water, vinegar, salt. Low 8-10 min. | *Coats a spoon, brick red* | S3 |
| 0:38 | OVEN | **Peppers out** (25-28 min). Lime on top. **Zucchini in.** Timer: turn at 12 min. | *Onions soft and golden at the edges* | V2, V3 |
| 0:45-0:50 | OVEN | **Potatoes out.** | *Deep golden cut sides, knife slides in* | B3 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **0:45** | **STOVE** | Check the beef and lentils. Add ¼ cup water at a time if it dries too soon. Off the heat when done. | *Lentils tender, pot thick like chili* | P5 |
| **0:50** | SLOW COOKER | Check the chicken. Shred with 2 forks. Stir in lime juice and ½ cup of the cooking liquid. If it isn't ready, check again at 1:10. | ***165 °F / 74 °C**, shreds with no effort* | P2 |
| **0:55** | **COLD** ⏱ | Overnight oats: dry mix, then yogurt, milk, honey, vanilla. Into 5 jars, berries on top. Fridge. | *No dry pockets* | D3 |
| **0:58-1:03** | **OVEN** | **Zucchini out** (20-25 min). Lemon juice on top. Turn on the **broiler, high**. | *Golden edges, tender middle* | V3 |
| **1:05** | **OVEN** | Tomatillos, jalapeño, onion, unpeeled garlic on a foil-lined pan under the broiler, 5-7 min. Flip, 4-5 min more. | *Blistered, soft, slumped* | S2 |
| **1:05** | **ASSEMBLY** ⏱ | Weigh each batch, divide by its box count (table below). Fill the boxes. Stack 6 tortillas with parchment between them, into a zip bag. | — | all |
| **1:20** | **COLD** | Cool the broiled salsa 5 min. Slip the garlic out of its skin. Blend with cilantro, lime, salt. | *Bright, not flat* | S2 |
| **1:30** | **ASSEMBLY** | Sauce into cups. Lids, labels. Fridge for Mon-Thu, **freezer for Friday's 2 M11 boxes**. The tortilla bag stays in the fridge. | *Fridge 40 °F / 4 °C or below* | all |

**Write your real time here:** start _____ finish _____ total _____ min.

*Why this order:* one oven temperature all session, so nothing waits for the oven to change. The broiler goes last because it needs the whole top of the oven. The lentil pot simmers on its own in the middle of the session.

To print: this Sunday Sheet and the shopping list are in the printable pack (pages 3 and 8), one page each.

# The assembly table

| Part | Boxes it fills | Per box (×1) | Goes into |
|---|---|---|---|
| P5 beef & lentil | 4 | about 200 g (7 oz) | M4, C5 |
| P2 salsa chicken | 6 | about 117 g (4 oz) + a spoon of juices | M11, M9, C8 |
| B3 potatoes | 4 | about 212 g (7½ oz) | M9, C5 |
| B6 tortillas | 6 | 1 tortilla, in the bag, not in the box | M4, M11, C8 |
| V3 zucchini & onion | 4 | about 162 g (5¾ oz) | M4, M9 |
| V2 peppers & onions | 6 | about 108 g (3¾ oz) | M11, C5, C8 |
| S3 enchilada (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | about 42 g | M4, M11 |
| S10 BBQ (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | about 41 g | C5, C8 |
| S2 salsa verde (cup) | 2 + 3 spare | about 44 g | M9 |
| D3 overnight oats | 5 jars | 1 jar | breakfast |

The recipe makes 5 tortillas' worth; this week has 6 wrap boxes, so buy a pack and use 6. The wrap is rolled at lunch (B6 card): warm the tortilla, fill, fold, roll.

**×2:** double every batch, 20 boxes, same grams. Use 2 pans for each tray and run a second oven round. Use a 6-quart or larger slow cooker, or two.

## The menu

| Day | Lunch | Dinner | Breakfast | Stored |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | M4 | M9 | D3 | fridge |
| Tue | M4 | C5 | D3 | fridge |
| Wed | M9 | C8 | D3 | fridge · zucchini plates done by today (3 days) |
| Thu | C5 | C8 | D3 | fridge · **move Friday's boxes to the fridge in the morning** |
| Fri | M11 | M11 | D3 | **freezer on Sunday** (filling + sauce cup); tortillas from the fridge bag |

| Plate | Name | Parts | Your box: kcal · protein | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| M4 | Red Enchilada Beef & Lentil Wrap | P5 + B6 + V3 + S3 | 710 kcal · 41 g | wheat |
| M11 | Enchilada Chicken Fajita Wrap | P2 + B6 + V2 + S3 | 500 kcal · 45 g | wheat |
| M9 | Salsa Chicken & Crispy Potato Bowl | P2 + B3 + V3 + S2 | 590 kcal · 47 g | none of the 9 |
| C5 | BBQ Beef & Lentil Potato Bowl | P5 + B3 + V2 + S10 | 780 kcal · 41 g | fish* |
| C8 | BBQ Chicken Fajita Wrap | P2 + B6 + V2 + S10 | 510 kcal · 45 g | fish*, wheat |
| D3 | Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats (1 jar) | breakfast | 340 kcal · 24 g | milk |

* The fish is the anchovy in Worcestershire sauce (S10). Some brands are made without it. Check the label.

**Per day (2 boxes + breakfast):** Mon 1,640 kcal · 112 g protein. Tue 1,830 · 106 g. Wed 1,450 · 117 g. Thu 1,630 · 110 g. Fri 1,350 · 115 g. **Week average:** about 1,580 kcal and 112 g protein a day. That's what the boxes hold, not a target.

*Calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy for the box sizes above, 1 whole tortilla per wrap box. Kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g.*

**Allergens this week:** wheat, fish (Worcestershire), milk. Jarred salsa and tortillas vary by brand: read the labels.

## The day-5 rule, applied

- **Friday = M11 ×2, frozen on Sunday.** Shredded chicken, peppers and enchilada sauce all freeze (3 months). Freeze the filling and the sauce cup. Tortillas keep 7 days in the fridge, so they stay in their bag.
- **Thursday morning:** move both M11 boxes to the fridge.
- **Zucchini (V3) keeps 3 days, not 4.** Both zucchini plates (M4, M9) are eaten by Wednesday.
- No salmon this week.

## Shopping list · Week 2

**×1** = 10 boxes + 5 breakfasts. **×2** = 20 boxes + 10 breakfasts. Common US package sizes; yours may differ.

## MEAT

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Boneless skinless chicken breasts | 2.2 lb (1 kg) | 4.4 lb (2 kg) |
| ☐ | 90% lean ground beef | 1 lb (454 g) | 2 lb (908 g) |

## PRODUCE

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Baby red potatoes | 2.2 lb (1 kg): a 3-lb bag covers it | 4.4 lb (2 kg): a 5-lb bag |
| ☐ | Zucchini | 3 medium (about 1.7 lb / 750 g) | 6 medium |
| ☐ | Bell peppers, red and/or green | 3 | 6 |
| ☐ | Yellow onions | 3 medium (about 1 lb / 450 g) | 6 medium |
| ☐ | Red onion | 1 large (7 oz / 200 g) | 2 large |
| ☐ | Carrot | 1 large | 2 large |
| ☐ | Tomatillos | 3-4 medium (6 oz / 170 g) | 6-8 (12 oz) |
| ☐ | Jalapeño | 1 | 2 |
| ☐ | White onion | 1 small (you use ¼) | 1 small (you use ½) |
| ☐ | Cilantro | 1 bunch (you use ¼ cup packed) | 1 bunch |
| ☐ | Limes | enough for 3 Tbsp + 1 tsp juice (2) | about 4 |
| ☐ | Lemon | 1 (1 Tbsp juice) | 1 |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Garlic | 4 cloves: 1 head | 8 cloves: 1 head |
| ☐ | Blueberries, fresh or frozen | 1¼ cups (6.5 oz / 185 g) | 2½ cups (13 oz) |

## DAIRY

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Plain nonfat Greek yogurt | 2½ cups (21 oz / 600 g): one 32-oz tub | 5 cups (42 oz): one 32-oz + one 16-oz tub |
| ☐ | 1% milk | 2½ cups: 1 quart | 5 cups: ½ gallon |

## BAKERY

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Flour tortillas, 8-inch | 6: one pack of 8 or 10 | 12 |

## PANTRY, CANNED & CONDIMENTS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Jarred salsa, medium | 1½ cups: one 16-oz jar | two 16-oz jars |
| ☐ | Dry brown lentils | ¾ cup (5.3 oz / 150 g): a 1-lb bag | 1½ cups |
| ☐ | Old-fashioned rolled oats | 2½ cups (7 oz / 200 g) | 5 cups (14 oz) |
| ☐ | Chia seeds | 2 Tbsp + 2 tsp | ⅓ cup |
| ☐ | Tomato paste | 4 Tbsp: one 6-oz can | 8 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Tomato sauce, plain | ½ cup: one 8-oz can | 1 cup: one 8-oz can |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Ketchup | ⅓ cup | ⅔ cup |
| ☐ | Yellow mustard | 1 tsp | 2 tsp |
| ☐ | Worcestershire sauce | 1 tsp | 2 tsp |
| ☐ | Cider vinegar | 2 Tbsp + 1 tsp | ¼ cup + 2 tsp |
| ☐ | Brown sugar | 1 Tbsp | 2 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Honey | 5 tsp | 3 Tbsp + 1 tsp |
| ☐ | Vanilla extract | 1 tsp | 2 tsp |
| ☐ | All-purpose flour | 2 tsp | 4 tsp |
| ☐ | Olive oil | 7 Tbsp + 2 tsp | about 1 cup |

**Spice check** (week total for ×1; double for ×2)

- [ ] Kosher salt: 5½ tsp · fine salt: about 1 tsp + a pinch
- [ ] Chili powder: 2 Tbsp + 2 tsp
- [ ] Ground cumin: 5¼ tsp
- [ ] Garlic powder: 4¼ tsp
- [ ] Smoked paprika: 4 tsp
- [ ] Dried oregano: 1¼ tsp
- [ ] Ground cinnamon: 1 tsp
- [ ] Onion powder: ½ tsp · cayenne: a pinch · black pepper: ½ tsp

### WHAT'S LEFT OVER AFTER THIS WEEK

- 3 cups of salsa verde, 1 of enchilada sauce, 1 of BBQ. All three freeze 3 months. Salsa verde goes into Week 4.
- 2-4 tortillas: they freeze 2 months wrapped in foil.
- Most of the lentil bag, oats and chia: pantry for later.
- About 11 oz of Greek yogurt and some milk: use them by their package date.

## What this week costs

| Week 2 | 1 person | 2 people | Average per plate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shopping total | **$47.15** | **$94.30** | $3.64 |

Not the cheapest week: it costs about the same as Week 1. Week 4 is the cheapest of the four.

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs and dairy: latest month available; fruit and vegetables: 2023 annual averages) plus reference prices for pantry items. Your store will differ.*

### YOUR ACTION

- [ ] Saturday night or Sunday morning: set a phone alarm for **2½ hours before you start** to load the slow cooker.
- [ ] Compare this week's time with Week 1: _____ min vs _____ min.
- [ ] Which plate would you swap next time, and for what? Look at the Mix & Match chart (Chapter 16).

_____

_____

_____

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition). USDA FSIS, "Leftovers and Food Safety", "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov). FDA, 9 major food allergens.*

CHAPTER 10

# Week 3 · The Freezer-Ahead Week

> **"Keep em in the freezer and you're good for weeks."**
>
> — reader review

This week you cook a little more than you eat. The meatballs are made twice. One batch feeds this week. The other goes into the freezer as a reserve for a week when Sunday doesn't happen.

**Who it's for:** you've done two weeks and you know a busy week is coming. Or you want a stock in the freezer before you need it.

**What comes out:** 10 boxes, 5 breakfast burritos, 1 salmon dinner for Sunday night, and **4 meatball portions (24 meatballs) for the freezer**.

**Raw meat and fish this week:** 6 lb (2.7 kg) for one person: 4 lb ground turkey and 2 lb salmon. It's the biggest shop of the plan because a third of it is the freezer reserve.

## The week at a glance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Proteins** | P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs (**×2**) · P8 Simple Baked Salmon |
| **Bases** | B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta · B2 Fluffy Quinoa |
| **Vegetables** | V4 Garlic Green Beans · V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion |
| **Sauces** | S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic · S9 Chimichurri · S4 Lighter Teriyaki |
| **Breakfast** | D5 Freezer Breakfast Burritos |
| **Oven** | 425 °F → 400 °F |
| **Stove** | 1 large pot, 1 medium pot with lid, 1 nonstick pan, 2 small saucepans |
| **Session** | About 2 hours, plus 10 minutes of setup. Time yours. |
| **Freezer** | Friday's 2 boxes, 1 burrito, 24 meatballs |

# The Sunday Sheet · Week 3

**Before 0:00 (about 10 minutes):** line 5 sheet pans with parchment. Fill a large pot with 3 quarts (3 L) of water. Get out the scale, thermometer, 10 boxes, 9 sauce cups, a freezer bag for the meatballs, foil or parchment for 5 burritos.

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | OVEN | Heat to **425 °F / 220 °C**. | *Oven signals hot* | — |
| 0:00 | STOVE | Pasta water on, high, lid on. | — | B5 |
| 0:00 | PREP ⏱ | Trim and dry the green beans. Toss with oil, salt, pepper on pan 1. Cut zucchini in ½-inch half-moons, red onion in wedges. Toss on pan 2. | *One layer, not crowded* | V4, V3 |
| 0:10 | OVEN | **Beans and zucchini in.** Timers: beans 10 min, zucchini turn at 12 min. | — | V4, V3 |
| 0:10 | STOVE ⏱ | Salt the boiling water, add the pasta. Cook **1-2 min less** than the package says. Drain, don't rinse, toss with oil, spread on a tray. | *Thin white dot in the center* | B5 |
| 0:12 | STOVE ⏱ | Medium pot: rinse quinoa 30 sec, add 3 cups water, oil, salt. Boil, then lowest heat, lid on, 14-16 min. Off heat 5 min, lid on. | *Water gone, white spiral tails* | B2 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **0:15** | PREP ⏱ | Meatball mix, **two batches in one big bowl**: egg, crumbs, Parmesan, garlic, spices, parsley, 3 min. Add the turkey, mix just until it comes together. Scoop 60 balls, about 2 Tbsp each, onto pans 3 and 4. | *Even size, close but not touching* | P6 |
| **0:20** | OVEN | Beans out, scatter the garlic, back in 4-6 min. Turn the zucchini. | — | V4, V3 |
| **0:26** | OVEN | **Beans out.** Lemon juice on top. | *Wrinkled, brown spots, a little snap. Garlic pale gold* | V4 |
| **0:32-0:35** | OVEN | **Zucchini out** (20-25 min). Lemon juice. Turn oven to **400 °F / 205 °C**, door open 1-2 min. | *Golden edges, tender middle* | V3 |
| **0:35** | OVEN | **Both meatball pans in.** Timer: 18 min. | — | P6 |
| **0:35** | STOVE ⏱ | Saucepan 1, medium-low: garlic 30-60 sec, tomato sauce + oregano + salt 8-10 min, then cream cheese on lowest heat, Parmesan off heat. | *Smooth, creamy pink-orange* | S12 |
| **0:40** | STOVE ⏱ | Saucepan 2: teriyaki. Simmer, whisk in the cornstarch, 1-2 min. Off heat, sesame oil. | *Glossy, coats a spoon* | S4 |
| **0:50** | PREP ⏱ | Pat the salmon dry. Cut into 5 even pieces (about 180 g raw each). On pan 5, skin side down. Oil, lemon, spices. | — | P8 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:53-0:55 | OVEN | **Meatballs out.** Cool 15 min. | *Browned. **165 °F / 74 °C** in the middle* | P6 |
| 0:55 | OVEN | **Salmon in.** Timer: 11 min. | — | P8 |
| 0:55 | STOVE ⏱ | Nonstick pan: onion + red pepper 3-4 min, spices, then the beaten eggs, folding 3-4 min. Onto a plate to cool 10 min. | *Large soft curds, no wet shine* | D5 |
| 1:06-1:09 | OVEN | **Salmon out.** Rest 3 min. Oven off. | *Flakes with a fork. **145 °F / 63 °C*** | P8 |
| 1:10 | ASSEMBLY ⏱ | Meatballs: 36 into 6 boxes (6 each). The other **24 on a tray into the freezer** for 1 hour, then into a bag. Weigh and divide the rest (table below). | — | all |
| 1:15 | PREP | Burritos: warm each tortilla 10 sec, add ⅕ of the eggs, 3 Tbsp beans, ⅕ of the cheddar. Fold the sides, roll tight. Wrap each one. | *5 tight rolls* | D5 |
| 1:35 | COLD | Chimichurri, last so it's freshest. Chop parsley and garlic fine, add vinegar, oregano, flakes, salt, then the oil. | *Sharp and green* | S9 |
| 1:45 | ASSEMBLY | Sauces into cups. Lids, labels. Fridge for Mon-Thu. **Freezer:** Friday's A10 + D-5 boxes, 1 burrito, the meatball bag. Salmon portion #5 is **Sunday dinner**. | *Fridge 40 °F / 4 °C or below* | all |

**Write your real time here:** start _____ finish _____ total _____ min.

*Why this order:* vegetables roast hottest, so they go first. The oven drops 25 degrees for the meatballs and stays there for the salmon. The stove runs the whole session on two burners; the oven never waits for it.

To print: this Sunday Sheet and the shopping list are in the printable pack (pages 4 and 9), one page each.

# The assembly table

| Part | Boxes it fills | Per box (×1) | Goes into |
|---|---|---|---|
| P6 meatballs | 6 + 4 reserve portions | 6 meatballs (about 156 g / 5½ oz) | C3, D-5, A10 |
| P8 salmon | 4 + 1 for Sunday dinner | 1 piece (about 146 g / 5 oz) | A4, D-3 |
| B5 pasta | 4 | about 188 g (6½ oz) | C3, A10 |
| B2 quinoa | 6 | about 140 g (5 oz) | D-5, A4, D-3 |
| V4 green beans | 6 | about 100 g (3½ oz) | D-5, A4, A10 |
| V3 zucchini & onion | 4 | about 162 g (5¾ oz) | C3, D-3 |
| S12 creamy tomato (cup) | 2 + 3 spare | 45 g | C3 |
| S9 chimichurri (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | about 38 g | D-5, D-3 |
| S4 teriyaki (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | 34 g | A4, A10 |
| D5 burritos | 5 | 1 burrito | breakfast |

**×2:** four meatball batches (120 balls) on 4 pans: run two oven rounds at 400 °F. Salmon ×2 needs 2 pans. Fill 20 boxes with the same amounts. The freezer reserve doubles to 8 portions.

# The menu

| Day | Lunch | Dinner | Breakfast | Stored |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sun | — | Salmon #5 + a spare sauce cup | — | eat tonight |
| Mon | A4 | D-3 | D5 | fridge · **salmon day** |
| Tue | A4 | D-3 | D5 | fridge · **salmon day** |
| Wed | C3 | C3 | D5 | fridge · zucchini plates done by today (3 days) |
| Thu | A10 | D-5 | D5 | fridge · **move Friday's boxes and burrito to the fridge in the morning** |
| Fri | A10 | D-5 | D5 | **freezer on Sunday** |

| Plate | Name | Parts | Your box: kcal · protein | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| A4 | Teriyaki Salmon & Green Bean Quinoa | P8 + B2 + V4 + S4 | 700 kcal · 47 g | fish, soy, wheat, sesame |
| D-3 | Chimichurri Salmon Quinoa Bowl | P8 + B2 + V3 + S9 | 840 kcal · 47 g | fish |
| C3 | Creamy Tomato Meatball Pasta | P6 + B5 + V3 + S12 | 880 kcal · 54 g | egg, milk, wheat |
| A10 | Teriyaki Meatball Noodle Bowl | P6 + B5 + V4 + S4 | 820 kcal · 53 g | egg, milk, wheat, soy, sesame |
| D-5 | Chimichurri Meatball Quinoa Bowl | P6 + B2 + V4 + S9 | 750 kcal · 47 g | egg, milk, wheat |
| D5 | Freezer Breakfast Burrito (1) | breakfast | 520 kcal · 28 g | egg, milk, wheat |

**Per day (2 boxes + breakfast):** Mon and Tue 2,050 kcal · 121 g protein. Wed 2,280 · 136 g. Thu and Fri 2,090 · 128 g. **Week average:** about 2,110 kcal and 127 g protein a day. This is the heaviest week of the plan: bigger pasta boxes, oily fish, a burrito breakfast.

It's what the boxes hold, not a target. If it's more than you eat, make the base portion smaller (Chapter 3) and keep the protein.

*Calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy for the box sizes above. Kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g.*

**Allergens this week:** fish, egg, milk, wheat, soy, sesame. Breadcrumbs, tortillas and soy sauce contain wheat. Read the labels.

## The day-5 rule, applied

- **Salmon on days 1-2.** All 4 salmon boxes are Monday and Tuesday. The 5th piece is Sunday dinner. Salmon is safe for 3 days, but it dries and smells stronger as the days pass.
- **Zucchini (V3) keeps 3 days.** The zucchini plates are D-3 (Mon-Tue) and C3 (Wed).
- **Friday = A10 + D-5, frozen on Sunday.** Meatballs, pasta, quinoa, teriyaki and chimichurri all freeze. The green beans are safe frozen but come out softer.
- **Friday's burrito** goes in the freezer too. Burritos keep 4 days in the fridge.
- **Thursday morning:** move both Friday boxes and the burrito to the fridge.
- **The reserve:** 24 meatballs, labeled with today's date. Best within 3 months. Reheat from frozen: 12 min at 350 °F / 175 °C, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the

center. Pair them with any base and sauce from the Mix & Match chart (Chapter 16).

## Shopping list · Week 3

**×1** = 10 boxes + 5 breakfasts + Sunday salmon + 4 reserve portions. **×2** = double all of it. Common US package sizes; yours may differ.

### MEAT & FISH

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 93% lean ground turkey | 4 lb (1.8 kg) | 8 lb (3.6 kg) |
| ☐ | Salmon fillets | 2 lb (907 g) | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |

### PRODUCE

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Green beans | 1.5 lb (700 g) | 3 lb (1.4 kg) |
| ☐ | Zucchini | 3 medium (about 1.7 lb / 750 g) | 6 medium |
| ☐ | Red onion | 1 large (7 oz / 200 g) | 2 large |
| ☐ | Red bell pepper | 1 medium | 2 medium |
| ☐ | Yellow onion | 1 small (⅓ cup diced) | 1 medium |
| ☐ | Flat-leaf parsley | about 2 bunches (1 cup packed + ¼ cup chopped) | about 4 bunches |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Lemons | enough for 3 Tbsp juice (1-2) | 3 |
| ☐ | Garlic | 17 cloves: 2 heads | 34 cloves: 3-4 heads |
| ☐ | Fresh ginger | 1 small knob (1 tsp grated) | same knob |

## DAIRY & EGGS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Large eggs | 12 (10 for burritos, 2 for meatballs) | 24 |
| ☐ | Shredded sharp cheddar | 1¼ cups (5 oz / 140 g): one 8-oz bag | 2½ cups: two 8-oz bags |
| ☐ | Grated Parmesan | ½ cup + 2 Tbsp (about 2.3 oz) | 1¼ cups (about 4.7 oz) |
| ☐ | Reduced-fat cream cheese | 3 Tbsp (1.6 oz): one 8-oz block | 6 Tbsp |

## BAKERY

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Flour tortillas, 10-inch | 5 | 10 |

## PANTRY, CANNED & CONDIMENTS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Short pasta (penne or fusilli) | 12 oz (340 g): one 16-oz box | 24 oz: two 16-oz boxes |
| ☐ | Quinoa | 1½ cups (9 oz / 255 g) | 3 cups (18 oz) |
| ☐ | Plain dry breadcrumbs | 1 cup (3.9 oz / 110 g) | 2 cups |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Low-sodium black beans | 1 cup drained: one 15-oz can | two 15-oz cans |
| ☐ | Tomato sauce, plain | ¾ cup: one 8-oz can | 1½ cups: one 15-oz can |
| ☐ | Red wine vinegar | 3 Tbsp | 6 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Reduced-sodium soy sauce | ¼ cup | ½ cup |
| ☐ | Honey | 1½ Tbsp | 3 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Rice vinegar or cider vinegar | 1 Tbsp | 2 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Cornstarch | 2 tsp | 4 tsp |
| ☐ | Toasted sesame oil | ½ tsp | 1 tsp |
| ☐ | Olive oil | about 14 Tbsp (⅞ cup) | about 1¾ cups |

## **Spice check** (week total for ×1; double for ×2)

- [ ] Kosher salt: about 6¼ tsp + 1 Tbsp for the pasta water · fine salt: 1½ tsp
- [ ] Dried oregano: 4½ tsp
- [ ] Onion powder: 2 tsp
- [ ] Garlic powder: 1½ tsp
- [ ] Black pepper: 1¾ tsp
- [ ] Smoked paprika: 1 tsp · ground cumin: ½ tsp · red pepper flakes: ¼ tsp

### WHAT'S LEFT OVER AFTER THIS WEEK

- 24 meatballs in the freezer (the point of this week).
- 3 cups of creamy tomato sauce (freezer 2 months), 1 chimichurri, 1 teriyaki (freezer 3 months).
- Most of the cream cheese block and some Parmesan: use by the package date.
- 4 oz pasta from the box: pantry.

## What this week costs

| Week 3 | 1 person | 2 people | Average per plate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shopping total | **$71.36** | **$142.72** | $4.84 |

This total includes the 4 extra freezer portions, so it buys more than one week of food.

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs and dairy: latest month available; fruit and vegetables: 2023 annual averages) plus reference prices for pantry items. Your store will differ.*

**YOUR ACTION**

- [ ] Clear freezer space before you shop: 2 boxes, 1 burrito, 1 flat bag of meatballs.
- [ ] Write the date on the meatball bag: _____. Use by: _____ (3 months).
- [ ] Pick the week you'll use the reserve: _____.

_____

_____

_____

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition). USDA FSIS, "Leftovers and Food Safety", "Freezing and Food Safety", "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov). FDA, 9 major food allergens.*

CHAPTER 11

# Week 4 · The Mix-It-Yourself Week

> **"It would be nice if prep and recipe and serving sizes were all together so you could pick and chose recipes to batch cook together. There is no deviating from the set weeks."**
>
> — reader review

Three weeks in, you've followed three sheets. This week is half filled in. Everything is set except one sauce, and you choose it. The point isn't the sauce. It's learning how a choice moves through the sheet, the shopping list and the boxes, so that after this week you can plan your own.

**Who it's for:** you've done at least one plan week and you want to stop depending on the book.

**What comes out:** 10 boxes and 5 breakfasts. One protein is tofu, so this week is lighter on meat.

**Raw meat this week:** about 3.5 lb (1.6 kg) for one person: 3 lb pork shoulder after trimming (buy about 3¾ lb) and 8 oz ground turkey for the egg bites. Plus 2 lb of tofu.

## The week at a glance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Proteins** | P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder · P9 Crispy Baked Tofu |
| **Bases** | B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice · B2 Fluffy Quinoa |
| **Vegetables** | V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) · V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli |
| **Sauces** | S6 Gochujang-Honey · S5 Peanut-Ginger · **your choice** (default: S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde) |
| **Breakfast** | D2 Turkey & Pepper Egg Bites |
| **Oven** | 300 °F (pork, before you start) → 450 °F → 425 °F → 350 °F |
| **Stove** | 1 medium pot with lid, 1 skillet, 1-2 small saucepans |
| **Session** | About 2 hours at the counter. The pork goes in about 4½ hours earlier and roasts alone. |
| **Freezer** | Friday's 2 boxes go in on Sunday |

## Step 1 · Choose your sauce

The sauce goes on **M5**, the pulled pork + rice + slaw plate. A sauce can go there if it shares a flavor family with all three parts (Chapter 16, Mix & Match). Pulled pork works with Mexican, Asian and Comfort. Rice works with all four. The slaw works with Asian, Mexican and Comfort. So any Mexican, Asian or Comfort sauce fits.

S5 and S6 are already in this week. Pick one of these:

| Sauce | Family | Your M5 box: kcal · protein | Adds allergens | Sheet slot | Freezes? |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde (default) | Mexican | 660 · 51 g | none | Broiler 12 min + blender, at 1:32 | yes, 3 months |
| S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt | Mexican | 670 · 54 g | milk | Cold, 5 min, at 1:10 | no |
| S3 Quick Red Enchilada | Mexican | 670 · 51 g | wheat | Stove, 15 min, at 1:10 | yes, 3 months |
| S4 Lighter Teriyaki | Asian | 680 · 51 g | soy, wheat, sesame | Stove, 12 min, at 1:10 | yes, 3 months |
| S10 Smoky BBQ | Comfort | 680 · 51 g | fish (Worcestershire) | Stove, 20 min, at 1:10 | yes, 3 months |
| S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt | Comfort | 680 · 53 g | milk | Cold, 5 min, at 1:10 | no |
| S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic | Comfort | 700 · 52 g | milk | Stove, 15 min, at 1:10 | yes, 2 months |

The M5 box already contains sesame, soy and wheat (from the slaw dressing). *Box numbers calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy for this week's box sizes.*

**My sauce this week:** _____ (ID ____ )

Now three things change, and you'll make each change yourself:

1. **The sheet:** write your sauce in the row marked ✎ below.
2. **The shopping list:** cross out the S2 lines and add your sauce's ingredients (they're on its recipe card, Chapter 15).
3. **The menu:** write your M5 numbers from the table above.

## The Sunday Sheet · Week 4

**About 4½ hours before 0:00 (15 minutes):** oven to **300 °F / 150 °C.** Trim the pork. Rub it with the sugar and spices. Into a Dutch oven or deep dish with the vinegar and ½ cup water around it. Cover tightly. Roast 4-4½ hours. You're free until 0:00.

**Before 0:00 (about 10 minutes):** line 2 sheet pans with parchment. Grease 15 muffin cups. Get out an 8×8-inch (20 cm) dish with foil, the scale, thermometer, 10 boxes, 6 dressing cups, 10 sauce cups, 5 breakfast containers. Fill the kettle.

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | OVEN | **Pork out.** Rest 20 min, covered. Oven to **450 °F / 230 °C**. | *195-205 °F / 90-96 °C, a fork twists in with no resistance* | P7 |
| 0:00 | PREP ⏱ | Drain the tofu, wrap in towels, press under a heavy pan for 20 min. Cut broccoli into florets, dry, toss with oil, salt, garlic powder on pan 1. | *Florets dry* | P9, V1 |
| 0:05 | STOVE ⏱ | Pot: rinse quinoa 30 sec, 3 cups water, oil, salt. Boil, lowest heat, lid on, 14-16 min. Off heat 5 min, lid on. | *Water gone, white spiral tails* | B2 |
| 0:10 | STOVE ⏱ | Skillet, medium-high: onion + red pepper 3 min, then turkey, paprika, half the salt 5-6 min. Drain. Cool. | *No pink. **165 °F / 74 °C*** | D2 |
| 0:12 | OVEN | **Broccoli in.** Timer: 18 min. | — | V1 |
| 0:20 | PREP ⏱ | Shred the pork with 2 forks. Skim the fat from the juices. Toss the pork with ½ cup juices. | *Shreds with no effort* | P7 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:25 | PREP ⏱ | Tofu: cut ¾-inch cubes. Soy sauce + oil, then spices, then cornstarch. Spread on pan 2. Kettle on: 2¼ cups. Rinse the rice. | *Cubes look dry, no white clumps* | P9, B1 |
| 0:30-0:34 | OVEN | **Broccoli out** (18-22 min). Oven to **425 °F / 220 °C**, door open 1 min. | *Tips blackened in spots* | V1 |
| 0:34 | OVEN | **Tofu in. Rice in** (rice, oil, salt, boiling water, foil crimped tight). Timers: tofu flip at 15 min, rice 25 min. | — | P9, B1 |
| 0:35 | STOVE ⏱ | Saucepan: gochujang sauce, medium-low 2-3 min, then 1 min more. Off heat, sesame oil. | *Glossy, slightly thicker* | S6 |
| 0:45 | COLD ⏱ | Slaw: shred cabbage thin, grate carrots, slice scallions. Whisk the dressing in a jar. **Keep them apart.** | — | V5 |
| 0:49 | OVEN | Flip the tofu. Timer: 15 min. | — | P9 |
| 0:55 | COLD ⏱ | Peanut-ginger: whisk, then warm water 1 Tbsp at a time. | *Smooth ribbon* | S5 |
| 0:59-1:04 | OVEN | **Rice out** (check at 25 min), leave covered 10 min. **Tofu out** (15-18 min after the flip). | *Water gone, steam holes · golden, sounds hollow when tapped* | B1, P9 |

| Clock | Station | Do this | Done when | Recipe |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1:05** | **OVEN** | Oven to **350 °F / 175 °C**, door open 2-3 min. Whisk eggs + salt + pepper. Turkey mix and cheddar into the cups, egg to ¾. **Egg bites in.** Timer: 20 min. | — | D2 |
| **1:10** | ✎ YOUR SAUCE | **Cold or stove sauce:** make it now. **S2:** wait for 1:32. Sauce: _____ | *(see its card)* | ____ |
| **1:15** | **ASSEMBLY** ⏱ | Fluff the rice and spread it thin. Into the fridge within 1 hour. Weigh each batch, divide by its box count (table below). Fill the boxes. | — | all |
| **1:25-1:30** | **OVEN** | **Egg bites out** (20-24 min). Cool 5 min in the tin, lift out. | *Set in the middle, knife clean.* ***160 °F / 71 °C*** | D2 |
| **1:32** | **OVEN** | **Only if S2:** broiler on high. Tomatillos, jalapeño, onion, garlic 5-7 min, flip, 4-5 min. Cool 5, blend. | *Blistered and slumped* | S2 |
| **1:50** | **ASSEMBLY** | Sauces and slaw dressing into cups. Lids, labels. Fridge for Mon-Thu, **freezer for Friday's A7 + A12**. Egg bites: 3 per container once fully cool. | *Fridge 40 °F / 4 °C or below* | all |

**Write your real time here:** start _____ finish _____ total _____ min (not counting the pork's 4½ hours alone in the oven).

*Why the pork goes in early:* at 300 °F it holds the oven for 4-4½ hours, and nothing else in this week cooks at 300 °F. Roasting it before the session frees the oven for the hot trays. Don't roast it on Saturday: that makes Thursday day 5.

To print: this Sunday Sheet and the shopping list are in the printable pack (pages 5 and 10), one page each.

# The assembly table

| Part | Boxes it fills | Per box (×1) | Goes into |
|---|---|---|---|
| P7 pulled pork | 6 | about 130 g (4½ oz) + juices | A3, M5, A12 |
| P9 tofu | 4 | about 170 g (6 oz) | A2, A7 |
| B1 rice | 6 | about 133 g (4¾ oz) | A3, M5, A7 |
| B2 quinoa | 4 | about 210 g (7½ oz) | A2, A12 |
| V5 slaw | 6 | about 108 g (3¾ oz) + ⅙ of the dressing in a cup | A3, M5, A2 |
| V1 broccoli | 4 | about 162 g (5¾ oz) | A7, A12 |
| S6 gochujang (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | 30 g | A3, A7 |
| S5 peanut-ginger (cup) | 4 + 1 spare | about 37 g | A2, A12 |
| ✎ your sauce (cup) | 2 + 3 spare | one card portion | M5 |
| D2 egg bites | 5 containers | 3 bites | breakfast |

**×2:** double every batch, 20 boxes, same amounts. Two pork shoulders fit in one large roasting pan if they don't touch. Tofu ×2 needs 2 pans.

# The menu

| Day | Lunch | Dinner | Breakfast | Stored |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | A3 | A2 | D2 | fridge |
| Tue | M5 ✎ | A12 | D2 | fridge |
| Wed | A3 | A2 | D2 | fridge |
| Thu | M5 ✎ | A7 | D2 | fridge · **move Friday's boxes to the fridge in the morning** |
| Fri | A7 | A12 | D2 | **freezer on Sunday** |

| Plate | Name | Parts | Your box: kcal · protein | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| A3 | Gochujang Pulled Pork Rice Bowl | P7 + B1 + V5 + S6 | 680 kcal · 51 g | soy, wheat, sesame |
| M5 | Pulled Pork Salsa Verde Bowl with Crunch Slaw (default) | P7 + B1 + V5 + S2 | 660 kcal · 51 g | soy, wheat, sesame |
| M5 ✎ | Your version: P7 + B1 + V5 + _____ | | _____ kcal · _____ g | _____ |
| A2 | Peanut-Ginger Tofu Crunch Bowl | P9 + B2 + V5 + S5 | 880 kcal · 55 g | peanuts, soy, wheat, sesame |
| A7 | Sticky Gochujang Tofu & Broccoli | P9 + B1 + V1 + S6 | 780 kcal · 51 g | soy, wheat, sesame |
| A12 | Peanut Pulled Pork Power Bowl | P7 + B2 + V1 + S5 | 860 kcal · 64 g | peanuts, soy, wheat, sesame |
| D2 | Turkey & Pepper Egg Bites (3 bites) | breakfast | 280 kcal · 24 g | egg, milk |

**Per day with the default S2 (2 boxes + breakfast):** Mon and Wed 1,840 kcal · 130 g protein. Tue 1,800 · 139 g. Thu 1,720 · 126 g. Fri 1,920 · 139 g. **Week average:** about 1,820 kcal and 133 g protein a day. Other sauces change Tue and Thu by 10-40 kcal. That's what the boxes hold, not a target.

*Calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy for the box sizes above. Kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g.*

**Allergens this week:** peanuts, soy, wheat, sesame, egg, milk, plus whatever your sauce adds. Many gochujang brands contain wheat. **If anyone eating this week has a peanut allergy, skip S5:** use S6 on A2 and A12 instead, and keep the peanut-ginger sauce out of the kitchen that day.

## The day-5 rule, applied

- **Friday = A7 + A12, frozen on Sunday.** Tofu, pork, rice, quinoa, gochujang sauce and peanut sauce freeze. The broccoli is safe frozen but softer. Re-crisp the tofu 6-8 min at 400 °F / 205 °C after thawing (the microwave makes it soft).

- **The raw slaw doesn't freeze.** That's why every slaw plate (A3, M5, A2) is Monday to Thursday. Dress it on the day.
- **If you chose S1 or S11:** they don't freeze, and they're fine here because M5 is on Tuesday and Thursday.
- **Thursday morning:** move Friday's boxes to the fridge.

## Shopping list · Week 4

**×1** = 10 boxes + 5 breakfasts. **×2** = 20 boxes + 10 breakfasts. The **S2** lines are marked: cross them out if you chose another sauce and add that sauce's card ingredients. Common US package sizes; yours may differ.

### MEAT

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Boneless pork shoulder (butt) | about 3¾ lb (3 lb / 1.36 kg after trimming) | about 7½ lb (6 lb after trimming) |
| ☐ | 93% lean ground turkey | 8 oz (227 g) | 1 lb (454 g) |

## PRODUCE

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Extra-firm tofu | 2 blocks, 14-16 oz each (908 g) | 4 blocks |
| ☐ | Broccoli crowns | 2 lb (900 g), about 2 large | 4 lb (1.8 kg) |
| ☐ | Green cabbage | ½ small head (about 1 lb / 450 g) | 1 small head (about 2 lb) |
| ☐ | Carrots | 2 large | 4 large |
| ☐ | Scallions | 3: one bunch | 6: one bunch |
| ☐ | Red bell pepper | 1 medium | 2 medium |
| ☐ | Yellow onion | 1 small (¼ cup diced) | 1 small |
| ☐ | Garlic | 3 cloves (+1 for S2): 1 head | 1 head |
| ☐ | Fresh ginger | 1 small knob (2 tsp grated) | same knob (4 tsp) |
| ☐ | Limes | 1 (1 Tbsp juice; +1 tsp for S2) | 2 |
| ☐ | **S2** Tomatillos | 3-4 medium (6 oz / 170 g) | 6-8 (12 oz) |
| ☐ | **S2** Jalapeño | 1 | 2 |
| ☐ | **S2** White onion | 1 small (you use ¼) | 1 small |
| ☐ | **S2** Cilantro | 1 bunch (¼ cup packed) | 1 bunch |

## DAIRY & EGGS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Large eggs | 10 | 20 |

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Shredded sharp cheddar | ½ cup (2 oz / 55 g) | 1 cup: one 8-oz bag |

## PANTRY & CONDIMENTS

| | Item | ×1 | ×2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Long-grain white rice | 1½ cups (10 oz / 278 g) | 3 cups |
| ☐ | Quinoa | 1½ cups (9 oz / 255 g) | 3 cups |
| ☐ | Smooth peanut butter, no sugar added | ¼ cup | ½ cup |
| ☐ | Gochujang | 3 Tbsp: one tub | 6 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Soy sauce (regular) | ¼ cup | ½ cup |
| ☐ | Reduced-sodium soy sauce | 2 Tbsp | ¼ cup |
| ☐ | Apple cider vinegar | 7 Tbsp (+ 1 Tbsp rice or cider vinegar for S6) | about 1 cup |
| ☐ | Honey | 3 Tbsp | 6 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Brown sugar | 1 Tbsp | 2 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Cornstarch | 3 Tbsp | 6 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Toasted sesame oil | 1 Tbsp + 1½ tsp | 3 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Toasted sesame seeds | 1 Tbsp | 2 Tbsp |
| ☐ | Sriracha | ½ tsp | 1 tsp |
| ☐ | Olive oil | 6 Tbsp + 1 tsp | ¾ cup + 2 tsp |
| ☐ | Canola oil | 1 Tbsp + spray for the tin | 2 Tbsp + spray |

**Spice check** (week total for ×1; double for ×2)

- [ ] Kosher salt: 5¼ tsp · fine salt: about 1 tsp (⅓ tsp of it for S2)
- [ ] Smoked paprika: 4½ tsp
- [ ] Garlic powder: 4 tsp
- [ ] Ground cumin: 2 tsp
- [ ] Black pepper: 1¾ tsp
- [ ] Ground ginger: ½ tsp

#### WHAT'S LEFT OVER AFTER THIS WEEK

- 3 cups of your sauce, 1 gochujang, 1 peanut-ginger. Check each card for freezer time.
- Most of the gochujang tub: it keeps for months in the fridge once opened (check the label).
- Salsa verde from Week 2 still in the freezer? Use it here instead of making S2 and skip the S2 lines.

## What this week costs

| Week 4 | 1 person | 2 people | Average per plate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shopping total | **$39.63** | **$79.26** | $3.23 |

Priced with the default sauce. Swapping the sauce changes the total by cents, not dollars.

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs and dairy: latest month available; fruit and vegetables: 2023 annual averages) plus reference prices for pantry items. Your store will differ.*

YOUR ACTION

### Plan Week 5 yourself

You just made the three changes a plan needs: the sheet, the list and the menu. Next week, do it from a blank page.

1. Take the blank Sunday Sheet (Chapter 23).
2. Pick 2 proteins, 2 bases, 2 vegetables and 3 sauces from the Mix & Match chart (Chapter 16). Keep at most one protein that needs a long, slow oven.
3. Copy each recipe's "Sunday-sheet slot" into the oven, stove and cold columns, hottest oven first.
4. Run the day-5 rule: which 2 boxes freeze on Sunday? Do their parts freeze?

| Week 5 | Choice |
| --- | --- |
| Proteins | |
| Bases | |
| Vegetables | |
| Sauces | |
| Friday's frozen plate | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition). USDA FSIS, "Leftovers and Food Safety", "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart" (fsis.usda.gov). FDA, 9 major food allergens.*

# 3

PART 3

# Recipes

12 · Proteins

13 · Bases

14 · Vegetables

15 · Sauces · The Variety Engine

16 · 48 Signature Plates + the Mix & Match Chart

17 · Breakfasts

18 · The Freezer Block · 10 One-Pot Meals

19 · High-Protein Snacks

CHAPTER 12

# Proteins

> **"This book calls for 4-5 lbs of meat minimum, each week."**
>
> — reader review

Ten proteins, cooked once and used across the week. Six are meat or fish. One (P5) stretches 1 lb of beef with lentils. Three don't need meat at all: tofu (P9), chickpeas (P10) and the egg-based breakfasts in Chapter 17.

### HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK

- Pick 2 proteins per week. One from the oven, one from the stove or slow cooker, so they don't fight for space.
- Check the **Families** column: it tells you which sauces each protein goes with (Chapter 16).
- Every card ends with **Swap**: a cheaper cut, a different meat, or an allergy-friendly version.
- The chickpeas give 11 g of protein per portion. That's the real number; pair them with a higher-protein breakfast or snack if protein matters to you.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens | Families |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| P1 | Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs | 136 g | 280 | 36 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | all |
| P2 | Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken | 140 g | 270 | 46 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX, COM |
| P3 | Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast | 150 g | 270 | 45 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | all |
| P4 | Turkey Taco Crumble | 140 g | 330 | 35 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX |
| P5 | Beef & Lentil Power Mince | 160 g | 330 | 27 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX, MED, COM |
| P6 | Freezer Turkey Meatballs | 156 g | 360 | 39 g | 4 days | 3 mo | milk, egg, wheat | MED, COM, ASI |
| P7 | Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder | 156 g | 430 | 54 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX, COM, ASI |
| P8 | Simple Baked Salmon | 146 g | 410 | 37 g | 3 days | 2 mo | fish | all |
| P9 | Crispy Baked Tofu | 136 g | 340 | 32 g | 4 days | 2 mo | soy, wheat | ASI, MEX, MED |
| P10 | Smoky Spiced Chickpeas | 140 g | 260 | 11 g | 4 days | 2 mo | — | MED, MEX |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Your choice for next week:** protein 1 _____ · protein 2 _____

PROTEIN

# P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs

**Makes** 5 portions (about 136 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 40 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 280 KCAL | 36 g PROTEIN | 2 g CARBS | 13 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.60 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60-90 sec, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M1, A1, A8, D-1, D-8, C1, C7 · flavour families MEX, ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 lb boneless skinless chicken thighs (907 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 3 tbsp lemon juice (45 g)
- 4 cloves, minced garlic cloves (12 g)
- 1 tsp dried oregano (1.5 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Line a rimmed sheet pan with parchment.
2. Whisk the oil, lemon juice, garlic, oregano, paprika, salt and pepper in a large bowl. Add the thighs and toss until every piece is coated. Leave 10 minutes, or up to 8 hours in the fridge.
3. Spread the thighs in one layer with space between them. Do not stack.
4. Roast 22-28 minutes. Done when the edges are browned, the juices run clear and a thermometer in the thickest piece reads 165 °F / 74 °C.
5. Rest 5 minutes on the pan. Slice into strips or bite-size pieces.
6. Portion into 5 containers (about 135 g each). Cool for up to 1 hour at room temperature, then refrigerate.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0. Goes in first, comes out at minute 25-28, then rests while you fill the oven with the next tray.

### SWAP

Use bone-in thighs (about 2.75 lb, add 10 minutes) or chicken breast cut into 1-inch strips (cook 15-18 minutes). For no lemon, use 1 tbsp red wine vinegar.

### FIX IT

- Pale and wet instead of browned: the pan was crowded or the oven was cool. Put it back 5 minutes under the broiler, watching it closely.
- Dry? Thighs forgive, but if they went past 185 °F, toss the slices with a spoon of the pan juices before storing.

PROTEIN

# P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken

**Makes** 5 portions (about 140 g cooked each) | **Active** 10 min | **Total** 250 min

| 270 KCAL | 46 g PROTEIN | 7 g CARBS | 6 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.45 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of its cooking juices, stir halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M2, M9, M11, C8 · flavour families MEX, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2.2 lb boneless skinless chicken breasts (1000 g)
- 1 1/2 cups (1 jar, 16 oz) jarred salsa (medium) (360 g)
- 2 tsp ground cumin (4 g)
- 2 tsp chili powder (5 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 2 tbsp lime juice (30 g)

## STEPS

1. Lay the chicken breasts in the slow cooker in one layer if you can. Sprinkle with cumin, chili powder, garlic powder and salt.
2. Pour the salsa over the top. Do not add water: the chicken gives off its own liquid.
3. Cover. Cook on LOW 6-7 hours or HIGH 3-4 hours. Done when a thermometer in the thickest breast reads 165 °F / 74 °C and a fork shreds it with no effort.
4. Move the chicken to a bowl. Shred with two forks or by beating it 20 seconds with a hand mixer.
5. Stir in the lime juice and 1/2 cup of the cooking liquid. Taste and add a pinch of salt if needed.
6. Portion into 5 containers (about 140 g each) with a spoonful of juices on each so it stays moist.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Slow cooker, minute 0. It works alone for 3-4 hours on HIGH, so start it before anything else. It never touches the oven or the stove.

### SWAP

Use boneless thighs (same weight, shred more tender) or a green salsa (tomatillo) for a milder, tangy version. Low on money: bone-in breasts, 3 lb, shredded after cooking.

### FIX IT

- Watery? Simmer the leftover liquid 5 minutes in a pan, or just use less when mixing back in.
- Stringy and dry: it cooked too long on HIGH. Next time check at 3 hours, and always mix the juices back in.

PROTEIN

# P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast

**Makes** 5 portions (about 150 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 45 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 270 KCAL | 45 g PROTEIN | 1 g CARBS | 8 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.90 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Microwave at 70% power for 60-90 sec, or slice and warm in a covered pan with a splash of water. Never full power for long.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes A5, A11, D-4, D-11, C4, C9 · flavour families MEX, ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2.2 lb boneless skinless chicken breasts (1000 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Salt the chicken (the 1 tsp) on both sides 15-30 minutes before cooking, or overnight in the fridge. This is a dry brine.
2. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Place a chicken breast between plastic wrap or in a bag and pound the thick end with a pan or rolling pin until it is an even 3/4 inch / 2 cm thick. Do all breasts.
3. Rub with the oil, then the pepper, garlic powder and paprika. Lay on a lined sheet pan, with space between them.
4. Bake 16-20 minutes. Start checking at 14. Done when a thermometer in the thickest part reads 160 °F / 71 °C, then it carries up to 165 °F / 74 °C as it rests.
5. Rest covered with foil for 5-10 minutes. Cutting early lets the juices run out.
6. Slice against the grain. Portion into 5 containers (150 g each) and drizzle any pan juices on top.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 25. Can share the oven with a veg tray at the same 425 °F / 220 °C.

### SWAP

Use thin-sliced breast cutlets (bake 10-12 minutes) to save pounding. Swap the spices for 2 tsp Italian seasoning or taco seasoning for a different family.

### FIX IT

- Rubbery or dry: it went past 165 °F or the breasts were uneven. Pound them flat next time and use the thermometer, not the clock.
- White and wet on the surface: pat the chicken dry before the oil goes on.

PROTEIN

# P4 Turkey Taco Crumble

**Makes** 5 portions (about 140 g cooked each) | **Active** 20 min | **Total** 25 min

| 330 KCAL | 35 g PROTEIN | 7 g CARBS | 19 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.50 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 90 sec, stirring halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M3, M10 · flavour families MEX

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 lb 93% lean ground turkey (907 g)
- 1 medium, finely diced yellow onion (150 g)
- 3 cloves, minced garlic cloves (9 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 2 tbsp tomato paste (32 g)
- 2 tbsp chili powder (16 g)
- 2 tsp ground cumin (4 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 1 tsp dried oregano (1.5 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (9 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the onion and a pinch of salt. Cook 4-5 minutes until soft and see-through.
2. Add the garlic, chili powder, cumin, paprika and oregano. Stir 30 seconds until it smells toasty.
3. Add the turkey. Break it up with a wooden spoon or a potato masher. Cook 7-9 minutes until no pink is left and it reaches 165 °F / 74 °C (ground turkey is safe at 165 °F).
4. Stir in the tomato paste, the salt and 1/2 cup water. Simmer 3-4 minutes until the liquid has mostly cooked off and the meat looks glossy, not soupy.
5. Cool for 20 minutes, spread out in a wide dish. Portion into 5 containers (about 140 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, one large skillet, minute 0 to 20. Frees the pan for a second batch of anything.

### SWAP

Use 93% lean ground chicken (same weight) or ground beef (90%, adds fat and a little protein). Out of chili powder: 1 tbsp taco seasoning replaces the three spices.

### FIX IT

- Dry and crumbly: add 2-3 tbsp water and simmer 1 minute, then do the same when you reheat.
- Bland: more salt and a squeeze of lime at reheat. Turkey needs more salt than beef.

PROTEIN

# P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince

**Makes** 5 portions (about 160 g cooked each) | **Active** 20 min | **Total** 50 min

| 330 KCAL | 27 g PROTEIN | 27 g CARBS | 13 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.10 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 90 sec, stirring halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M4, M12, D-6, C5, C10 · flavour families MEX, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 lb 90% lean ground beef (454 g)
- 3/4 cup (150 g) dry brown lentils (150 g)
- 1 medium, diced yellow onion (150 g)
- 1 large, finely diced carrots (100 g)
- 3 cloves, minced garlic cloves (9 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 2 tbsp tomato paste (32 g)
- 2 tsp ground cumin (4 g)
- 2 tsp smoked paprika (5 g)
- 1 tsp chili powder (2.7 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (9 g)

## STEPS

1. Rinse the lentils in a sieve and pick out any stones.
2. Heat the oil in a large pot over medium-high. Add the beef and break it up. Cook 6-8 minutes until browned and no pink is left (160 °F / 71 °C).
3. Add the onion and carrot. Cook 5 minutes until the onion is soft.
4. Add the garlic, tomato paste and spices. Stir 1 minute until the paste darkens a shade.
5. Add the lentils, the salt and 3 cups water. Bring to a boil, then lower to a steady simmer, partly covered.
6. Cook 22-28 minutes, stirring now and then. Done when the lentils are tender but not mushy and the pot is thick like chili, with almost no loose liquid. Add water 1/4 cup at a time if it dries too soon.
7. Cool, then portion into 5 containers (about 160 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, minute 0 to 45, one pot. Lentils simmer while you chop the rest. Lowest-cost protein of the book: 1 lb of beef covers 5 portions.

### SWAP

Use ground turkey in place of beef, or half the beef and a second 1/2 cup of lentils for the cheapest week. Red lentils cook in 12 minutes but go soft.

### FIX IT

- Hard lentils after 30 minutes: old lentils. Add 1/2 cup water and simmer 10 more minutes.
- Too wet: simmer uncovered 5 minutes. Too thick on day 3: loosen with a splash of water.

PROTEIN

# P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs

**Makes** 5 portions (about 156 g cooked each) **Active** 15 min **Total** 35 min

**Oven** 400 °F / 205 °C

| 360 | 39 g | 10 g | 18 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.45 | ALLERGENS<br>**milk, egg, wheat** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 6 meatballs 60-90 sec, or 12 min at 350 °F / 175 °C from frozen, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the centre.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes A6, A10, D-5, D-12, C3, C12 · flavour families MED, COM, ASI

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 lb 93% lean ground turkey (907 g)
- 1 large egg (50 g)
- 1/2 cup plain dry breadcrumbs (55 g)
- 1/4 cup (about 1 oz) grated Parmesan (28 g)
- 3 cloves, minced garlic cloves (9 g)
- 1 tsp onion powder (2.5 g)
- 1 tsp dried oregano (1.5 g)
- 2 tbsp, chopped fresh parsley (8 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (9 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 400 °F / 205 °C. Line a rimmed sheet pan with parchment.
2. In a large bowl, mix the egg, breadcrumbs, Parmesan, garlic, onion powder, oregano, parsley, salt and pepper. Let it sit 3 minutes so the crumbs soak up the egg.
3. Add the turkey. Mix with your hands only until it just comes together. Overmixing makes them tough.
4. Scoop 30 even balls (about 2 tbsp each, a bit over 1 oz / 35 g) and roll them smooth. Wet your hands if it sticks.
5. Place on the pan, close but not touching. Bake 18-20 minutes. Done when browned on top and a thermometer in the middle reads 165 °F / 74 °C.
6. Cool 15 minutes. Portion 6 meatballs per container (about 155 g). To freeze, lay on a tray for 1 hour, then bag.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 25. Freezer champion: double the batch and freeze the second half flat on a tray, then bag.

### SWAP

Gluten-free: swap the breadcrumbs for 1/2 cup rolled oats pulsed fine. Dairy-free: leave out the Parmesan and add 1/4 tsp more salt. Ground chicken works too.

### FIX IT

- Dry meatballs: you overmixed, or baked past 165 °F. Reheat them in a covered pan with a spoonful of sauce.
- Falling apart: the mix was too wet. Add 1 more tbsp breadcrumbs and chill 10 minutes.

PROTEIN

# P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder

**Makes** 5 portions (about 156 g cooked each) **Active** 15 min **Total** 300 min

**Oven** 300 °F / 150 °C

| 430 | 54 g | 5 g | 20 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.30 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of its juices until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M5, A3, A12, C2, C11 · flavour families MEX, COM, ASI

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3 lb, after trimming (buy about 3 3/4 lb) trimmed boneless pork shoulder (butt) (1361 g)
- 1 tbsp brown sugar (13 g)
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika (7 g)
- 2 tsp ground cumin (4 g)
- 2 tsp garlic powder (6 g)
- 2 1/2 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (15 g)
- 1 tsp black pepper (2 g)
- 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar (58 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 300 °F / 150 °C. Trim off the thick fat cap and any big fat seams you can reach with a knife (the macros here are for trimmed meat). Mix the sugar, paprika, cumin, garlic powder, salt and pepper. Rub it all over the pork.
2. Place the pork in a Dutch oven or a deep baking dish. Pour in the vinegar and 1/2 cup water around it, not over it.
3. Cover tightly with a lid or double foil. Roast 4 to 4 1/2 hours.
4. Done when a thermometer reads 195-205 °F / 90-96 °C and a fork twists in with no resistance. Safe at 145 °F, but it only shreds once the connective tissue melts at the higher temperature.
5. Rest 20 minutes, covered. Move to a board. Discard any bone and leftover fat. Shred with two forks.
6. Skim the fat from the pan juices. Toss the pork with 1/2 cup of the juices. Portion into 5 containers (about 155 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 270. Start it first. At 300 °F it blocks the oven for 4-4.5 hours, so P7 is a slow-Sunday protein: pair it with stovetop bases and cold veg, or cook it Saturday and shred on Sunday.

### SWAP

Same recipe in a slow cooker: LOW 8-10 hours, no extra liquid except the vinegar. Leaner and faster: use pork tenderloin (cook to 145 °F), but it will not be as juicy.

### FIX IT

- Pork will not shred: it needs more time. Re-cover and give it another 30-45 minutes.
- Dry after reheating: always store with its juices; add 1 tbsp water to the container before the microwave.

PROTEIN

# P8 Simple Baked Salmon

**Makes** 5 portions (about 146 g cooked each) **Active** 8 min **Total** 22 min

**Oven** 400 °F / 205 °C

| 410 KCAL | 37 g PROTEIN | 1 g CARBS | 27 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $4.50 | ALLERGENS<br>fish |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Eat cold, or microwave at 50% power 60-90 sec. Do not boil it; it dries and smells.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M8, A4, A9, D-3, D-10, C6 · flavour families MEX, ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 lb (skin-off or skin-on) Atlantic salmon fillets (907 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 1 tbsp lemon juice (15 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 3/4 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (4.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper (0.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 400 °F / 205 °C. Line a sheet pan with parchment.
2. Pat the salmon dry. Cut into 5 even portions (about 180 g raw each).
3. Place on the pan, skin side down. Rub with the oil, lemon juice, garlic powder, paprika, salt and pepper.
4. Bake 11-14 minutes. Done when the thickest part flakes with a fork and reads 145 °F / 63 °C. It should look opaque with a slight shine inside, not dry and chalky.
5. Rest 3 minutes. Cool for up to 1 hour at room temperature, then refrigerate in a sealed container.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 15. Quick tray: put it in last if the oven is busy, but eat it on days 1-2 of the week for best quality.

### SWAP

Use arctic char or steelhead trout (same weight). For a budget version, use canned salmon (14.75 oz cans) mixed with lemon, but the macros change.

### FIX IT

- White liquid on top (albumin): you cooked it hot and fast. Lower to 375 °F and shorten the time next batch.
- Smells fishy on day 4: it is past its best. Plan this protein for the first 2 days and freeze the rest the same day.

PROTEIN

# P9 Crispy Baked Tofu

**Makes** 5 portions (about 136 g cooked each) **Active** 15 min **Total** 55 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 340 KCAL | 32 g PROTEIN | 11 g CARBS | 21 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.30 | ALLERGENS<br>soy, wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Oven or air fryer, 400 °F / 205 °C for 6-8 minutes to bring back the crisp. Microwave makes it soft.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M6, A2, A7, D-7 · flavour families ASI, MEX, MED

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 blocks (16 oz / 454 g each), extra-firm extra-firm tofu (908 g)
- 3 tbsp cornstarch (24 g)
- 3 tbsp soy sauce (48 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Drain the tofu. Wrap in clean towels, set a heavy pan on top and press 20 minutes.
2. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Line a sheet pan with parchment.
3. Tear or cut the tofu into 3/4-inch / 2 cm cubes. Toss gently with the soy sauce and oil, then the garlic powder, paprika and pepper.
4. Sprinkle on the cornstarch and toss until the pieces look dry and lightly coated, with no white clumps.
5. Spread in one layer with space between pieces. Bake 15 minutes, flip, bake 15-18 minutes more.
6. Done when the outside is golden and firm, and a cube sounds hollow when you tap it. It crisps more as it cools. Portion into 5 containers (about 135 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 35 (after a 20-minute press that happens while you prep everything else).

### SWAP

Gluten-free: use tamari (check the label) instead of soy sauce. Use baked tempeh cubes for more protein per portion, or pressed cubes of extra-firm tofu with 1 tbsp more oil in an air fryer.

### FIX IT

- Soft, not crispy: not pressed enough, or the pan was crowded. Pat dry harder and use two pans.
- Stuck to the pan: the parchment was missing or you flipped too soon. Wait until the edge lifts easily.

PROTEIN

# P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas

**Makes** 5 portions (about 140 g cooked each) **Active** 8 min **Total** 35 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 260 KCAL | 11 g PROTEIN | 36 g CARBS | 9 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.60 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60 sec, or 5 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer to bring back the edges.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M7, D-2, D-9 · flavour families MED, MEX

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3 cans (15 oz), drained and rinsed canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed (750 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 2 tsp smoked paprika (5 g)
- 1 tsp ground cumin (2 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tbsp lemon juice (15 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C.
2. Drain and rinse the chickpeas. Spread on a towel and pat very dry. Dry beans roast. Wet beans steam.
3. Toss on a sheet pan with the oil, paprika, cumin, garlic powder and salt.
4. Roast 25-30 minutes, shaking the pan once at the halfway point. Done when the chickpeas are golden, shrunken a little and the skins split.
5. Toss with the lemon juice right out of the oven.
6. Cool, then portion into 5 containers (about 140 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 30. Cheapest protein in the book, and the only plant protein P with no pressing or soaking.

### SWAP

Use white beans or black beans (canned, rinsed). Skip the smoke with 2 tsp Italian seasoning for a Mediterranean version. Each portion has about 11 g of protein, about a third of the chicken recipes: pair it with a higher-protein sauce like Greek yogurt.

### FIX IT

- Soft in the fridge: normal, they take on moisture. Re-crisp them 5 minutes in the oven or air fryer.
- Burnt spice on the pan: the oven was too hot or the pan was dark. Lower to 400 °F / 205 °C and use parchment.

CHAPTER 13

# Bases

Rice, quinoa, potatoes, sweet potatoes, pasta and tortillas. The base is the part that usually ruins day 4: hard rice, mushy pasta, soggy potatoes. Each card is written to stop that.

**HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK**

- **Rice and quinoa:** cool them fast and spread thin (Chapter 4). Reheat with 1 Tbsp of water, covered.
- **Pasta:** cook it 1-2 minutes short, toss with oil. It finishes cooking when you reheat it.
- **Potatoes:** reheat in the oven or air fryer. The microwave makes them soft. Potatoes don't freeze well; sweet potatoes do.
- **Tortillas:** no cooking. Store them in a bag and roll the wrap at lunch, so it isn't soggy.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens | Families |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| B1 | Hands-Off Oven Rice | 160 g | 230 | 4 g | 4 days | 2 mo | — | all |
| B2 | Fluffy Quinoa | 168 g | 210 | 7 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | all |
| B3 | Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes | 170 g | 190 | 4 g | 4 days | no | — | MEX, MED, COM |
| B4 | Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes | 170 g | 220 | 3 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX, ASI, COM |
| B5 | Reheat-Ready Pasta | 150 g | 280 | 9 g | 4 days | 2 mo | wheat | COM, ASI, MED |
| B6 | Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) | 50 g | 150 | 4 g | 7 days | 2 mo | wheat | MEX, MED, COM |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Your choice:** base 1 _____ · base 2 _____

BASE

# B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice

**Makes** 5 portions (about 160 g cooked each) **Active** 5 min **Total** 45 min

**Oven** 375 °F / 190 °C

| 230 KCAL | 4 g PROTEIN | 44 g CARBS | 3 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.15 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of water, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M1, M2, M5, M8, M10, A1, A3, A6, A7, A9, D-1, D-6, D-10, C4, C11 · flavour families MEX, ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 1/2 cups long-grain white rice (278 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 375 °F / 190 °C. Boil 2 1/4 cups of water in a kettle or pot.
2. Rinse the rice in a sieve under cold water for 30 seconds. Drain well.
3. Put the rice, oil and salt in an 8x8-inch / 20 cm baking dish (or any dish with a tight lid). Pour in the boiling water and stir once.
4. Cover tightly with foil, crimping all the edges. Bake 25-30 minutes without opening it.
5. Done when all the water is absorbed and small steam holes show on the surface. Leave covered 10 minutes, then fluff with a fork.
6. Spread the rice out in a thin layer to cool, then portion into 5 containers (160 g each) within 1 hour of cooking. Refrigerate right away.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 30, then rest 10 minutes off. Fits next to a 425 °F tray if you cover it well; or cook it before the high-heat trays.

### SWAP

Brown rice: use 1 1/2 cups rice and 2 3/4 cups boiling water, bake 55-60 minutes. Cauliflower rice is not a swap in this recipe (it does not bake like rice).

### FIX IT

- Crunchy grains: the foil leaked steam. Add 2 tbsp hot water, re-cover and give it 10 minutes.
- Gummy: too much water or no rinse. Spread on a pan and dry 5 minutes in the oven.

BASE

# B2 Fluffy Quinoa

**Makes** 5 portions (about 168 g cooked each) **Active** 5 min **Total** 25 min

| 210 | 7 g | 33 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.50 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60-90 sec with a splash of water, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M6, A2, A4, A12, D-2, D-3, D-5, D-7 · flavour families ASI, MED, MEX, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 1/2 cups quinoa (255 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 3/4 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (4.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Rinse the quinoa in a fine sieve for 30 seconds, rubbing it with your hand. This removes the bitter coating.
2. Add the quinoa, 3 cups water, oil and salt to a medium pot. Bring to a boil.
3. Lower to the lowest heat, cover and cook 14-16 minutes. Done when the water is gone and you can see the little white spiral tails on each seed.
4. Take off the heat, keep the lid on and leave 5 minutes. Fluff with a fork.
5. Spread on a tray to cool 15 minutes. Portion into 5 containers (about 165 g each) and refrigerate within 1 hour.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, minute 0 to 20, one pot with a lid. Hands free after the first 5 minutes.

### SWAP

Use millet or couscous in the same weight if quinoa is too pricey. Cheaper: half quinoa, half rice, cooked separately.

### FIX IT

- Mushy: too much water or you lifted the lid. Next time stick to 2 cups of water per 1 cup of quinoa.
- Bitter: it was not rinsed enough.

BASE

# B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes

**Makes** 5 portions (about 170 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 45 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 190 | 4 g | 33 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.50 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Oven or air fryer, 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 minutes. Microwave makes them soft. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M9, M12, D-11, C1, C5, C6 · flavour families MEX, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2.2 lb baby red potatoes, halved (1000 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Put the empty sheet pan in the oven to heat.
2. Halve the potatoes (quarter any bigger than a golf ball). Dry them with a towel.
3. Toss in a bowl with the oil, salt, garlic powder, paprika and pepper.
4. Carefully tip onto the hot pan, cut sides down. They should sizzle.
5. Roast 20 minutes, flip, then roast 15-20 minutes more. Done when the cut sides are deep golden and a knife slides in with no push.
6. Cool, then portion into 5 containers (about 170 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 40 (long tray, so put it in first). Goes on the lower rack at 425 °F / 220 °C.

### SWAP

Use Yukon Gold potatoes cut into 1-inch chunks. Not good for the freezer: they turn grainy and watery.

### FIX IT

- Soggy: they were wet or the pan was crowded. Dry them and use two pans.
- Hard centres, burnt edges: pieces were uneven. Cut to the same size, and give the big ones 10 minutes extra.

BASE

# B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes

**Makes** 5 portions (about 170 g cooked each) **Active** 15 min **Total** 45 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 220 | 3 g | 41 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.60 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60-90 sec, covered, or 8 minutes in a 400 °F / 205 °C oven to re-crisp.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M3, A5, A11, D-8, C2, C12 · flavour families MEX, ASI, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2.2 lb (about 3 medium), peeled, 3/4-inch cubes sweet potatoes (1000 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Line a pan with parchment.
2. Peel the sweet potatoes and cut into 3/4-inch / 2 cm cubes. Keep them the same size so they cook evenly.
3. Toss with the oil, salt, paprika and pepper. Spread in one layer, not touching.
4. Roast 15 minutes, flip, then roast 12-15 minutes more.
5. Done when the edges are browned and caramelised, and a fork slides into the centre with no resistance.
6. Cool, then portion into 5 containers (about 170 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 35. Needs one flip. Works on the same rack as other 425 °F trays.

### SWAP

Butternut squash cubes work in the same time. For a sweeter finish, add 1/2 tsp cinnamon in place of the paprika.

### FIX IT

- Soft and no browning: the pan was crowded. Use two pans or reduce to a single layer.
- Burnt edges, hard middle: cubes too large. Next time cut to 3/4 inch.

BASE

# B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta

**Makes** 5 portions (about 150 g cooked each) **Active** 5 min **Total** 20 min

| 280 KCAL | 9 g PROTEIN | 51 g CARBS | 4 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.30 | ALLERGENS<br>wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60-90 sec with 1 tbsp of water or sauce, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes A8, A10, C3, C7, C10 · flavour families COM, ASI, MED

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 12 oz (340 g) penne or fusilli short dry pasta (penne or fusilli) (340 g)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (14 g)
- 1 tbsp (for the water; only part is absorbed) kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)

## STEPS

1. Bring 3 quarts / 3 L of water to a rolling boil. Add the salt.
2. Add the pasta. Cook 1-2 minutes LESS than the package says. It must still have a firm centre, since it cooks more when you reheat it.
3. Check by biting a piece: you should see a thin white dot in the centre.
4. Drain. Do not rinse. Toss right away with the oil so the pieces do not stick together.
5. Spread on a tray to cool 15 minutes. Portion into 5 containers (about 150 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, minute 0 to 15 while the oven trays roast. Boil the water first thing so it is ready.

### SWAP

Gluten-free: use a corn-and-rice pasta and cook 2 minutes less. Higher protein: use chickpea or lentil pasta (this changes the macros, recalculate).

### FIX IT

- Clumped together in the fridge: not enough oil. Add a splash of water on reheat and break up with a fork.
- Mushy after reheating: it was overcooked to start with. Pull it 2 minutes early next time.

BASE

# B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble)

**Makes** 5 portions (about 50 g cooked each) **Active** 5 min **Total** 5 min

| 150 | 4 g | 25 g | 4 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.35 | ALLERGENS<br>wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>7 days (opened package) | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Warm 15 seconds per side in a dry pan, or 10 seconds in the microwave wrapped in a damp towel. Assemble the wrap at lunch.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M4, M7, M11, D-4, D-9, D-12, C8, C9 · flavour families MEX, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 5 flour tortillas, 8-inch flour tortillas (8-inch) (250 g)

## STEPS

1. Check the date on the package. Keep the tortillas in the fridge once opened.
2. Stack the tortillas in two groups, with a square of parchment between each.
3. Slide them into a zip bag and press out the air. For 5 days, one bag is enough.
4. To freeze beyond a week: wrap in foil, then a freezer bag. Defrost overnight in the fridge.
5. Assemble the wrap on the day. Warm the tortilla, then fill with 1 protein portion, a vegetable portion and a spoonful of sauce, and fold in the sides before rolling.
6. For a lunch you take with you: pack the filling in a container and the tortilla in a bag, and assemble at lunch to avoid sogginess.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

No cooking at all. Minute 0: portion and wrap. Do this while the oven works.

### SWAP

Use corn tortillas (6-inch, 2 per portion) for gluten-free tacos, or low-carb wraps, but check the label. Check macros for any wrap that is not plain flour.

### FIX IT

- Cracks when you fold it: it is cold or dry. Warm 15 seconds in a dry pan to make it bendable.
- Soggy by lunch: the filling was wet. Keep sauce in its own cup and add it at the last minute.

CHAPTER 14

# Vegetables

Four roasted, two raw. Roasted vegetables cook hot and fast so they don't turn to mush by Thursday. Raw ones are cut and dressed separately so they stay crisp.

### HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK

- **Space on the pan is the whole trick.** One layer, pieces not touching. Crowded vegetables steam and go limp. Use a second pan.
- **Broccoli roasts hottest** (450 °F). Do it first on Sunday, then lower the oven.
- **Zucchini (V3) and the cucumber-tomato salad (V6) keep 3 days, not 4.** Plan them for Monday-Wednesday.
- **Dressings stay apart** until you eat (V5, V6).
- Most vegetables don't freeze well. The fajita peppers (V2) are the exception.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens | Families |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V1 | Charred Roasted Broccoli | 130 g | 110 | 5 g | 4 days | no | — | all |
| V2 | Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions | 130 g | 110 | 2 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX |
| V3 | Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion | 130 g | 90 | 2 g | 3 days | no | — | MEX, MED, COM |
| V4 | Garlic Green Beans | 120 g | 100 | 3 g | 4 days | no | — | ASI, MED, COM |
| V5 | Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) | 130 g | 110 | 2 g | 4 days | no | sesame, soy, wheat | ASI, MEX, COM |
| V6 | Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) | 180 g | 80 | 2 g | 3 days | no | — | MED, MEX |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Your choice:** vegetable 1 _____ · vegetable 2 _____

VEGETABLE

# V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli

**Makes** 5 portions (about 130 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 30 min

**Oven** 450 °F / 230 °C

| 110 | 5 g | 12 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.30 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |

REHEAT
Eat cold in bowls, or 10 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer. Microwave makes it soft but it is safe.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M10, M12, A1, A5, A7, A9, A12, D-7, D-8, D-11, C2, C6, C7 · flavour families MEX, ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 large crowns (about 2 lb), cut into florets broccoli crowns (900 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 450 °F / 230 °C.
2. Cut the broccoli into bite-size florets, with a flat cut side if possible. Cut thick stems into coins.
3. Dry well. Toss with the oil, salt and garlic powder.
4. Spread over a large pan with space between pieces. Place cut sides down.
5. Roast 18-22 minutes without stirring more than once. Done when the tips are blackened in spots, the stems pierce with a knife, and the florets look dark green and slightly shrunken.
6. Portion into 5 containers (about 130 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 22 at 450 °F / 230 °C. Hottest tray of the day. Do it first, then lower the oven for the rest.

### SWAP

Use cauliflower (same time) or Brussels sprouts halved (add 5 minutes). Frozen broccoli: roast from frozen at 450 °F for 25 minutes, less crisp.

### FIX IT

- Limp and olive-colored: too wet, too crowded or too low an oven. Dry it and use 2 pans.
- Bitter, burnt tips: oven too hot or pan too close to the top. Lower the rack.

VEGETABLE

# V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions

**Makes** 5 portions (about 130 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 35 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 110 | 2 g | 14 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.70 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 60 sec, or a hot dry pan for 3 minutes for better texture.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M1, M3, M6, M11, C5, C8 · flavour families MEX

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3 bell peppers (red, green or mix), sliced bell peppers (red and green) (600 g)
- 2 medium, sliced in 1/2-inch strips yellow onion (300 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 2 tsp chili powder (5 g)
- 1 tsp ground cumin (2 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tbsp lime juice (15 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C.
2. Slice the peppers and onions into strips about 1/2 inch / 1 cm wide, all the same size.
3. Toss with the oil, chili powder, cumin, garlic powder and salt.
4. Spread over a large pan in one layer. Do not crowd.
5. Roast 25-28 minutes, stirring once at 15 minutes. Done when the onions are soft and golden at the edges and the peppers have blistered spots.
6. Squeeze the lime juice on top. Portion into 5 containers (about 130 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 28 at 425 °F / 220 °C. Shares the oven with P1, P3, P9 and P10.

### SWAP

Add 1 sliced poblano or a jalapeno for heat. If peppers are expensive, use half peppers and half zucchini.

### FIX IT

- Watery: the pan was too crowded. Use 2 pans or drain the liquid before storing.
- Too crunchy: slice them thinner next time and leave 5 more minutes.

VEGETABLE

# V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion

**Makes** 5 portions (about 130 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 30 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 90 | 2 g | 9 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.75 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Eat cold, or microwave 45 sec. Best on the first 3 days; it gets watery after. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M4, M9, D-2, D-3, D-9, C3, C9, C10 · flavour families MEX, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3 medium (about 1.7 lb), cut in 1/2-inch half-moons zucchini (750 g)
- 1 large red onion, cut in wedges (200 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 1 tsp dried oregano (1.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp garlic powder (1.5 g)
- 1 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (6 g)
- 1 tbsp lemon juice (15 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C.
2. Cut the zucchini in 1/2-inch half-moons. Cut the onion into thick wedges, keeping the root so the layers hold together.
3. Toss with the oil, oregano, garlic powder and salt.
4. Spread over a large pan in one layer. Zucchini likes space and high heat.
5. Roast 20-25 minutes, turning once at 12 minutes. Done when the edges are golden brown and the middle is tender, not soft and mushy.
6. Add the lemon juice. Portion into 5 containers (about 130 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 25 at 425 °F / 220 °C. Zucchini goes in last in the week-1 order, as it turns watery the longest in the fridge.

### SWAP

Use yellow squash, or eggplant cubes (add 5 minutes). Add 1/2 tsp of smoked paprika for a stronger taste.

### FIX IT

- Mushy and wet: pan crowded or pieces too thin. Next time keep them thick and use 2 pans.
- Watery by day 3: normal. Pat dry with a paper towel before eating.

VEGETABLE

# V4 Garlic Green Beans

**Makes** 5 portions (about 120 g cooked each) **Active** 10 min **Total** 25 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 100 | 3 g | 11 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.95 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Eat cold in bowls, or microwave 45-60 sec. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes A4, A6, A10, A11, D-5, C1, C4, C11, C12 · flavour families ASI, MED, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1.5 lb, trimmed green beans (700 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 4 cloves, minced garlic cloves (12 g)
- 3/4 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (4.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper (0.5 g)
- 1 tbsp lemon juice (15 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C.
2. Trim the ends off the green beans. Dry them well.
3. Toss with the oil, salt and pepper. Spread in one layer on a large pan.
4. Roast 10-12 minutes until they start to wrinkle.
5. Take out, scatter the garlic over, stir, and roast 4-6 minutes more. Done when the beans are wrinkled with brown spots and still have a little snap, and the garlic is pale gold, not dark.
6. Add the lemon juice. Portion into 5 containers (about 120 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, minute 0 to 18 at 425 °F / 220 °C. The garlic goes on in the last 5 minutes.

### SWAP

Use asparagus (cook 8-10 minutes) or snap peas (7-9 minutes). Frozen green beans work: roast from frozen for 20 minutes.

### FIX IT

- Bitter garlic: it burned. Always add it late, and take it out when pale gold.
- Limp beans: roasted too long or too low. Next time use the top rack and check at 12 minutes.

VEGETABLE

# V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw)

**Makes** 5 portions (about 130 g cooked each) **Active** 15 min **Total** 15 min

| 110 KCAL | 2 g PROTEIN | 13 g CARBS | 7 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.50 | ALLERGENS<br>**sesame, soy, wheat** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Not reheated. Eat cold. Keep the dressing in a jar and toss on the day for crunch. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M5, M8, A2, A3, A8 · flavour families ASI, MEX, COM

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1/2 small head (about 1 lb), thinly shredded green cabbage (450 g)
- 2 large, grated carrots (150 g)
- 3, thinly sliced scallions (40 g)
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil (14 g)
- 1 tbsp canola oil (14 g)
- 3 tbsp apple cider vinegar (45 g)
- 1 tbsp soy sauce (16 g)
- 1 tbsp honey (21 g)
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds (9 g)
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Shred the cabbage as thin as you can with a sharp knife. Grate the carrots. Slice the scallions.
2. In a jar or bowl, whisk the sesame oil, canola oil, vinegar, soy sauce, honey, ginger and half the sesame seeds until the honey dissolves.
3. Combine the vegetables in a big bowl. Keep the dressing apart for now.
4. Portion the vegetables into 5 containers (about 130 g each) with a small cup or section for the dressing (about 1 1/2 tbsp each).
5. When eating, pour the dressing over and toss. Top with the rest of the sesame seeds.
6. Taste the dressing: it should be tangy and a bit sweet. Add a pinch of salt or 1 tsp more honey to taste.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold prep, no heat. Do it while the oven runs. Dress it only on days 1-2 if you want maximum crunch.

### SWAP

Allergy to sesame: leave out the seeds and use 1 tbsp more canola oil. Gluten-free: use tamari. Use pre-shredded coleslaw mix to save 8 minutes.

### FIX IT

- Watery slaw: it was dressed too early. Keep the dressing separate and drain any liquid.
- Too sharp: add 1 tsp honey or 1 tbsp oil.

VEGETABLE

# V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw)

**Makes** 5 portions (about 180 g cooked each) | **Active** 15 min | **Total** 15 min

| 80 | 2 g | 8 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.60 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Not reheated. Eat cold. Add the dressing on the day. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** signature dishes M2, M7, D-1, D-4, D-6, D-10, D-12 · flavour families MED, MEX

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 medium, diced cucumbers (400 g)
- 1 lb Roma or cherry tomatoes, diced tomatoes (Roma or cherry) (400 g)
- 1/2 small, finely diced red onion (80 g)
- 1/4 cup, chopped fresh parsley (15 g)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 2 tbsp lemon juice (30 g)
- 1/2 tsp dried oregano (0.8 g)
- 3/4 tsp kosher salt (table-salt equivalent) (4.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Dice the cucumbers and tomatoes into 1/2-inch pieces. Scoop out the seedy centre of the tomatoes if they are very juicy.
2. Finely dice the red onion. Soak it in cold water for 5 minutes, then drain, to take away the sharp bite.
3. Mix the cucumber, tomato, onion and parsley in a bowl. Do not add the salt yet.
4. In a jar, shake the oil, lemon juice, oregano and salt until creamy.
5. Portion the salad into 5 containers (about 180 g each) lined with a paper towel, with the dressing in a small cup.
6. On eating day, pour the dressing over. It should taste bright and a little salty, with crisp cucumber.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold prep, no heat. Prep it last, as it is the most perishable thing in the week.

### SWAP

Add 1/2 cup crumbled feta or a can of chickpeas for a heartier salad (macros change). Use bell pepper if cucumbers are out of season.

### FIX IT

- Soggy: salt and dressing draw out water. Dress only at the last minute.
- Bland tomatoes: add a pinch of sugar and extra lemon. Cherry tomatoes hold up better than big ones.

CHAPTER 15

# Sauces · The Variety Engine

> **"I noticed you reuse a lot of ingredients, seasonings, and sauces like the hot honey."**
>
> — reader review

Same chicken, three sauces, three different meals. That's how one Sunday gives you five plates that don't taste like the same box. There are 12 sauces, 3 per flavor family. Most take 5-15 minutes and one small saucepan, or no heat at all.

### HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK

- **Pick 3 sauces a week**, ideally from 2-3 families.
- **Store each sauce in its own cup.** It goes on after reheating. Sauce stored on rice or pasta makes it soggy.
- **Yogurt sauces (S1, S7, S11) are never heated** and don't freeze. Everything else freezes for 2-3 months: make a double batch and freeze half flat in a bag.
- Sauces are where the allergens hide: soy sauce (soy, usually wheat), tahini (sesame), peanut butter (peanuts), Worcestershire (fish), yogurt (milk). Check the column.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens | Families |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| S1 | Chipotle-Lime Yogurt | 40 g | 30 | 4 g | 4 days | no | milk | MEX |
| S2 | Tomatillo Salsa Verde | 45 g | 20 | 0 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MEX |
| S3 | Quick Red Enchilada Sauce | 40 g | 30 | 1 g | 4 days | 3 mo | wheat | MEX |
| S4 | Lighter Teriyaki | 35 g | 40 | 1 g | 4 days | 3 mo | soy, wheat, sesame | ASI |
| S5 | Peanut-Ginger Sauce | 35 g | 100 | 3 g | 4 days | 2 mo | peanuts, soy, wheat, sesame | ASI |
| S6 | Gochujang-Honey Sauce | 30 g | 30 | 1 g | 4 days | 3 mo | soy, wheat, sesame | ASI |
| S7 | Tzatziki | 45 g | 40 | 3 g | 4 days | no | milk | MED |
| S8 | Lemon-Tahini Sauce | 35 g | 70 | 2 g | 4 days | 2 mo | sesame | MED |
| S9 | Chimichurri | 40 g | 140 | 0 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — | MED |
| S10 | Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar) | 40 g | 40 | 1 g | 4 days | 3 mo | fish | COM |
| S11 | Honey-Mustard Yogurt | 45 g | 40 | 3 g | 4 days | no | milk | COM |
| S12 | Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce | 45 g | 60 | 2 g | 4 days | 2 mo | milk | COM |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Your three sauces: _____ · _____ · _____**

SAUCE

# S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (40 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 5 min

| 30 | 4 g | 2 g | 1 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.35 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Serve cold. Don't heat it. Stir before using. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

*Macro note: Chipotle in adobo is costed with the closest USDA entry (canned hot red chili peppers); brands vary a little.*

**Goes with:** M1, M3, M6, M8, M10, M12 (all the Mexican plates with S1)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3/4 cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt (170 g)
- 1 pepper canned chipotle pepper in adobo, minced (+ 1 tsp of the adobo sauce) (15 g)
- 1 Tbsp lime juice (15 g)
- 1 small clove garlic, grated (3 g)
- 1/4 tsp ground cumin (0.5 g)
- 1 tsp olive oil (4.5 g)
- 1/8 tsp fine salt (0.7 g)

## STEPS

1. Mince the chipotle pepper as fine as you can. Grate the garlic.
2. Spoon the yogurt into a bowl or a 1-cup jar.
3. Add the chipotle, 1 tsp adobo sauce, lime juice, garlic, cumin, oil and salt. Stir until the color is an even pale orange with no white streaks.
4. Taste. Add a pinch more salt if it tastes flat, or a little more adobo if you want heat.
5. Scoop into one small lidded container or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 40 g each). Chill at least 30 min so the garlic and chipotle settle in.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. Make it in the 5-minute gap while the oven preheats or the chicken rests. No burner, no oven.

### SWAP

No dairy: use unsweetened plain coconut or soy yogurt (macros change). Less heat: use half the chipotle.

### FIX IT

- Too thin? Your yogurt was watery. Stir in 1 more Tbsp of yogurt, or drain it in a sieve for 10 min next time.
- Too hot the next day? Heat builds as it sits. Stir in 1 Tbsp yogurt to calm it.

SAUCE

# S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (45 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 10 min | **Total** 20 min | **Oven** broil, high

| 20 | 0 g | 3 g | 0 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.25 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Eat cold or at room temperature. For a warm sauce, simmer 3 min in a small pan.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** M2, M5, M7, M9 (Mexican plates with S2)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3-4 medium tomatillos, husked and rinsed (170 g)
- 1 jalapeño, stem removed (15 g)
- about 1/4 small white onion, quartered (30 g)
- 1 clove garlic, in the skin (3 g)
- 1/4 cup packed fresh cilantro, leaves and tender stems (8 g)
- 1 tsp lime juice (5 g)
- 1/3 tsp fine salt (2 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the broiler on high with a rack 4-6 inches below the heat. Line a small sheet pan with foil.
2. Put the tomatillos, jalapeño, onion and unpeeled garlic on the pan. Broil 5-7 min until the tops are blistered and spotted black.
3. Flip everything. Broil 4-5 min more until the tomatillos are soft, slumped and leaking juice. The garlic should feel soft when squeezed.
4. Cool 5 min. Slip the garlic out of its skin. Tip everything, juices too, into a blender with cilantro, lime juice and salt.
5. Pulse 8-10 times for a bit of texture, or blend longer for smooth. Taste and add salt until it tastes bright, not flat.
6. Pour into a lidded jar or 5 mini containers (about 3 Tbsp / 45 g each). Cool fully before closing.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven (broiler) for 12 min. Fits in the last 20 minutes while the main tray rests, or right after the main tray comes out.

### SWAP

Mild: take the seeds and ribs out of the jalapeño. No broiler: pan-roast in a dry cast-iron skillet over medium-high heat, turning, 10 min. Not hot enough? Add a second jalapeño.

### FIX IT

- Too sour or sharp? Tomatillos vary. Stir in 1/4 tsp honey or sugar.
- Too watery? Simmer in a pan 4-5 min, stirring, until it coats the back of a spoon.

SAUCE

# S3 Quick Red Enchilada Sauce

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (40 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 15 min

| 30 KCAL | 1 g PROTEIN | 3 g CARBS | 2 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.20 | ALLERGENS<br>wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Warm in a small pan or microwave 30-45 sec until steaming.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** M4, M11 (Mexican plates with S3)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 tsp olive oil (9 g)
- 2 tsp all-purpose flour (5 g)
- 1 Tbsp chili powder (8 g)
- 1/4 tsp ground cumin (0.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp garlic powder (0.8 g)
- 1/4 tsp dried oregano (0.3 g)
- 1/2 cup tomato sauce (plain, canned) (122 g)
- 1/3 cup water (80 g)
- 1 tsp cider vinegar (5 g)
- 1/2 tsp fine salt (3 g)

## STEPS

1. Warm the oil in a small saucepan over medium heat until it shimmers, about 1 min.
2. Whisk in the flour, chili powder, cumin, garlic powder and oregano. Cook 45-60 sec, whisking, until it smells toasty and looks like wet sand. Don't let it go dark.
3. Pour in the tomato sauce, water and vinegar while whisking. Scrape up any paste from the bottom.
4. Add the salt. Simmer on low 8-10 min, stirring now and then, until it coats the back of a spoon and the color deepens to brick red.
5. Taste. Add a pinch of salt if it tastes flat. Cool, then spoon into one jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 42 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One burner, 15 min, low and unattended after minute 5. Fits while the oven is heating.

### SWAP

Gluten-free: use 1 tsp cornstarch instead of the flour. Hotter: add 1/8 tsp cayenne.

### FIX IT

- Bitter? The spices burned. Stir in 1/2 tsp honey and 1 tsp tomato sauce; if still bitter, start again with lower heat.
- Too thick when cold? Thin with 1-2 tsp water when you reheat.

SAUCE

# S4 Lighter Teriyaki

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (35 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 12 min

| 40 | 1 g | 7 g | 0 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.20 | ALLERGENS<br>soy, wheat, sesame |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Warm in a pan or microwave 30 sec. Stir; it thickens as it cools.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** A1, A4, A10 (Asian plates with S4)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1/4 cup reduced-sodium soy sauce (60 g)
- 1/4 cup water (60 g)
- 1 1/2 Tbsp honey (32 g)
- 1 Tbsp rice vinegar or cider vinegar (15 g)
- 1 tsp fresh ginger, finely grated (2 g)
- 1 clove garlic, grated (3 g)
- 1/2 tsp toasted sesame oil (2 g)
- 2 tsp cornstarch (5 g)
- 1 Tbsp (for the cornstarch) water (15 g)

## STEPS

1. Whisk the cornstarch with 1 Tbsp cold water in a small cup until smooth. Set aside.
2. In a small saucepan, combine soy sauce, 1/4 cup water, honey, vinegar, ginger and garlic. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat, stirring.
3. Give the cornstarch cup another stir, then pour it in while whisking. Simmer 1-2 min until the sauce turns glossy and coats the back of a spoon.
4. Remove from the heat and stir in the sesame oil.
5. Cool 10 min. Pour into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 34 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One burner, 10 min. Easy to run while the oven is on.

### SWAP

Gluten-free and soy-free: use coconut aminos and the same amount of honey, and taste for salt. Less sweet: use 1 Tbsp honey.

### FIX IT

- Lumpy? The cornstarch wasn't mixed smooth. Pour through a small sieve.
- Too thin? Simmer 1 more min. Too thick when cold? Whisk in 1 tsp warm water.

SAUCE

# S5 Peanut-Ginger Sauce

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (35 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 5 min

| 100 KCAL | 3 g PROTEIN | 7 g CARBS | 7 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.15 | ALLERGENS<br>**peanuts, soy, wheat, sesame** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Serve cool or room temperature. Thin with 1 tsp warm water if it has set firm.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** A2, A5, A8, A12 (Asian plates with S5)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1/4 cup smooth peanut butter (no sugar added) (65 g)
- 1 Tbsp reduced-sodium soy sauce (16 g)
- 1 Tbsp lime juice (15 g)
- 1 Tbsp honey (21 g)
- 1 tsp fresh ginger, finely grated (2 g)
- 1 clove garlic, grated (3 g)
- 1/2 tsp toasted sesame oil (2 g)
- 1/2 tsp sriracha (3 g)
- warm, 1/4 cup water (60 g)

## STEPS

1. Put the peanut butter in a bowl. Add soy sauce, lime juice, honey, ginger, garlic, sesame oil and sriracha.
2. Whisk it. It will look thick and grainy at first. Keep going.
3. Whisk in the warm water 1 Tbsp at a time. Stop when it falls from the whisk in a smooth ribbon.
4. Taste. More lime if it's heavy, more soy sauce if it's flat.
5. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 37 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 5 minutes anywhere in the session. No heat.

### SWAP

Peanut allergy: use sunflower seed butter (nut-free; macros change). Spicier: double the sriracha.

### FIX IT

- Split or oily? Your peanut butter was cold or natural-style with a layer of oil. Whisk in 1 Tbsp warm water.
- Too thick after chilling? Whisk in 1 tsp warm water per portion when you serve it.

SAUCE

# S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (30 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 10 min

| 30 KCAL | 1 g PROTEIN | 6 g CARBS | 1 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.25 | ALLERGENS<br>soy, wheat, sesame |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Serve cool or warm 20 sec in the microwave. It thickens in the fridge; stir in a splash of water.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

*Macro note: USDA has no gochujang entry. It is costed with the closest entry (sriracha chili sauce), which likely UNDERSTATES calories by roughly 10-15 kcal per portion. Check your jar's label.*

**Goes with:** A3, A6, A7, A9, A11 (Asian plates with S6)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 3 Tbsp gochujang (Korean chili paste) (50 g)
- 1 Tbsp honey (21 g)
- 1 Tbsp reduced-sodium soy sauce (16 g)
- 1 Tbsp rice vinegar or cider vinegar (15 g)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil (4.5 g)
- 2 cloves garlic, grated (6 g)
- 1 tsp fresh ginger, finely grated (2 g)
- 3 Tbsp water (45 g)

## STEPS

1. In a small saucepan, whisk the gochujang, honey, soy sauce, vinegar, garlic, ginger and water until smooth.
2. Heat over medium-low, stirring, until small bubbles break at the edges, about 2-3 min. Do not boil hard; it spits.
3. Simmer 1 min until it looks glossy and slightly thicker. Take it off the heat and stir in the sesame oil.
4. Cool 10 min. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2 Tbsp / 30 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One small burner, 8 min. Fits any gap.

### SWAP

Gluten-free: check the gochujang label (many brands contain wheat) and use tamari. Milder: swap 1 Tbsp of gochujang for tomato paste.

### FIX IT

- Too spicy? Stir in 1 tsp more honey and 1 tsp water.
- Too salty? Gochujang brands differ. Add 1 tsp water and 1 tsp vinegar next time, and use less soy sauce.

SAUCE

# S7 Tzatziki

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (45 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 8 min **Total** 8 min

| 40 | 3 g | 2 g | 2 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.30 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |

REHEAT
Serve cold. Don't heat. A little water on top is normal; stir it back in.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D-1, D-4, D-9, D-10, D-12 (Mediterranean plates with S7)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2/3 cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt (150 g)
- 1/4 cup cucumber, grated and squeezed dry (40 g)
- 2 tsp lemon juice (10 g)
- 2 tsp olive oil (9 g)
- 1 small clove garlic, grated (3 g)
- 1/2 tsp dried dill (0.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Grate the cucumber on the big holes. Wrap it in a clean towel or paper towel and squeeze hard until only a damp clump is left.
2. Stir the yogurt, lemon juice, oil, grated garlic, dill and salt in a bowl until smooth.
3. Fold in the cucumber.
4. Taste. Add salt until the cucumber tastes sweet, not watery. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 43 g each). Chill 30 min.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 8 minutes any time. Do it first so the flavors blend.

### SWAP

No dairy: unsweetened plain soy or coconut yogurt. Fresh dill: use 1 Tbsp chopped in place of dried.

### FIX IT

- Watery next day? The cucumber wasn't squeezed enough. Spoon off the liquid and stir in 1 Tbsp thick yogurt.
- Garlic too sharp? Let it sit 1 hour, or use half a clove.

SAUCE

# S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (35 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 5 min

| 70 | 2 g | 3 g | 6 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.30 | ALLERGENS<br>sesame |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Serve cool. It sets firm in the fridge; whisk in 1 Tbsp water per portion.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D-2, D-6, D-7, D-8, D-11 (Mediterranean plates with S8)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1/4 cup tahini (stir the jar first) (60 g)
- 3 Tbsp lemon juice (45 g)
- cold, 1/4 cup water (60 g)
- 1 small clove garlic, grated (3 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- a pinch ground cumin (0.3 g)

## STEPS

1. Put the tahini in a bowl. Add the lemon juice, garlic, salt and cumin. Whisk. It will seize into a thick, pale paste. That's normal.
2. Whisk in the cold water 1 Tbsp at a time. The paste loosens and turns creamy and light.
3. Stop when it falls from the whisk in a thick ribbon.
4. Taste. More lemon if it's heavy, more salt if it's flat. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 34 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 5 minutes anywhere. No heat.

### SWAP

Sesame allergy: use sunflower seed butter (macros change). Sweeter: add 1 tsp honey.

### FIX IT

- Bitter? Cheaper tahini can be. Add 1 tsp honey and 1 tsp lemon.
- Grainy or split? Whisk in 1 tsp cold water at a time until smooth again.

SAUCE

# S9 Chimichurri

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (40 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 10 min **Total** 10 min

| 140 KCAL | 0 g PROTEIN | 2 g CARBS | 15 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.35 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Thaw in the fridge overnight, or at room temperature 20 min only, then stir.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D-3, D-5 (Mediterranean plates with S9)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 cup packed fresh flat-leaf parsley, leaves and tender stems (60 g)
- 3 cloves garlic (9 g)
- 3 Tbsp red wine vinegar (45 g)
- 1/3 cup olive oil (73 g)
- 1 tsp dried oregano (1 g)
- 1/4 tsp red pepper flakes (0.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp fine salt (3 g)

## STEPS

1. Wash the parsley and dry it well. Wet leaves make a watery sauce.
2. Chop the parsley and garlic fine by hand, or pulse 5-6 times in a food processor until it looks like coarse crumbs. Don't purée it.
3. Tip into a bowl with the vinegar, oregano, pepper flakes and salt. Stir and let sit 5 min.
4. Stir in the oil. Taste. It should be sharp and green. Add salt if it tastes flat.
5. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 38 g each). Press a thin film of oil over the top. Refrigerate right away.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 10 minutes. Make it last so it's freshest.

### SWAP

Nothing fresh? Use 1 cup packed cilantro for a different but good version. Milder: use 1 garlic clove. Always refrigerate; fresh garlic in oil must not sit at room temperature.

### FIX IT

- Dull brown-green after a day? That's normal. A squeeze of lemon on serving brings it back.
- Too sharp? Add 1 Tbsp more oil, or reduce the vinegar next time.

SAUCE

# S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (40 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 20 min

| 40 | 1 g | 10 g | 0 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.20 | ALLERGENS<br>fish |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |
| REHEAT<br>Warm in a pan or microwave 30 sec. Stir. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** C1, C2, C5, C8, C11 (Comfort plates with S10)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1/3 cup ketchup (85 g)
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste (32 g)
- 2 Tbsp cider vinegar (30 g)
- 1 Tbsp brown sugar (14 g)
- 1 tsp yellow mustard (5 g)
- 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce (5 g)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika (2.3 g)
- 1/2 tsp garlic powder (1.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp onion powder (1.2 g)
- a pinch cayenne (0.2 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- 1/4 cup water (60 g)

## STEPS

1. Whisk everything in a small saucepan: ketchup, tomato paste, vinegar, brown sugar, mustard, Worcestershire, paprika, garlic powder, onion powder, cayenne, salt and water.
2. Bring to a gentle bubble over medium heat, then turn to low. Simmer 10-12 min, stirring every few minutes.
3. It's done when a spoon leaves a clear trail across the bottom of the pan and the sauce looks dark and glossy.
4. Taste. More cayenne for heat, more vinegar for tang. Cool 10 min.
5. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 40 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One burner, 20 min, mostly unattended on low. Start it first.

### SWAP

No fish allergen: use 1 tsp soy sauce in place of Worcestershire (adds soy and wheat). Lower sugar still: use 2 tsp brown sugar.

### FIX IT

- Splattering? Turn the heat down and half-cover the pan.
- Too tangy? Stir in 1 tsp honey. Too thick when cold? Whisk in 1 tsp water.

SAUCE

# S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (45 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 5 min

| 40 | 3 g | 7 g | 0 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.35 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |
| REHEAT<br>Serve cold. Don't heat. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

*Macro note: Costed with yellow mustard entry; Dijon is similar.*

**Goes with:** C4, C6, C9, C12 (Comfort plates with S11)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2/3 cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt (150 g)
- 2 Tbsp Dijon or yellow mustard (30 g)
- 1 1/2 Tbsp honey (32 g)
- 1 tsp lemon juice (5 g)
- 1/4 tsp garlic powder (0.8 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- a pinch black pepper (0.3 g)

## STEPS

1. Put the yogurt in a bowl.
2. Add the mustard, honey, lemon juice, garlic powder, salt and pepper.
3. Stir until smooth and pale gold, with no streaks of mustard or honey.
4. Taste. More honey if it's sharp, more mustard if it's sweet.
5. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 44 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 5 minutes anywhere. No heat.

### SWAP

No dairy: unsweetened plain soy or coconut yogurt. Less sugar: use 1 Tbsp honey.

### FIX IT

- Too thin? Strain the yogurt next time, or stir in 1 more Tbsp yogurt.
- Too sweet or too sharp? Balance with a little honey or a little lemon.

SAUCE

# S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce

**Makes** 5 portions of sauce (45 g each, about 2-3 Tbsp), stored separately

**Active** 5 min **Total** 15 min

| 60 | 2 g | 4 g | 5 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.35 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Warm in a pan over low heat, whisking, or microwave at 50% power 45 sec. Stir.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** C3, C7, C10 (Comfort plates with S12)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 Tbsp olive oil (13.5 g)
- 3 cloves garlic, minced (9 g)
- 3/4 cup tomato sauce (plain, canned) (184 g)
- 1/2 tsp dried oregano (0.5 g)
- 3 Tbsp reduced-fat cream cheese, cubed (45 g)
- 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan (10 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Warm the oil in a small saucepan over medium-low heat. Add the garlic. Cook 30-60 sec, stirring, until fragrant and just pale gold. Don't let it brown.
2. Pour in the tomato sauce and add the oregano and salt. Simmer on low 8-10 min, stirring now and then, until it darkens slightly and thickens.
3. Turn the heat to the lowest setting. Add the cream cheese and whisk until fully melted and the sauce turns a smooth, creamy pink-orange.
4. Whisk in the Parmesan off the heat. Taste and add salt if it needs it.
5. Cool 10 min. Spoon into a jar or 5 mini containers (about 2-3 Tbsp / 45 g each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One burner, 15 min. Low heat after the first 2 minutes.

### SWAP

No dairy: use a plant-based cream cheese and skip the Parmesan (macros change). Lighter: skip the cream cheese and use 3 Tbsp Parmesan.

### FIX IT

- Grainy or split? The heat was too high. Whisk in 1 Tbsp warm water off the heat.
- Too acidic? Stir in 1/4 tsp sugar or honey.

CHAPTER 16

# 48 Signature Plates + the Mix & Match Chart

> **"It would be nice if prep and recipe and serving sizes were all together so you could pick and chose recipes to batch cook together."**
>
> — reader review

A signature plate is one protein, one base, one vegetable and one sauce that we put together on purpose. There are 48, 12 per flavor family. Each one tells you what it adds up to and how to pack it.

Use this chapter two ways:

- **To swap a plate in a plan week.** Same parts, different sauce? Find it here and check its

numbers.

- **To plan your own week.** Pick 5 plates that share 2 proteins, 2 bases and 2 vegetables. Then cook those parts on Sunday.

## How to read a plate

- **kcal and protein** are for one box built from **one standard portion** of each part, the portion on its recipe card. Calculated from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy, including the sauce. Kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g. In the plan weeks, some batches are shared by more or fewer boxes, so the week chapters show the numbers for those boxes.
- **Allergens** are the 9 major US allergens (FDA) found in any of the 4 parts. Brands differ: read your labels.
- **Fridge** is the shortest fridge life of the 4 parts. Count from Sunday (day 0).
- **Freezer** tells you if the box can go in the freezer for Friday (the day-5 rule, Chapter 4), and which

part comes out softer if it does. Safe, just a different texture.

- **The 3 lines** are how you pack and eat it: (1) what goes in the box, (2) what stays apart, (3) how to reheat and finish. The finish (lime, lemon, pepper, scallion) isn't counted in the numbers. It adds almost nothing and wakes up day-4 food.
- Grams are the standard portion. Weigh the batch and divide it (Chapter 3); the scale wins.

## Mexican-style (MEX) · 12 plates

Chipotle, lime, salsa verde, red enchilada. The fridge-friendliest family: most of these sauces freeze, and the yogurt one is never heated.

### M1 Chipotle Lemon Chicken Fajita Bowl

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**640 kcal** | **46 g protein** | Allergens: milk | Fridge: 4 days | Freezer: yes, except S1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M2 Salsa Verde Chicken Rice Bowl

P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde

**600 kcal** **52 g protein** Allergens: none of the 9 Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 140 g salsa chicken on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tomatillo Salsa Verde; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M3 Turkey Taco Sweet Potato Bowl

P4 Turkey Taco Crumble + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**690 kcal** **44 g protein** Allergens: milk Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except S1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 140 g turkey taco crumble on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M4 Red Enchilada Beef & Lentil Wrap

P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S3 Quick Red Enchilada Sauce

**600 kcal** **34 g protein** Allergens: wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 (texture)

1. Box: 130 g zucchini & red onion, 160 g beef & lentil mince on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Quick Red Enchilada Sauce; 1 tortilla in a bag.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, inside, a squeeze of lime.

## M5 Pulled Pork Salsa Verde Bowl with Crunch Slaw

P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) + S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde

**780 kcal** **60 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V5 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 156 g pulled pork + a spoon of juices on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tomatillo Salsa Verde; 130 g slaw in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M6 Chipotle Tofu Fajita Quinoa Bowl

P9 Crispy Baked Tofu + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**690 kcal** **45 g protein** Allergens: milk, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except S1 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 136 g crispy tofu on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt.
3. Re-crisp the tofu 6-8 min at 400 °F / 205 °C (oven or air fryer); microwave the rest covered until steaming, 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M7 Smoky Chickpea Salsa Verde Wrap

P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde

**510 kcal** **17 g protein** Allergens: wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 (texture)

1. Box: 140 g spiced chickpeas.
2. Apart: 45 g Tomatillo Salsa Verde; 1 tortilla in a bag; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce inside, salad inside, a squeeze of lime.

## M8 Chipotle Salmon Slaw Bowl

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**780 kcal** **47 g protein** Allergens: fish, milk, sesame, soy, wheat

Fridge: 3 days Freezer: yes, except V5 and S1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt; 130 g slaw in its own container.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M9 Salsa Chicken & Crispy Potato Bowl

P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde

**570 kcal** **53 g protein** Allergens: none of the 9 Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 and V3 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 130 g zucchini & red onion, 140 g salsa chicken on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tomatillo Salsa Verde.
3. Potatoes and protein in the oven or air fryer at 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 min, or microwave covered until 165 °F / 74 °C (softer). Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M10 Turkey Taco Rice Bowl with Charred Broccoli

P4 Turkey Taco Crumble + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**700 kcal** **48 g protein** Allergens: milk Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V1 and S1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 130 g charred broccoli, 140 g turkey taco crumble on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## M11 Enchilada Chicken Fajita Wrap

P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S3 Quick Red Enchilada Sauce

**560 kcal** **54 g protein** Allergens: wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: the whole box

1. Box: 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 140 g salsa chicken on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Quick Red Enchilada Sauce; 1 tortilla in a bag.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, inside, a squeeze of lime.

### M12 Chipotle Beef & Lentil Potato Bowl

P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

**660 kcal** **40 g protein** Allergens: milk Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 and V1 and S1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 130 g charred broccoli, 160 g beef & lentil mince on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chipotle-Lime Yogurt.
3. Potatoes and protein in the oven or air fryer at 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 min, or microwave covered until 165 °F / 74 °C (softer). Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime.

## Asian-style (ASI) · 12 plates

Teriyaki, peanut-ginger, gochujang-honey. Big flavor, short ingredient lists. Watch the allergens: soy sauce brings soy and usually wheat; the peanut sauce brings peanuts.

## A1 Teriyaki Lemon Chicken & Broccoli Rice

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S4 Lighter Teriyaki

**650 kcal** **46 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 130 g charred broccoli, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lighter Teriyaki.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A2 Peanut-Ginger Tofu Crunch Bowl

P9 Crispy Baked Tofu + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) + S5 Peanut-Ginger Sauce

**760 kcal** **45 g protein** Allergens: peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V5 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 136 g crispy tofu on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Peanut-Ginger Sauce; 130 g slaw in its own container.
3. Re-crisp the tofu 6-8 min at 400 °F / 205 °C (oven or air fryer); microwave the rest covered until steaming, 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A3 Gochujang Pulled Pork Rice Bowl

P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) + S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**800 kcal** **61 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V5 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 156 g pulled pork + a spoon of juices on top.
2. Apart: 30 g Gochujang-Honey Sauce; 130 g slaw in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A4 Teriyaki Salmon & Green Bean Quinoa

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S4 Lighter Teriyaki

**750 kcal** **48 g protein** Allergens: fish, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 3 days Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 120 g garlic green beans, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lighter Teriyaki.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A5 Peanut Chicken Sweet Potato Bowl

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S5 Peanut-Ginger Sauce

**700 kcal** **57 g protein** Allergens: peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat

Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 130 g charred broccoli, 150 g chicken breast on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Peanut-Ginger Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A6 Gochujang Meatball Rice Bowl

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**720 kcal** **46 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, sesame, soy, wheat

Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 120 g garlic green beans, 156 g meatballs (6) on top.
2. Apart: 30 g Gochujang-Honey Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A7 Sticky Gochujang Tofu & Broccoli

P9 Crispy Baked Tofu + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**710 kcal** **42 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 130 g charred broccoli, 136 g crispy tofu on top.
2. Apart: 30 g Gochujang-Honey Sauce.
3. Re-crisp the tofu 6-8 min at 400 °F / 205 °C (oven or air fryer); microwave the rest covered until steaming, 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A8 Peanut-Ginger Chicken Pasta Salad

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta + V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) + S5 Peanut-Ginger Sauce

**760 kcal** **50 g protein** Allergens: peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V5 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g pasta, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Peanut-Ginger Sauce; 130 g slaw in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A9 Gochujang-Glazed Salmon Rice Bowl

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**780 kcal** **47 g protein** Allergens: fish, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 3 days Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 130 g charred broccoli, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 30 g Gochujang-Honey Sauce.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A10 Teriyaki Meatball Noodle Bowl

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S4 Lighter Teriyaki

**770 kcal** **51 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g pasta, 120 g garlic green beans, 156 g meatballs (6) on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lighter Teriyaki.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A11 Sweet-Heat Chicken & Sweet Potato

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S6 Gochujang-Honey Sauce

**620 kcal** **52 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 120 g garlic green beans, 150 g chicken breast on top.
2. Apart: 30 g Gochujang-Honey Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

## A12 Peanut Pulled Pork Power Bowl

P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S5 Peanut-Ginger Sauce

**850 kcal** **70 g protein** Allergens: peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 130 g charred broccoli, 156 g pulled pork + a spoon of juices on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Peanut-Ginger Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lime and sliced scallion if you have it.

# Mediterranean-style (MED) · 12 plates

Tzatziki, lemon-tahini, chimichurri. Bright and fresh, so the raw parts matter: cut the cucumber-tomato salad on the day if you can. Shorter fridge life on several plates (3 days).

## D-1 Greek Lemon Chicken Rice Bowl

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S7 Tzatziki

**620 kcal** **45 g protein** Allergens: milk Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 and S7 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tzatziki; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-2 Smoky Chickpea Tahini Bowl

P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**640 kcal** **22 g protein** Allergens: sesame Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 130 g zucchini & red onion, 140 g spiced chickpeas on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lemon-Tahini Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-3 Chimichurri Salmon Quinoa Bowl

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S9 Chimichurri

**850 kcal** **47 g protein** Allergens: fish Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 130 g zucchini & red onion, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chimichurri.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-4 Chicken Tzatziki Wrap

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S7 Tzatziki

**540 kcal** **54 g protein** Allergens: milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 and S7 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g chicken breast.
2. Apart: 45 g Tzatziki; 1 tortilla in a bag; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce inside, salad inside, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-5 Chimichurri Meatball Quinoa Bowl

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S9 Chimichurri

**810 kcal** **49 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, wheat Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 120 g garlic green beans, 156 g meatballs (6) on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Chimichurri.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-6 Spiced Beef & Lentil Tahini Rice Bowl

P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**710 kcal** **34 g protein** Allergens: sesame Fridge: 3 days Freezer: yes, except V6 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 160 g beef & lentil mince on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lemon-Tahini Sauce; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-7 Lemon-Tahini Tofu & Broccoli Bowl

P9 Crispy Baked Tofu + B2 Fluffy Quinoa + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**730 kcal** **47 g protein** Allergens: sesame, soy, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 168 g quinoa, 130 g charred broccoli, 136 g crispy tofu on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lemon-Tahini Sauce.
3. Re-crisp the tofu 6-8 min at 400 °F / 205 °C (oven or air fryer); microwave the rest covered until steaming, 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-8 Lemon Chicken, Sweet Potato & Tahini

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**680 kcal** **46 g protein** Allergens: sesame Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 130 g charred broccoli, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lemon-Tahini Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-9 Roasted Veg & Chickpea Tzatziki Wrap

P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S7 Tzatziki

**540 kcal** **20 g protein** Allergens: milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 and S7 (texture)

1. Box: 130 g zucchini & red onion, 140 g spiced chickpeas on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tzatziki; 1 tortilla in a bag.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce inside, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-10 Salmon Tzatziki Rice Bowl

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S7 Tzatziki

**750 kcal** **46 g protein** Allergens: fish, milk Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 and S7 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Tzatziki; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce cold on top, raw veg on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-11 Tahini Chicken & Crispy Potatoes

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S8 Lemon-Tahini Sauce

**650 kcal** **56 g protein** Allergens: sesame Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 and V1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 130 g charred broccoli, 150 g chicken breast on top.
2. Apart: 35 g Lemon-Tahini Sauce.
3. Potatoes and protein in the oven or air fryer at 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 min, or microwave covered until 165 °F / 74 °C (softer). Then sauce cold on top, a squeeze of lemon.

## D-12 Turkey Meatball Gyro-Style Wrap

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) + S7 Tzatziki

**630 kcal** **47 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V6 and S7 (texture)

1. Box: 156 g meatballs (6).
2. Apart: 45 g Tzatziki; 1 tortilla in a bag; 180 g cucumber-tomato salad in its own container.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce inside, salad inside, a squeeze of lemon.

# Comfort (COM) · 12 plates

Smoky BBQ, honey-mustard, creamy tomato-garlic. The weeknight-dinner family. The BBQ sauce lists fish because Worcestershire usually contains anchovy.

## C1 BBQ Lemon Chicken & Crispy Potatoes

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**600 kcal** | **43 g protein** | Allergens: fish | Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 and V4 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 120 g garlic green beans, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Smoky BBQ Sauce.
3. Potatoes and protein in the oven or air fryer at 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 min, or microwave covered until 165 °F / 74 °C (softer). Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C2 Smoky BBQ Pulled Pork & Sweet Potato

P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**800 kcal** | **63 g protein** | Allergens: fish | Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 130 g charred broccoli, 156 g pulled pork + a spoon of juices on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Smoky BBQ Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C3 Creamy Tomato Meatball Pasta

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce

**790 kcal** **52 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days Freezer: yes, except V3 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g pasta, 130 g zucchini & red onion, 156 g meatballs (6) on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C4 Honey-Mustard Chicken Rice Plate

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt

**630 kcal** **55 g protein** Allergens: milk Fridge: 4 days Freezer: yes, except V4 and S11 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 120 g garlic green beans, 150 g chicken breast on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Honey-Mustard Yogurt.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C5 BBQ Beef & Lentil Potato Bowl

P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**670 kcal** **34 g protein** Allergens: fish Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 160 g beef & lentil mince on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Smoky BBQ Sauce.
3. Potatoes and protein in the oven or air fryer at 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 min, or microwave covered until 165 °F / 74 °C (softer). Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C6 Honey-Mustard Salmon & Potatoes

P8 Simple Baked Salmon + B3 Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt

**750 kcal** **50 g protein** Allergens: fish, milk Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except B3 and V1 and S11 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g roasted potatoes, 130 g charred broccoli, 146 g salmon (1 piece) on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Honey-Mustard Yogurt.
3. Salmon: eat cold, or warm at 50% power 60-90 sec. Eat it on day 1 or 2. Then sauce cold on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C7 Creamy Tomato Chicken Pasta

P1 Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs + B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta + V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli + S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce

**730 kcal** **52 g protein** Allergens: milk, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V1 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g pasta, 130 g charred broccoli, 136 g lemon-garlic chicken on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

## C8 BBQ Chicken Fajita Wrap

P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions + S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**570 kcal** **53 g protein** Allergens: fish, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: the whole box

1. Box: 130 g fajita peppers & onions, 140 g salsa chicken on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Smoky BBQ Sauce; 1 tortilla in a bag.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, inside, a crack of black pepper.

## C9 Honey-Mustard Chicken Wrap

P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast + B6 Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt

**560 kcal** **55 g protein** Allergens: milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 and S11 (texture)

1. Box: 130 g zucchini & red onion, 150 g chicken breast on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Honey-Mustard Yogurt; 1 tortilla in a bag.
3. Microwave the filling covered until steaming (165 °F / 74 °C). Warm the tortilla 15 sec per side in a dry pan, fill, fold, roll. Then sauce inside, a crack of black pepper.

## C10 Creamy Beef & Lentil Pasta

P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince + B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta + V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion + S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce

**760 kcal** **40 g protein** Allergens: milk, wheat Fridge: 3 days

Freezer: yes, except V3 (texture)

1. Box: 150 g pasta, 130 g zucchini & red onion, 160 g beef & lentil mince on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

### C11 BBQ Pulled Pork Rice Plate

P7 Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder + B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S10 Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar)

**790 kcal** **61 g protein** Allergens: fish Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V4 (texture)

1. Box: 160 g rice, 120 g garlic green beans, 156 g pulled pork + a spoon of juices on top.
2. Apart: 40 g Smoky BBQ Sauce.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce warmed 30 sec, on top, a crack of black pepper.

### C12 Honey-Mustard Meatballs & Sweet Potato

P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs + B4 Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes + V4 Garlic Green Beans + S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt

**720 kcal** **48 g protein** Allergens: egg, milk, wheat Fridge: 4 days

Freezer: yes, except V4 and S11 (texture)

1. Box: 170 g sweet potato, 120 g garlic green beans, 156 g meatballs (6) on top.
2. Apart: 45 g Honey-Mustard Yogurt.
3. Microwave covered, stir or turn halfway, until steaming hot: 165 °F / 74 °C. Then sauce cold on top, a crack of black pepper.

## Three plates that cross families

Three signature plates break the chart's rule below on purpose: **D-8** (sweet potato with a Mediterranean sauce), **C5** and **C8** (fajita peppers with BBQ sauce). We

kept them because the pairing works on the plate and because they let Weeks 1 and 2 reuse the same trays. They're marked here so the chart stays honest.

## The Mix & Match chart

You don't need a list of every combination. You need one rule and four small tables.

**The rule: pick a sauce. Then any protein, base and vegetable with a ✓ in that sauce's family column goes with it.**

That rule gives **1,815 combinations** from the 34 parts (10 proteins × 6 bases × 6 vegetables × 12 sauces = 4,320 possible boxes; 1,815 pass the rule). Only the 48 above have names and packing notes. The rest are pairings that follow the same flavor logic, not plates we've built one by one.

## Sauces by family

| Family | Sauce 1 | Sauce 2 | Sauce 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **MEX** Mexican-style | S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt | S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde | S3 Quick Red Enchilada |
| **ASI** Asian-style | S4 Lighter Teriyaki | S5 Peanut-Ginger | S6 Gochujang-Honey |
| **MED** Mediterranean-style | S7 Tzatziki | S8 Lemon-Tahini | S9 Chimichurri |
| **COM** Comfort | S10 Smoky BBQ | S11 Honey-Mustard Yogurt | S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic |

## Proteins

| | MEX | ASI | MED | COM |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| P1 Lemon-Garlic Chicken Thighs | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| P2 Slow-Cooker Salsa Chicken | ✓ | | | ✓ |
| P3 Never-Dry Chicken Breast | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| P4 Turkey Taco Crumble | ✓ | | | |
| P5 Beef & Lentil Power Mince | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ |
| P6 Freezer Turkey Meatballs | | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| P7 Oven Pulled Pork | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| P8 Simple Baked Salmon | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| P9 Crispy Baked Tofu | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | |
| P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas | ✓ | | ✓ | |

## Bases

| | MEX | ASI | MED | COM |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| B1 Oven Rice | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| B2 Quinoa | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| B3 Roasted Baby Potatoes | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ |
| B4 Sweet Potato Cubes | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta | | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| B6 Wraps & Tortillas | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ |

## Vegetables

| | MEX | ASI | MED | COM |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| V1 Charred Broccoli | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| V2 Fajita Peppers & Onions | ✓ | | | |
| V3 Zucchini & Red Onion | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ |
| V4 Garlic Green Beans | | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| V5 Sesame Slaw (raw) | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| V6 Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) | ✓ | | ✓ | |

## Four checks before you commit to a combo

1. **Fridge days.** The box keeps as long as its shortest part. Salmon (P8), zucchini (V3) and the cucumber-tomato salad (V6) are 3 days; most parts are 4.

2. **Friday.** If the combo is your Friday box, every hot part must freeze. Raw vegetables (V5, V6) and yogurt sauces (S1, S7, S11) don't.
3. **Allergens.** Add up the allergens of the four parts. Their recipe cards list them, and so does Chapter 21.
4. **The oven.** Two oven proteins at very different temperatures (P7 at 300 °F, everything else at 400-450 °F) don't share a session easily. Week 4 shows the workaround.

## Add up any combo yourself

Every recipe card gives kcal and protein per portion. Add the four. Example, a combo that isn't one of the 48:

| Part | kcal | Protein |
|---|---|---|
| P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast | 269 | 45.2 g |
| B2 Fluffy Quinoa | 212 | 7.2 g |
| V4 Garlic Green Beans | 96 | 2.7 g |
| S9 Chimichurri | 139 | 0.5 g |
| **Box** | **716 → about 720 kcal** | **55.6 → about 56 g** |

MED column: P3 ✓, B2 ✓, V4 ✓, S9 is MED. It passes the rule. Allergens: none of the 9 in any part. Fridge: 4 days.

*Per-portion numbers from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy, as printed on each recipe card. The printable "Build Your Plate" sheet does this sum with boxes to fill.*

YOUR ACTION

## Build 3 plates of your own

Use the chart. Write one combo per family you like. Check the four boxes before you cook it.

| My plate | Protein | Base | Vegetable | Sauce | kcal | Protein | Fridge days | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | | | |

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition, calculated per recipe with `herramientas/macros.py`). FDA, 9 major food allergens. USDA FSIS, storage times (Chapter 20). Combination count: script over the flavor families on each recipe card.*

CHAPTER 17

# Breakfasts

> **"The basic idea holds but it's only for one meal a day..."**
>
> — reader review

Lunch and dinner are covered by the boxes. These 8 cover breakfast, cooked in the same Sunday session. Each recipe makes 5, one for each weekday.

### HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK

- **Each plan week has one breakfast.** To swap, pick one that uses the same oven temperature or no oven at all.
- **Egg bites (D1, D2) and baked oats (D6)** bake at 350 °F: put them in last, while you pack the boxes.
- **Overnight oats (D3, D4)** take 10 minutes and no heat, but need 6 hours in the fridge.
- **Burritos and pancakes (D5, D7)** freeze for 3 months. Make a double batch and you have next week's breakfast too.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D1 | Spinach-Feta Egg Bites | 150 g | 220 | 18 g | 4 days | 3 mo | egg, milk |
| D2 | Turkey & Pepper Egg Bites | 170 g | 280 | 24 g | 4 days | 3 mo | egg, milk |
| D3 | Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats | 330 g | 340 | 24 g | 4 days | no | milk |
| D4 | Peanut Butter-Banana Overnight Oats | 290 g | 400 | 22 g | 4 days | no | milk, peanuts |
| D5 | Freezer Breakfast Burritos | 255 g | 520 | 28 g | 4 days | 3 mo | egg, milk, wheat |
| D6 | Cottage Cheese Baked Oats | 255 g | 370 | 22 g | 4 days | 2 mo | egg, milk |
| D7 | Freezer Protein Pancakes | 150 g | 230 | 16 g | 4 days | 3 mo | egg, milk |
| D8 | Turkey Sausage & Sweet Potato Hash | 230 g | 310 | 21 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Your breakfast this week: _____**

BREAKFAST

# D1 Spinach-Feta Egg Bites

**Makes** 5 portions (3 egg bites per portion, about 150 g) **Active** 15 min

**Total** 40 min **Oven** 350 °F / 175 °C

| 220 | 18 g | 4 g | 15 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.05 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Microwave 2 bites 30-45 sec, 3 bites 45-60 sec, until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). From frozen: 90 sec at 50% power, then 30 sec at full.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Plan week 1 (Starter). Pairs with a piece of fruit or a slice of toast.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 10 large eggs (500 g)
- 1/2 cup 2% cottage cheese (113 g)
- 4 packed cups fresh baby spinach (120 g)
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta (75 g)
- 1 tsp olive oil (for the spinach) (4.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp garlic powder (1.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper (0.5 g)
- 1 tsp canola oil or cooking spray (for the tin) (4.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 350 °F / 175 °C. Grease 15 muffin cups well (one 12-cup tin plus 3 cups of a second tin) with oil or spray. Silicone cups work too.
2. Warm the olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add the spinach and stir 1-2 min until fully wilted and bright green. Tip into a sieve and press out the water with a spoon. Chop fine.
3. Blend or whisk the eggs and cottage cheese with the garlic powder, salt and pepper until nearly smooth, with only tiny curds.
4. Divide the spinach and feta evenly between the cups, then pour in the egg until each is about 3/4 full.
5. Bake 20-24 min until the tops are puffed and set, the centers don't jiggle when you nudge the tin, and a knife in the middle comes out clean (160 °F / 71 °C).
6. Cool in the tin 5 min, then run a knife around each and lift out. Cool completely before packing 3 per container.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, 22 min at 350 °F. Slot it in beside the main tray (350 °F on the lower rack) or right after the proteins come out.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: use 1/2 cup extra spinach and 3 Tbsp nutritional yeast in place of the cottage cheese and feta (macros change). Cheaper: swap the feta for 1/2 cup shredded cheddar.

### FIX IT

- Rubbery or weeping water? It baked too long or the spinach wasn't squeezed dry. Pull at 20 min and squeeze the spinach harder.
- Stuck to the tin? Grease was too thin. Run a thin knife around each and use silicone cups next time.

BREAKFAST

# D2 Turkey & Pepper Egg Bites

**Makes** 5 portions (3 egg bites per portion, about 170 g) **Active** 20 min

**Total** 45 min **Oven** 350 °F / 175 °C

| 280 KCAL | 24 g PROTEIN | 3 g CARBS | 19 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.20 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Microwave 2 bites 30-45 sec, 3 bites 45-60 sec, until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). From frozen: 90 sec at 50% power, then 30 sec at full.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Plan week 4 (Mix-it-yourself). Good with salsa S2 on the side.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 10 large eggs (500 g)
- 8 oz ground turkey (93% lean) (227 g)
- 1 medium red bell pepper, finely diced (120 g)
- 1/4 cup yellow onion, finely diced (40 g)
- 1/2 cup shredded sharp cheddar (55 g)
- 1 tsp olive oil (4.5 g)
- 1/2 tsp smoked paprika (1.2 g)
- 3/4 tsp fine salt (4.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper (0.5 g)
- 1 tsp canola oil or cooking spray (for the tin) (4.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 350 °F / 175 °C. Grease 15 muffin cups well.
2. Warm the olive oil in a large pan over medium-high heat. Add the onion and pepper. Cook 3 min until the pepper just softens.
3. Add the turkey, paprika and half the salt. Break it into small crumbs with a spoon. Cook 5-6 min until no pink remains and a thermometer reads 165 °F / 74 °C. Drain off any liquid. Cool 5 min.
4. Whisk the eggs with the rest of the salt and the pepper until fully mixed.
5. Divide the turkey mix and cheddar between the cups. Pour in egg until each is about 3/4 full.
6. Bake 20-24 min until puffed, set in the middle, and a knife comes out clean (160 °F / 71 °C). Cool 5 min in the tin, lift out, and cool fully before packing 3 per container.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire first (10 min for the turkey), then oven 22 min at 350 °F beside the main tray.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: leave out the cheddar and add 1/2 tsp extra salt and 1 Tbsp nutritional yeast. Cheaper: use ground chicken or leftover cooked crumble from P4.

### FIX IT

- Watery bottoms? The turkey liquid wasn't drained. Drain it and blot with a paper towel.
- Dry? It baked past 24 min. Pull when the centers are just set.

BREAKFAST

# D3 Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats

**Makes** 5 portions (1 jar, about 330 g) **Active** 10 min **Total** 10 min + 6 h chill

| 340 KCAL | 24 g PROTEIN | 50 g CARBS | 6 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.95 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |

REHEAT
Eat cold, straight from the jar. Or microwave 60-90 sec and stir.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Plan week 2 (Budget). Takes no hands on the morning.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 1/2 cups old-fashioned rolled oats (200 g)
- 2 1/2 cups plain nonfat Greek yogurt (600 g)
- 2 1/2 cups 1% milk (610 g)
- 2 Tbsp + 2 tsp chia seeds (20 g)
- 5 tsp honey (35 g)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract (4 g)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon (2.6 g)
- a pinch fine salt (0.5 g)
- 1 1/4 cups blueberries (fresh or frozen) (185 g)

## STEPS

1. Line up 5 jars or containers of at least 12 oz / 350 ml each.
2. In a large bowl, stir together the oats, chia, cinnamon and salt.
3. Add the yogurt, milk, honey and vanilla. Stir until there are no dry pockets of oats and no yogurt lumps.
4. Divide evenly between the jars (about 1 cup / 285 g each).
5. Top each jar with 1/4 cup berries. Close the lids and refrigerate at least 6 hours.
6. In the morning, stir the jar. It's ready when the oats are soft and the mix looks thick and spoonable like pudding.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 10 minutes, any time on Sunday. Needs 6 hours in the fridge, so make it before dinner.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: use unsweetened soy milk and a plain soy or coconut yogurt (macros change). Cheaper: use frozen berries or 1 mashed banana instead.

### FIX IT

- Too thick? Stir in 2 Tbsp milk before eating.
- Too runny? The oats were quick oats or the jar sat under 6 hours. Add 1 tsp chia and wait 30 min.

BREAKFAST

# D4 Peanut Butter-Banana Overnight Oats

**Makes** 5 portions (1 jar, about 290 g) | **Active** 10 min | **Total** 10 min + 6 h chill

| 400 | 22 g | 51 g | 14 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.10 | ALLERGENS<br>**milk, peanuts** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (texture) |

REHEAT
Eat cold. Or microwave 60-90 sec, stir, and add a splash of milk.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Banana is mashed in, so it doesn't brown. Add a few banana slices on top the morning you eat it if you like.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 1/2 cups old-fashioned rolled oats (200 g)
- 2 1/2 cups 1% milk (610 g)
- 1 1/4 cups plain nonfat Greek yogurt (300 g)
- 5 Tbsp smooth peanut butter (no sugar added) (80 g)
- 2 medium ripe bananas, mashed (236 g)
- 2 Tbsp + 2 tsp chia seeds (20 g)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract (4 g)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon (2.6 g)
- a pinch fine salt (0.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Line up 5 jars of at least 12 oz / 350 ml each.
2. In a large bowl, mash the bananas with a fork until almost smooth. Stir in the peanut butter until it's mostly blended.
3. Whisk in the milk, then the yogurt, vanilla, cinnamon and salt until the mix is an even light tan.
4. Stir in the oats and chia.
5. Divide evenly between the jars (about 1 1/4 cups / 290 g each). Close and refrigerate at least 6 hours.
6. In the morning, stir. It's ready when the oats are soft and no dry oats show at the bottom.

**SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT**

Cold. 10 minutes, any time. Needs 6 hours in the fridge, so make it before dinner.

**SWAP**

Peanut allergy: use sunflower seed butter (macros change). Dairy-free: soy milk and plain soy yogurt (macros change).

**FIX IT**

- Peanut butter lumps? Warm the spoon in hot water or microwave the peanut butter 10 sec before mixing.
- Too thick? Stir in 2 Tbsp milk. Too sweet? Use one banana less.

BREAKFAST

# D5 Freezer Breakfast Burritos

**Makes** 5 portions (1 burrito, about 255 g) **Active** 25 min **Total** 35 min

| 520 KCAL | 28 g PROTEIN | 43 g CARBS | 26 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.50 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, milk, wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

From frozen: unwrap, wrap in a damp paper towel and microwave 2 min, flip, then 45-60 sec more until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). Or thaw overnight in the fridge and microwave 60-90 sec.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Plan week 3 (Freezer-ahead). Serve with salsa S2 or S1 on the side (not counted).

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 10 large eggs (500 g)
- 5 10-inch flour tortillas (325 g)
- 1 cup canned low-sodium black beans, drained and rinsed (215 g)
- 1 1/4 cups shredded sharp cheddar (140 g)
- 1 medium red bell pepper, finely diced (120 g)
- 1/3 cup yellow onion, finely diced (50 g)
- 2 tsp olive oil (9 g)
- 1/2 tsp ground cumin (1 g)
- 3/4 tsp fine salt (4.5 g)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper (0.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Warm the oil in a large nonstick pan over medium heat. Cook the onion and pepper 3-4 min until the edges soften. Stir in the cumin, salt and pepper.
2. Beat the eggs in a bowl. Pour them into the pan and stir gently, folding, until the eggs form large soft curds and no wet shine is left, 3-4 min. Take it off the heat; it keeps cooking.
3. Cool the egg mix 10 min on a plate. Hot filling steams the tortillas soggy.
4. Warm the tortillas 10 sec each in the microwave so they fold without cracking. Lay one flat and put 1/5 of the eggs, 3 Tbsp beans and 1/5 of the cheddar in a line below the center.
5. Fold the sides in, then roll up tight from the bottom. Repeat for all 5.
6. Wrap each burrito in parchment or foil. For the freezer, put them in a bag, press out the air and flatten. Label with the date.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One pan, 15 min of active time. Do it while the oven is full; no oven needed.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: omit the cheddar and add 1/2 cup more beans. Gluten-free: use large corn tortillas or serve as a bowl (macros change). More protein: add 4 oz / 115 g cooked turkey crumble (P4) to the mix.

### FIX IT

- Soggy burrito? The filling was warm when you rolled. Cool it fully first and drain the beans well.
- Eggs dry after reheating? Cook them softer (still set, a little glossy) and reheat covered with a damp towel.

BREAKFAST

# D6 Cottage Cheese Baked Oats

**Makes** 5 portions (1 large square, about 255 g) **Active** 10 min **Total** 60 min

**Oven** 350 °F / 175 °C

| 370 | 22 g | 50 g | 10 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.90 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT
Microwave a square 60-90 sec until hot in the middle. Or 350 °F / 175 °C oven 10 min, covered. Good cold too.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Tastes like dessert. Cut into 5 on Sunday and it reheats well all week.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2 cups old-fashioned rolled oats (170 g)
- 2 cups 2% cottage cheese (450 g)
- 4 large eggs (200 g)
- 2 medium ripe bananas (236 g)
- 1/2 cup 1% milk (122 g)
- 2 Tbsp pure maple syrup (40 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder (7 g)
- 2 tsp vanilla extract (9 g)
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon (5 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- 1 cup blueberries (fresh or frozen) (150 g)
- 1 tsp cooking spray or butter (for the dish) (4.5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 350 °F / 175 °C. Grease a 9x13 inch / 23x33 cm baking dish.
2. Blend the cottage cheese, eggs, bananas, milk, maple syrup, vanilla, baking powder, cinnamon and salt in a blender until smooth and pourable, about 30 sec.
3. Stir in the oats in a large bowl until all the oats are wet.
4. Pour into the dish and spread level. Scatter the blueberries over the top, pressing in lightly.
5. Bake 40-45 min until the edges are golden, the middle doesn't jiggle, and a knife in the center comes out clean (160 °F / 71 °C).
6. Cool 15 min. Cut into 5 squares (or more, thinner). Cool completely before packing.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, 45 min at 350 °F. Put it on the lower rack beside the main tray or in first thing.

### SWAP

Cheaper: use frozen berries. Dairy-free: not a good fit (cottage cheese is the structure); try D3 with plant yogurt. Less sweet: use 1 Tbsp maple syrup.

### FIX IT

- Wet in the middle? Bake 5-8 min more. Cover the top with foil if it browns too fast.
- Dry or rubbery edges? Your oven runs hot or the dish was smaller than 9x13. Check at 35 min next time.

BREAKFAST

# D7 Freezer Protein Pancakes

**Makes** 5 portions (3 pancakes, about 150 g) **Active** 30 min **Total** 40 min

| 230 | 16 g | 22 g | 9 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.95 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Toaster or toaster oven (375 °F / 190 °C) 4-5 min until hot and crisp at the edges. Or microwave 3 pancakes 45-60 sec. From frozen: add 1 min.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Syrup, peanut butter or fruit are extra and not counted.

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats (100 g)
- 1 1/2 cups 2% cottage cheese (340 g)
- 4 large eggs (200 g)
- 1 small ripe banana (100 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder (7 g)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract (4.5 g)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon (2.6 g)
- 1/4 tsp fine salt (1.5 g)
- 2 tsp canola oil (for the pan) (9 g)

## STEPS

1. Blend the oats, cottage cheese, eggs, banana, baking powder, vanilla, cinnamon and salt in a blender 30-40 sec until smooth. Rest the batter 5 min so the oats soften.
2. Heat a nonstick pan or griddle over medium heat. Brush with a little oil.
3. Pour 3 Tbsp / 45 g of batter per pancake, about 4 inches wide. Cook 2-3 min until bubbles form and pop on top and the edges look dry.
4. Flip. Cook 1-2 min until golden underneath and the center springs back (160 °F / 71 °C). Re-oil the pan every batch. Make 15 pancakes.
5. Cool the pancakes in a single layer on a rack, 10 min. Stacked warm pancakes steam and stick.
6. Pack 3 per portion. For the freezer, freeze flat on a tray 1 hour, then bag them with parchment between layers.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Fire. One pan, about 25 min of active time. Do it while the oven bakes everything else.

### SWAP

Gluten-free: use certified gluten-free oats. More protein: replace 2 Tbsp of the oats with 2 Tbsp unflavored or vanilla protein powder (macros change). No banana: use 1/4 cup unsweetened applesauce.

### FIX IT

- Pancakes tear when flipped? Wait for bubbles to pop across the surface and the edges to look dry, and use a thin spatula.
- Raw center? The heat is too high. Drop to medium-low and make them smaller.

BREAKFAST

# D8 Turkey Sausage & Sweet Potato Hash

**Makes** 5 portions (1 heaping cup, about 230 g) **Active** 20 min **Total** 50 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 310 | 21 g | 30 g | 13 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.70 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Skillet over medium heat 3-4 min, or microwave 90 sec, stirring once, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** Breakfast slot. Top with a fried or poached egg the morning you eat it (not counted).

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 1 lb ground turkey (93% lean) (454 g)
- 2 medium sweet potatoes, peeled, 1/2-inch cubes (600 g)
- 1 large yellow onion, diced (150 g)
- 1 large red bell pepper, diced (150 g)
- 2 Tbsp olive oil (27 g)
- 2 tsp smoked paprika (4.6 g)
- 1 tsp dried thyme (1 g)
- 1 tsp garlic powder (3 g)
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt (9 g)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C with two rimmed sheet pans inside.
2. Toss the sweet potato, onion and pepper with the oil, paprika, thyme, garlic powder, salt and pepper in a big bowl.
3. Spread over the two hot pans in one layer with space between. Roast 15 min until the potato edges just start to brown.
4. Pull the pans out. Crumble the raw turkey in small clumps over the vegetables, then stir roughly.
5. Roast 15-18 min more, stirring once at the halfway point, until the turkey has no pink, the potato is soft in the middle and crisp at the edges, and a thermometer in the turkey reads 165 °F / 74 °C.
6. Cool 15 min on the pans. Mix well, divide into 5 containers (about 1 heaping cup each).

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven, 35 min at 425 °F. Use the oven slot when the proteins and veg are not full; fits with P1 or V1 at the same temperature.

### SWAP

Cheaper: use regular ground pork or beef (reheat to 160 °F / 71 °C; macros change). More veg: add 2 cups chopped kale in the last 5 min.

### FIX IT

- Soft, not crisp? The pans were crowded. Use two pans and don't stack the vegetables.
- Dry turkey? It stayed in too long. Break the clumps smaller next time so it cooks faster.

CHAPTER 18

# The Freezer Block · 10 One-Pot Meals

> **"Keep em in the freezer and you're good for weeks."**
>
> — reader review

For the weeks when Sunday doesn't happen. Each recipe is one pot or one dish, makes 6 portions, and is built to freeze. Cook one on any free evening, portion it, freeze it, and take out one box at a time.

### HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK

- **This is Path C** from Chapter 0. You can live on this block alone for a while.
- **Freeze on the day you cook.** Not on day 3 (freezing doesn't reset the clock).
- **Shallow containers**, 2 inches (5 cm) deep or less, so they cool fast and thaw evenly.
- **Thaw in the fridge overnight, never on the counter.** Reheat until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center.
- **Label every box** with the name and date. Quality is best within the months in the table.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FM1 | Turkey Three-Bean Chili | 540 g | 480 | 42 g | 4 days | 3 mo | — |
| FM2 | Chicken Tikka-Style Curry | 525 g | 550 | 46 g | 3 days | 3 mo | milk |
| FM3 | Beef & Lentil Ragù | 490 g | 560 | 37 g | 4 days | 3 mo | wheat, milk |
| FM4 | Chicken Enchilada Bake | 390 g | 550 | 50 g | 3 days | 2 mo | milk |
| FM5 | Turkey Sausage & Lentil Soup | 555 g | 560 | 28 g | 4 days | 3 mo | wheat |
| FM6 | Chicken Tortilla Soup | 655 g | 560 | 58 g | 3 days | 3 mo | milk |
| FM7 | Teriyaki Chicken Fried Rice | 310 g | 500 | 38 g | 3 days | 2 mo | egg, soy, wheat, sesame |
| FM8 | Turkey Meatball & Orzo Bake | 380 g | 530 | 39 g | 3 days | 2 mo | egg, wheat, milk |
| FM9 | Black Bean & Sweet Potato Burritos | 350 g | 530 | 24 g | 3 days | 2 mo | wheat, soy, milk |
| FM10 | Creamy Chicken & Broccoli Pasta Bake | 335 g | 530 | 45 g | 3 days | 2 mo | wheat, milk |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway. These make 6 portions per batch.*

**First freezer meal I'll make:** _____ · on (day) _____

FREEZER MEAL

# FM1 Turkey Three-Bean Chili

**Makes** 6 portions (~540 g each) **Active** 25 min **Total** 60 min

| 480 | 42 g | 44 g | 18 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $3.20 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT
Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat covered in the microwave 3-4 min, stirring halfway, or in a pot over medium 6-8 min, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice, S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt, V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- lean ground turkey (93/7): 2 lb (907 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- yellow onion, diced: 1 large (200 g)
- red bell pepper, diced: 1 large (150 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- chili powder: 2 tbsp (15 g)
- ground cumin: 2 tsp (5 g)
- smoked paprika: 1 tsp (3 g)
- crushed tomatoes: 1 can (28 oz) (794 g)
- tomato paste: 2 tbsp (32 g)
- kidney beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- black beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- pinto beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- frozen corn kernels: 1 cup (150 g)
- low-sodium chicken broth: 2 cups (480 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oil in a large pot (5-6 qt / 5-6 L) over medium-high heat. Add the onion and pepper and cook 5 minutes, stirring, until the onion is soft and see-through at the edges.
2. Add the garlic and cook 30 seconds, just until you can smell it. Push the vegetables to the sides, add the turkey, and break it up with a spoon. Cook 6-8 minutes until no pink is left and it looks like small crumbles.
3. Stir in the chili powder, cumin, paprika and tomato paste. Cook 1 minute until the paste darkens a shade and the spices smell toasty.
4. Add the crushed tomatoes, all three beans, corn, broth and salt. Bring to a boil, then drop to low and simmer, partly covered, 30 minutes, stirring every 10 minutes. It is done when a spoon dragged across the bottom leaves a clear trail for a second and the chili coats the spoon.
5. Taste and add salt in pinches if needed. Check that the chili is at least 165 °F / 74 °C in the middle.
6. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Chili freezes well in zip bags laid flat: they stack and thaw in half the time.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop. Start at minute 0 on a back burner; it simmers on its own from minute 20 to minute 50, so the oven and the other burners stay free for P and B recipes.

### SWAP

Swap the turkey for 2 lb of 90% lean ground beef (brown it until no pink remains and the internal temp reads 160 °F / 71 °C). For a budget version, replace one can of beans with 1 cup of cooked lentils.

### FIX IT

- Too thin: simmer uncovered 10 more minutes, or mash a half cup of the beans against the pot wall and stir them in.
- Tastes flat: add 1 tsp vinegar or lime juice off the heat and a pinch more salt. Acid wakes up tomato-based dishes.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM2 Chicken Tikka-Style Curry

**Makes** 6 portions (~525 g each) **Active** 25 min **Total** 55 min

| 550 KCAL | 46 g PROTEIN | 49 g CARBS | 20 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.85 | ALLERGENS<br>milk (coconut milk too) |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 3-4 min, stirring halfway, adding 1 tbsp water to the rice; or reheat the curry in a pan over medium 6-8 min. It must reach 165 °F / 74 °C in the center.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice (the rice is already packed in), V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw, S7 Tzatziki

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- boneless skinless chicken thighs, cut in 1.5 in chunks: 2.2 lb (1000 g)
- plain nonfat Greek yogurt: 1 cup (245 g)
- curry powder: 1 tbsp (7 g)
- kosher salt: 1.5 tsp (8 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- yellow onion, diced: 1 large (250 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- fresh ginger, grated: 1 tbsp (10 g)
- smoked paprika: 2 tsp (5 g)
- ground turmeric: 1 tsp (3 g)
- tomato paste: 3 tbsp (48 g)
- crushed tomatoes: 1 can (14.5 oz) (411 g)
- canned coconut milk: 1 cup (half a can) (240 g)
- chickpeas, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- fresh baby spinach: 5 oz (140 g)
- long-grain white rice, cooked (to pack with each portion): about 1/2 cup / 85 g per portion (510 g)

*Nutrition note: includes 85 g of cooked rice per portion*

## STEPS

1. Mix the chicken with the yogurt, curry powder and 1 tsp of the salt in a bowl. Let it sit 15 minutes on the counter while you chop (no longer than 30 minutes; for longer, marinate in the fridge).
2. Heat the oil in a large deep skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Add the onion and cook 5 minutes until soft with golden edges. Add garlic and ginger and cook 30 seconds.
3. Stir in paprika, turmeric and tomato paste. Cook 1-2 minutes until the paste turns a deeper brick red.
4. Add the chicken with all its marinade, the crushed tomatoes and the coconut milk. Stir, bring to a gentle bubble, then lower to medium-low and simmer, partly covered, 15 minutes. The chicken is done when the biggest piece is white all the way through and reads 165 °F / 74 °C.
5. Stir in the chickpeas and spinach and the rest of the salt. Cook 2-3 minutes until the spinach has wilted into the sauce and the sauce coats the back of a spoon. Do not boil hard once the yogurt is in, or it can split.
6. Cook the rice (or use the rice from B1). Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: pack each of 6 containers with a scoop of rice (about 1/2 cup / 85 g) and a scoop of curry, side by side. Date the lids and freeze flat.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop. Starts at minute 10 (after the oven things are in) and needs about 40 minutes with the lid half on, so it can share the back burner with a rice pot.

### SWAP

Swap thighs for boneless skinless chicken breast (same weight); cook it just until it hits 165 °F / 74 °C. Dairy-free: use coconut yogurt for the marinade and skip nothing else. Nut-free note: coconut is not a tree nut in most guidance, but check with your doctor if you have a tree-nut allergy.

### FIX IT

- Sauce split or grainy: you boiled it after the yogurt went in. Take it off the heat, whisk in 2 tbsp warm water, and keep it at a bare simmer from now on.
- Chicken tough: the chunks were too small or cooked too hot. Cut them at least 1.5 in / 4 cm and keep the simmer gentle.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM3 Beef & Lentil Ragù

**Makes** 6 portions (~490 g each) **Active** 25 min **Total** 65 min

| 560 KCAL | 37 g PROTEIN | 72 g CARBS | 15 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $3.05 | ALLERGENS<br>**wheat, milk** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min (or microwave covered 3-4 min), stirring, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Meanwhile boil 1.75 oz / 50 g dry pasta per portion for the time on the package minus 1 minute, and toss it with the hot ragù. Nutrition below includes this pasta and the Parmesan.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B5 Reheat-Ready Pasta (use instead of fresh pasta if you prefer), V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli, V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- lean ground beef (90/10): 1.25 lb (567 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- yellow onion, finely diced: 1 large (200 g)
- carrots, finely diced: 2 medium (130 g)
- celery, finely diced: 2 stalks (80 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- tomato paste: 3 tbsp (48 g)
- dried oregano: 2 tsp (3 g)
- brown or green lentils, dry, rinsed: 3/4 cup (150 g)
- crushed tomatoes: 1 can (28 oz) (794 g)
- low-sodium beef broth: 2 cups (480 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)
- black pepper: 1/2 tsp (1 g)
- dry spaghetti or penne (cooked fresh on serving day, about 1.75 oz / 50 g dry per portion): about 10.5 oz total (300 g)
- grated Parmesan (1 tbsp per portion): 6 tbsp (30 g)

*Nutrition note: includes the pasta (50 g dry per portion) and 1 tbsp Parmesan, added on serving day*

## STEPS

1. Heat the oil in a large pot over medium-high heat. Add the beef and break it into small crumbles. Cook 7-8 minutes until all the pink is gone and the bits are lightly browned. Spoon off most of the fat.
2. Add onion, carrot and celery. Cook 6 minutes, stirring, until the onion is soft and see-through. Add garlic and oregano, 30 seconds.
3. Stir in the tomato paste and cook 1 minute until it darkens a shade.
4. Add the lentils, crushed tomatoes, broth, salt and pepper. Bring to a boil, lower to a steady simmer, cover with the lid slightly open, and cook 35-40 minutes, stirring every 10 minutes. It is done when a lentil squashes easily between two fingers and the sauce is thick enough to hold a spoon trail.
5. If it looks dry before the lentils are soft, add 1/2 cup water and keep going. Check that it reads 160 °F / 71 °C or more in the center.
6. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Freeze the ragù only. Do not freeze it mixed with pasta; pasta turns mushy.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop. Start at minute 5; it simmers hands-off from minute 25 to minute 65, which suits the long, quiet part of a Sunday.

### SWAP

Swap the beef for lean ground turkey (cook to 165 °F / 74 °C). Gluten-free: serve over gluten-free pasta or baked sweet potato. Budget: use 1 lb of beef and 1 cup (200 g) lentils.

### FIX IT

- Lentils still hard after 40 minutes: your lentils are old or your tomatoes are very acidic. Add 1/2 cup water, cover, and cook 10 more minutes before tasting again.
- Greasy surface: skim it off with a spoon before portioning, or chill the ragù and lift off the white fat that sets on top.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM4 Chicken Enchilada Bake

**Makes** 6 portions (~390 g each) **Active** 30 min **Total** 70 min

**Oven** 375 °F / 190 °C

| 550 KCAL | 50 g PROTEIN | 45 g CARBS | 19 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $3.20 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave 2-3 min on a plate, covered, until steaming; or bake at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min covered with foil. Center must reach 165 °F / 74 °C.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V2 Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions, B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice, S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- boneless skinless chicken breasts: 2 lb (907 g)
- red enchilada sauce, mild: 3 cups (24 oz) (680 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- yellow onion, diced: 1 medium (150 g)
- ground cumin: 2 tsp (5 g)
- chili powder: 1 tbsp (8 g)
- black beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- frozen corn kernels: 1 cup (150 g)
- corn tortillas (6 in): 12 (312 g)
- shredded Mexican-blend cheese: 1.5 cups (6 oz) (170 g)
- plain nonfat Greek yogurt (stirred into the filling): 1/2 cup (125 g)
- kosher salt: 1/2 tsp (3 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 375 °F / 190 °C. Lightly oil a 9x13 in / 23x33 cm baking dish.
2. In a large skillet, heat the oil over medium and cook the onion 4 minutes until soft. Add cumin and chili powder for 30 seconds. Pour in 2 cups of the enchilada sauce, add the whole chicken breasts, cover, and simmer on low 18-25 minutes, flipping once, until the thickest part reads 165 °F / 74 °C and the juices run clear.
3. Move the chicken to a board and shred it with two forks. Return it to the skillet with the beans, corn and salt, and stir. Take the pan off the heat and stir in the yogurt (off the heat so it does not curdle).
4. Spread 1/2 cup sauce on the bottom of the dish. Layer 4 tortillas (overlap them), then 1/3 of the filling, then 1/4 of the cheese. Repeat twice. Finish with the last 4 tortillas, the last of the sauce, and the rest of the cheese.
5. Cover with foil and bake 20 minutes. Uncover and bake 10-15 minutes more until the cheese is melted with a few browned spots and the sauce bubbles at the edges. The center must read 165 °F / 74 °C.
6. Let it rest 10 minutes so it cuts cleanly into 6 squares. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Wrap each square individually in parchment, then put in a freezer bag or container.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven for 30-35 min. Slot it right after the sheet-pan proteins come out (425 °F to 375 °F: let the oven drop 10 minutes). The chicken simmers on the stove before that.

### SWAP

Swap the chicken for 2 lb of lean ground turkey, browned to 165 °F / 74 °C, or for 3 cups of extra beans plus 1 package of crumbled firm tofu (vegetarian). Use dairy-free cheese for a dairy-free version.

### FIX IT

- Soggy bottom: the filling was too wet. Simmer the shredded chicken 2 minutes uncovered before layering, and rest the bake 10 minutes before cutting.
- Tortillas tear while layering: warm them 20 seconds in the microwave wrapped in a damp towel.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM5 Turkey Sausage & Lentil Soup

**Makes** 6 portions (~555 g each) **Active** 20 min **Total** 65 min

| 560 KCAL | 28 g PROTEIN | 50 g CARBS | 30 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.70 | ALLERGENS<br>wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min, adding 1/4 cup water or broth per portion because the barley keeps drinking liquid, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Microwave covered 3-4 min, stirring halfway.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B6 Wraps & Tortillas (for dipping, toasted), V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad, S9 Chimichurri (a spoonful on top)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- fully cooked smoked turkey sausage, sliced into coins: 1 lb (454 g)
- olive oil: 1.5 tbsp (21 g)
- yellow onion, diced: 1 large (200 g)
- carrots, diced: 3 medium (200 g)
- celery, diced: 3 stalks (120 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- dried thyme: 1 tsp (2 g)
- brown or green lentils, dry, rinsed: 1.25 cups (250 g)
- diced tomatoes with their juice: 1 can (14.5 oz) (411 g)
- low-sodium chicken broth: 7 cups (1680 g)
- kale, stems removed, chopped: 3 cups packed (90 g)
- pearled barley: 1/4 cup (50 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat 2 tsp of the oil in a large pot over medium-high heat. Add the sausage coins and cook 4-5 minutes until browned on both sides. Take them out and set aside.
2. Add the rest of the oil, onion, carrot and celery. Cook 6 minutes until the onion is soft and see-through. Add garlic and thyme for 30 seconds.
3. Add the lentils, barley, tomatoes with juice, broth and salt. Bring to a boil, lower to a steady simmer, and partly cover. Cook 30 minutes.
4. Add the sausage back and the kale. Simmer 10 more minutes. The soup is done when the lentils and barley are tender with no hard center and the kale is dark green and soft.
5. Taste and adjust the salt. The soup will thicken as it cools; that is normal. The soup must read 165 °F / 74 °C or more before you portion.
6. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace; soup expands. Freeze in zip bags laid flat if short on space.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop. Start at minute 10; simmers on its own from minute 25. Pairs with a long oven item like P2 or P7.

### SWAP

Swap the sausage for 1.5 cups of diced cooked chicken breast added in the last 5 minutes, or for a second can of chickpeas (vegetarian, check the broth). Gluten-free: leave out the barley and add 1/2 cup more lentils.

### FIX IT

- Soup turned into stew overnight: the barley and lentils absorbed the broth. Add broth or water when reheating until it looks like soup again.
- Lentils split into mush: you cooked too hard. Keep a lazy simmer with small bubbles, not a rolling boil.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM6 Chicken Tortilla Soup

**Makes** 6 portions (~655 g each) **Active** 20 min **Total** 50 min

| 560 KCAL | 58 g PROTEIN | 43 g CARBS | 19 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $3.60 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min or microwave covered 3-4 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Add toppings after heating.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B1 Hands-Off Oven Rice (a scoop in the bowl), S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt, V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- boneless skinless chicken breasts: 2.2 lb (1000 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- yellow onion, diced: 1 large (200 g)
- jalapeño, seeded and minced: 1 (30 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- chili powder: 1 tbsp (8 g)
- ground cumin: 2 tsp (5 g)
- diced tomatoes with green chilies: 1 can (14.5 oz) (411 g)
- low-sodium chicken broth: 6 cups (1440 g)
- black beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- pinto beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 1 can (15 oz) (240 g)
- frozen corn kernels: 1 cup (150 g)
- lime juice: 3 tbsp (45 g)
- fresh cilantro, chopped: 1/2 cup (15 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)
- corn tortillas, cut in strips (topping, baked fresh on serving day): 6 (156 g)
- shredded Monterey Jack (1 oz per portion): 6 oz (170 g)

*Nutrition note: includes the tortilla strips and 28 g of cheese topping*

## STEPS

1. Heat the oil in a large pot over medium-high heat. Cook the onion and jalapeño 5 minutes until soft. Add garlic, chili powder and cumin for 30 seconds.
2. Add the tomatoes with chilies and the broth. Lay the whole chicken breasts in the pot. Bring to a boil, then lower to a gentle simmer, cover, and cook 18-20 minutes until the thickest breast reads 165 °F / 74 °C and is white inside.
3. Move the chicken to a board and shred with two forks. Return it to the pot with both beans and the corn. Simmer 5 more minutes.
4. Off the heat, stir in the lime juice, cilantro and salt. Taste: it should taste bright, not flat.
5. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
6. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Freeze the soup only. The tortilla strips and cheese are added on serving day.
7. Serving-day topping (macros include it): toss the strips with a little spray oil, bake at 400 °F / 200 °C for 8-10 minutes until crisp and light golden. Top each bowl with the strips and 1 oz / 28 g cheese.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop. Start at minute 15; 35 minutes of mostly waiting. The tortilla strips go in the oven for 10 minutes on the day you eat it, not on Sunday.

### SWAP

Swap chicken breast for thighs (same weight) for juicier meat; they need about 25 minutes. Dairy-free: skip the cheese and top with sliced avocado on serving day.

### FIX IT

- Chicken stringy and dry: it boiled hard. Keep the simmer lazy and pull the breasts out the minute they hit 165 °F / 74 °C.
- Soup tastes like plain broth: add salt a pinch at a time and another splash of lime juice at the end, never before the simmer.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM7 Teriyaki Chicken Fried Rice

**Makes** 6 portions (~310 g each) **Active** 30 min **Total** 45 min

| 500 KCAL | 38 g PROTEIN | 54 g CARBS | 14 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.80 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, soy, wheat, sesame |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered with 1 tbsp water 2-3 min, stirring halfway, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center; or reheat in a skillet over medium-high 4-5 min.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V1 Charred Roasted Broccoli, V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw, S6 Gochujang-Honey

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- long-grain white rice, dry (cook ahead and chill): 1.5 cups (300 g)
- boneless skinless chicken breasts, cut in 3/4 in cubes: 1.5 lb (700 g)
- canola oil: 2 tbsp (28 g)
- toasted sesame oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- large eggs, beaten: 4 (200 g)
- frozen mixed vegetables (peas, carrots, corn, green beans): 1 bag (14 oz) (400 g)
- scallions, sliced: 4 (50 g)
- garlic, minced: 3 cloves (9 g)
- fresh ginger, grated: 1 tbsp (10 g)
- teriyaki sauce: 6 tbsp (100 g)
- low-sodium soy sauce: 2 tbsp (36 g)

## STEPS

1. Cook the rice ahead: 1.5 cups rice with 3 cups water, covered, 15-18 minutes until all the water is absorbed. Spread it on a sheet pan to cool 20 minutes, then chill it uncovered in the fridge at least 1 hour (cold, dry rice fries better and stays safe). Use it within 24 hours.
2. Heat 1 tbsp canola oil in your largest skillet or wok over high heat. Add the chicken in a single layer and cook 5-6 minutes, turning, until golden and white inside (165 °F / 74 °C). Move to a bowl.
3. Add the other 1 tbsp canola oil, pour in the eggs, and scramble 1-2 minutes until fully set with no runny parts. Move them to the chicken bowl.
4. Add the sesame oil, garlic, ginger and the white parts of the scallions. Cook 30 seconds. Add the frozen vegetables and cook 3 minutes until hot and bright.
5. Add the cold rice, breaking up clumps. Stir-fry 4 minutes until the rice is hot and a few grains look toasted. Pour in the teriyaki and soy sauce and toss 1 minute.
6. Return the chicken and eggs. Toss 1 minute until everything is steaming. Stir in the green scallion tops. If your pan is small, cook in 2 batches. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Fried rice freezes best in flat, thin layers; press it to about 1 in / 2.5 cm thick.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, last. Cook the rice the night before, so on Sunday this is a 20 minute active job once the other burners are free.

### SWAP

Swap the rice for quinoa (B2) or cauliflower rice (lower carbs, cut the rice and add 4 cups). Gluten-free: use tamari and a gluten-free teriyaki.

### FIX IT

- Mushy, clumpy rice: the rice was warm or too wet. Chill it fully, uncovered, and use a hot pan.
- Bland: add 1 tsp soy sauce at the end, not more teriyaki (it is sweet). A squeeze of lime lifts it.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM8 Turkey Meatball & Orzo Bake

**Makes** 6 portions (~380 g each) **Active** 30 min **Total** 65 min

**Oven** 400 °F / 205 °C

| 530 | 39 g | 53 g | 19 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.90 | ALLERGENS<br>egg, wheat, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 3-4 min with 1 tbsp water on top, or bake covered at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V3 Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion, V4 Garlic Green Beans, S9 Chimichurri

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- lean ground turkey (93/7): 1.5 lb (680 g)
- large egg: 1 (50 g)
- plain dry breadcrumbs: 1/3 cup (40 g)
- grated Parmesan: 1/4 cup (25 g)
- yellow onion, grated: 1/2 medium (75 g)
- garlic, minced: 4 cloves (12 g)
- dried oregano: 1 tsp (2 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)
- marinara sauce, no sugar added: 1 jar (24 oz) (680 g)
- low-sodium chicken broth: 2 cups (480 g)
- dry orzo (or other small pasta): 1.5 cups (270 g)
- baby spinach, chopped: 4 oz (115 g)
- shredded part-skim mozzarella: 1 cup (4 oz) (115 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 400 °F / 200 °C. Mix the turkey, egg, breadcrumbs, Parmesan, onion, garlic, oregano and salt with your hands until just combined (overmixing makes tough meatballs). Roll into 24 meatballs, about 1.5 in / 4 cm each.
2. Stir the marinara, broth and orzo together in a 9x13 in / 23x33 cm baking dish. Stir in the spinach. Nestle the meatballs on top.
3. Cover tightly with foil. Bake 30 minutes.
4. Uncover, stir the orzo gently (it can stick at the edges), and scatter the mozzarella on top. Bake 10-12 more minutes until the cheese is melted with browned spots, the orzo is tender with no hard center, and a meatball cut open reads 165 °F / 74 °C and shows no pink.
5. Rest 10 minutes; the orzo soaks up the last of the sauce. Cut into 6 portions (4 meatballs each).
6. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Freeze in single-portion containers; the orzo is softer after thawing, which is normal.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven for 40-45 min at 400 °F / 200 °C. Slot it with the 425 °F sheet-pan proteins; the stovetop stays free for soups.

### SWAP

Swap the orzo for the same weight of any small pasta, or for brown rice (needs 50 minutes covered). Dairy-free: skip the Parmesan and mozzarella and add 1/2 tsp salt.

### FIX IT

- Orzo crunchy in the middle: the dish was not covered tight or the oven runs cool. Add 1/4 cup hot water, cover again, and bake 8 more minutes.
- Dry meatballs: you used too much breadcrumb or mixed too long. Keep the 1.5 lb turkey to 1/3 cup crumbs and mix just until combined.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM9 Black Bean & Sweet Potato Burritos

**Makes** 6 burritos (1 per portion, ~350 g each) **Active** 30 min **Total** 55 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 530 | 24 g | 70 g | 18 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.85 | ALLERGENS<br>**wheat, soy, milk** |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave unwrapped, wrapped in a damp paper towel, 1.5-2 min, flipping once; or bake at 375 °F / 190 °C for 20 min. The center must reach 165 °F / 74 °C. Finish in a dry skillet 1 min per side for a crisp outside.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** S1 Chipotle-Lime Yogurt, S2 Tomatillo Salsa Verde, V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- sweet potatoes, peeled and cut in 1/2 in cubes: 1.3 lb (600 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- firm tofu, crumbled: 1 block (16 oz) (454 g)
- chili powder: 1 tbsp (8 g)
- ground cumin: 2 tsp (5 g)
- garlic powder: 1 tsp (3 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)
- red bell pepper, diced: 1 (150 g)
- black beans, canned, drained and rinsed: 2 cans (15 oz) (480 g)
- shredded Mexican-blend cheese: 1 cup (4 oz) (115 g)
- large flour tortillas (10 in): 6 (390 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Toss the sweet potato and pepper with the oil, 1 tsp of the chili powder and half the salt on a sheet pan. Roast 20-25 minutes, stirring once, until a fork goes in easily and the edges are browned.
2. While they roast, press the tofu between paper towels for 5 minutes. Crumble it into a nonstick skillet over medium-high heat with the rest of the chili powder, cumin, garlic powder and salt. Cook 6-8 minutes until it looks dry, golden and crumbly like scrambled egg.
3. Mash half the black beans lightly with a fork and leave the rest whole. Mix beans, tofu and roasted vegetables in a big bowl. Taste and add salt if needed. Let the filling cool 10 minutes (hot filling makes the tortilla soggy and steams in the freezer).
4. Warm the tortillas 15 seconds each in the microwave so they fold without cracking. Put about 1 cup filling and 2.5 tbsp cheese in the lower third of each tortilla. Fold in the sides, then roll up tightly.
5. Cool completely at room temperature, no longer than 2 hours total. Wrap each burrito in parchment, then foil or a freezer bag. Press out the air.
6. Freeze flat on a tray for 1 hour, then stack. Label with the date.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven for 25 minutes at 425 °F / 220 °C, the same heat as the sheet-pan proteins. Rolling happens at the end, off the stove, while the oven items rest.

### SWAP

Swap the tofu for 2 cups of cooked shredded chicken (P2 or P3) for a meat version, still 165 °F / 74 °C. Dairy-free: skip the cheese. Gluten-free: use large corn or gluten-free tortillas and warm them well.

### FIX IT

- Burritos burst open: you overfilled them. Use about 1 cup of filling, and fold in the sides before rolling.
- Soggy after reheating: the filling was warm when rolled, or they sat wrapped warm. Cool them fully, and finish in a dry skillet.

FREEZER MEAL

# FM10 Creamy Chicken & Broccoli Pasta Bake

**Makes** 6 portions (~335 g each) **Active** 35 min **Total** 60 min

**Oven** 375 °F / 190 °C

| 530 | 45 g | 51 g | 16 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.35 | ALLERGENS<br>**wheat, milk** |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>2 months |

REHEAT

Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 2-3 min with 1 tbsp milk drizzled on top, stirring once; or bake covered at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V4 Garlic Green Beans, V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad, S12 Creamy Tomato-Garlic (a spoonful on the side)

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- boneless skinless chicken breasts, cut in 1 in cubes: 1.5 lb (700 g)
- dry short pasta (penne or rotini): 10 oz (285 g)
- broccoli florets, small: 4 cups (350 g)
- butter: 2 tbsp (28 g)
- all-purpose flour: 3 tbsp (25 g)
- garlic, minced: 3 cloves (9 g)
- 1% milk: 2.5 cups (620 g)
- light cream cheese: 3 oz (6 tbsp) (85 g)
- grated Parmesan: 1/2 cup (2 oz) (50 g)
- kosher salt: 1 tsp (5 g)
- black pepper: 1/2 tsp (1 g)
- shredded part-skim mozzarella: 3/4 cup (3 oz) (85 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 375 °F / 190 °C. Boil the pasta in salted water 3 minutes less than the package says (it finishes in the oven). Add the broccoli for the last 2 minutes. Drain; the pasta should be chewy in the center.
2. In a large skillet, cook the chicken in a little of the butter over medium-high heat 5-6 minutes until white inside and 165 °F / 74 °C. Move it to the pasta bowl.
3. In the same skillet melt the rest of the butter over medium. Whisk in the flour and garlic and cook 1 minute. Pour in the milk slowly, whisking, and cook 4-5 minutes until the sauce coats the back of a spoon and a finger drawn across it leaves a clean line.
4. Off the heat, whisk in the cream cheese until smooth, then the Parmesan, salt and pepper.
5. Toss the pasta, broccoli, chicken and sauce together and spread into a 9x13 in / 23x33 cm dish. Sprinkle with the mozzarella. Bake uncovered 20-25 minutes until bubbling at the edges and golden in spots; the center must read 165 °F / 74 °C.
6. Rest 10 minutes, cut into 6 squares. Cool fast: within 2 hours of cooking, ladle into shallow containers no deeper than 2 in / 5 cm. Leave uncovered about 20 minutes (or set the containers in an ice bath), then lid and refrigerate once the steam stops.
7. Portion and freeze: divide into 6 labeled containers (date on the lid), leave 1 in / 2.5 cm of headspace, and freeze flat. Wrap squares individually or freeze in flat containers.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven 20-25 min at 375 °F / 190 °C, with the pasta water and sauce on the stove first (minutes 0-30).

### SWAP

Swap the pasta for the same weight of dry whole-wheat pasta or chickpea pasta for more protein. Swap the chicken for 2 cups of canned white beans (vegetarian). Gluten-free: use gluten-free pasta and 3 tbsp cornstarch (instead of flour).

### FIX IT

- Lumpy sauce: the milk went in too fast. Whisk hard off the heat, or push the sauce through a sieve.
- Dry and thick after freezing: stir in 1 tbsp milk per portion when reheating. Cream sauces thicken in the freezer.

CHAPTER 19

# High-Protein Snacks

Eight snack boxes for between meals. Half need no cooking at all (SN1, SN2, SN6, SN7). Each one shows its protein, so you know what it adds to the day.

**HOW TO USE THIS BLOCK**

- **Make them with the rest of the Sunday session**, in the cold-prep gaps.
- **Most don't freeze.** The peanut butter bites (SN4) and roasted chickpeas (SN5) do.
- **Keep them cold:** at 40 °F / 4 °C or below, and no more than 2 hours out of the fridge (FSIS).
- **Peanuts and tree nuts** show up in this block (SN1, SN4, SN8). Check the column if you pack snacks for other people.

| ID | Recipe | Portion | kcal | Protein | Fridge | Freezer | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SN1 | Greek Yogurt Protein Cups (3 flavors) | 265 g | 280 | 25 g | 4 days | no | milk, peanuts, tree nuts |
| SN2 | Hummus & Veg Boxes | 280 g | 270 | 14 g | 4 days | no | sesame, milk |
| SN3 | Perfect Hard-Boiled Eggs | 100 g | 160 | 13 g | 7 days | no | egg |
| SN4 | Peanut Butter Oat Bites | 75 g | 330 | 11 g | 7 days | 3 mo | peanuts |
| SN5 | Crunchy Roasted Chickpeas | 105 g | 230 | 10 g | 5 days | 3 mo | — |
| SN6 | Turkey & Cheese Roll-Ups | 130 g | 210 | 22 g | 3 days | no | milk |
| SN7 | Cottage Cheese Ranch Dip | 270 g | 130 | 13 g | 5 days | no | milk |
| SN8 | Edamame Snack Boxes | 200 g | 220 | 15 g | 4 days | no | soy, tree nuts, sesame, wheat |

*Per portion. kcal rounded to 10, protein to 1 g, from USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA FSIS (Chapter 20). — = none of the 9 major US allergens; read your labels anyway.*

**Two snacks for this week: _____ · _____**

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*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition, per recipe). USDA FSIS, storage and reheating (Chapter 20). FDA, 9 major food allergens.*

SNACK

# SN1 Greek Yogurt Protein Cups (3 flavors)

**Makes** 5 portions (200 g yogurt + toppings; nutrition is the average of the 5 cups)

**Active** 10 min | **Total** 10 min

| 280 KCAL | 25 g PROTEIN | 26 g CARBS | 10 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $2.30 | ALLERGENS<br>**milk, peanuts, tree nuts** |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |

REHEAT
Eat cold. Do not freeze. Keep at 40 °F / 4 °C or colder; do not leave out more than 2 hours.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D3 Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats (same yogurt tub), D4 Peanut Butter-Banana Overnight Oats; stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- plain nonfat Greek yogurt: 4 cups (1000 g)
- strawberries, diced (Berry-Vanilla cups): 1 cup (150 g)
- honey (all flavors): 3 tbsp (63 g)
- vanilla extract (Berry-Vanilla): 1 tsp (4 g)
- unsweetened cocoa powder (Cocoa-Peanut cups): 2 tbsp (11 g)
- smooth peanut butter (Cocoa-Peanut cups): 4 tbsp (64 g)
- ground cinnamon (Cinnamon-Walnut cup): 1/2 tsp (1 g)
- chopped walnuts (Cinnamon-Walnut cup): 2 tbsp (15 g)
- chia seeds (Berry-Vanilla cups): 2 tsp (10 g)

## STEPS

1. Set out 5 jars or containers (about 1 1/4 cups / 300 ml each) with lids. Put 200 g (a heaping 3/4 cup) of yogurt in each. Weighing on a scale is the fastest way to get even cups.
2. Berry-Vanilla (2 cups): stir 2 tsp honey and 1/2 tsp vanilla into the yogurt of each cup until smooth. Top each with 75 g (about 1/2 cup) diced strawberries and 1 tsp chia seeds. The strawberries go on top, not stirred in, so the cup does not turn watery.
3. Cocoa-Peanut (2 cups): stir 1 tbsp cocoa and 1 tsp honey into the yogurt of each cup until there are no streaks. Spoon 2 tbsp peanut butter on top (warm it 10 seconds in the microwave so it spreads).
4. Cinnamon-Walnut (1 cup): stir 1 tbsp honey and the cinnamon into the yogurt. Top with the walnuts.
5. Done when each cup is smooth and thick like pudding with no dry cocoa clumps. Put on the lids and refrigerate right away.
6. Do not freeze: the yogurt separates and turns grainy. Add crunchy toppings (walnuts, granola) just before eating if you want them to stay crisp.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. Assemble in the last 10 minutes of the session, while the oven and stove items rest.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: use unsweetened soy yogurt (protein will be lower, about 8-10 g per cup). Nut-free: swap the peanut butter for sunflower seed butter and the walnuts for pumpkin seeds.

### FIX IT

- Watery cups: the yogurt wasn't strained. Pour off the liquid on top and stir; next time buy a thick Greek yogurt or strain 10 minutes in a sieve.
- Cocoa clumps: mix the cocoa with the honey first into a paste, then into the yogurt.

SNACK

# SN2 Hummus & Veg Boxes

**Makes** 5 portions (60 g hummus + 30 g cheese + 190 g raw veg) **Active** 15 min

**Total** 15 min

| 270 KCAL | 14 g PROTEIN | 22 g CARBS | 16 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.65 | ALLERGENS<br>sesame, milk |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |
| REHEAT<br>Eat cold. Not freezer-friendly (the vegetables turn limp). | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B6 Wraps & Tortillas, S8 Lemon-Tahini (use instead of hummus); stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- hummus, store-bought: 1 1/4 cups (300 g)
- part-skim mozzarella, cut in cubes (or string cheese): 5 oz (150 g)
- cucumber, cut in sticks: 1 large (400 g)
- carrots, cut in sticks: 4 medium (250 g)
- red bell pepper, cut in strips: 2 medium (300 g)
- everything bagel seasoning or paprika (pinch per box): 1 tsp (3 g)

## STEPS

1. Wash and dry all the vegetables completely (wet veg makes the box soggy and shortens its life). Cut cucumber, carrot and pepper into sticks about 3 in / 8 cm long.
2. Spoon 60 g (about 1/4 cup) of hummus into the small compartment of each of 5 containers, or into small lidded cups. Sprinkle a pinch of paprika on top.
3. Divide the cheese cubes (30 g each) and the vegetables (about 190 g each) between the boxes. Wrap the cheese in parchment if you want it fully dry.
4. Done when every box has hummus, cheese and three colors of veg with nothing touching the hummus except the dip cup. Lid and refrigerate.
5. Eat within 4 days. Keep the boxes cold (40 °F / 4 °C or below), especially in a lunch bag; use an ice pack if it will sit more than 2 hours.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 15 minutes, any time; it uses no oven or burner.

### SWAP

Dairy-free: swap the mozzarella for 1/2 cup of roasted chickpeas (SN5) per box. Sesame-free: use a hummus without tahini or mashed white beans with lemon and garlic.

### FIX IT

- Soggy sticks: dry the vegetables with a towel and store the hummus in its own cup.
- Cucumber turns watery by day 4: salt nothing in advance, and swap cucumber for celery after day 3.

SNACK

# SN3 Perfect Hard-Boiled Eggs

**Makes** 5 portions (2 large eggs (about 100 g peeled)) **Active** 5 min

**Total** 25 min

| 160 KCAL | 13 g PROTEIN | 1 g CARBS | 11 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.40 | ALLERGENS<br>egg |
| FRIDGE<br>7 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |

REHEAT
Eat cold. Do not microwave in the shell (they can burst). Do not freeze: the whites turn rubbery.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D1 Spinach-Feta Egg Bites (same protein, different style), V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw; stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- large eggs, cold from the fridge: 10 (500 g)
- kosher salt (pinch per portion): 1/2 tsp (3 g)
- smoked paprika or everything seasoning (optional, pinch per portion): 1/2 tsp (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Put the eggs in a single layer in a large pot. Cover with cold water by 1 in / 2.5 cm. Bring to a full rolling boil over high heat.
2. As soon as the water boils, cover the pot, turn off the heat, and slide it off the burner. Set a timer for 12 minutes.
3. While they sit, fill a big bowl with ice and water. When the timer rings, move the eggs into the ice bath for 10 minutes. Cold shock stops the cooking and makes them easy to peel.
4. Peel under a trickle of cool water, starting at the wide end where the air pocket is. A done egg has a fully set, pale yellow yolk with no green ring and no wet center.
5. Keep the eggs in their shells in a lidded container for up to 7 days; peeled eggs keep best in a container with a damp paper towel and are best within 5 days. Divide into 5 portions of 2 eggs. Add the salt and paprika when you eat them.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, minute 0. It is 12 minutes of waiting, so start it first and forget it.

### SWAP

Make them deviled-style: halve the eggs, mash the yolks with 1 tbsp plain Greek yogurt and 1 tsp mustard per 4 yolks, and spoon them back (eat within 3 days). Want fewer calories: eat 2 whole eggs plus 2 extra whites boiled the same way.

### FIX IT

- Green-gray ring around the yolk: they were overcooked. Stick to 12 minutes off heat and go straight to the ice bath.
- Shells stick: your eggs were very fresh. Use eggs 1-2 weeks old, and peel under water.

SNACK

# SN4 Peanut Butter Oat Bites

**Makes** 5 portions (3 bites (about 70 g)) **Active** 15 min **Total** 45 min

| 330 | 11 g | 38 g | 17 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.60 | ALLERGENS<br>peanuts |
| FRIDGE<br>7 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Eat cold or at room temperature. To freeze, set the bites on a tray for 1 hour, then bag them. Thaw 15 minutes on the counter or overnight in the fridge. (No raw egg or meat, so counter thawing is safe here.)

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** D4 Peanut Butter-Banana Overnight Oats; stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- old-fashioned rolled oats: 1 1/4 cups (120 g)
- smooth peanut butter: 1/2 cup (128 g)
- honey: 1/4 cup (85 g)
- ground flaxseed: 2 tbsp (20 g)
- unsweetened cocoa powder: 1 tbsp (8 g)
- vanilla extract: 1 tsp (4 g)
- kosher salt: 1/4 tsp (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Line a tray or plate with parchment. Mix the oats, flax, cocoa and salt in a bowl.
2. Warm the peanut butter and honey together in the microwave for 20 seconds (or in a small pot on low for 1 minute). Stir in the vanilla.
3. Pour the wet mix over the oats and stir until no dry oats remain. It should hold together when you squeeze a spoonful. If it is crumbly, add 1 tsp water; if it is sticky, add 1 tbsp oats.
4. Chill the bowl 15 minutes so the mix firms up and is easy to roll.
5. Roll into 15 balls, about 1 tbsp (25 g) each, and put them on the tray. Done when each ball is firm and holds its shape without leaving a greasy mark on your palm.
6. Chill 30 minutes more, then store in an airtight container. Divide into 5 portions of 3.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold, no cooking. 15 minutes of work. Do it while an oven item bakes and finish the chilling in the fridge.

### SWAP

Peanut-free: use sunflower seed butter (same amount). Lower sugar: use 3 tbsp honey and add 1 tbsp more oats.

### FIX IT

- Too crumbly: add 1 tsp water or 1 tsp honey, mix, and test again.
- Too sticky to roll: chill the bowl 15 more minutes, or wet your hands lightly.

SNACK

# SN5 Crunchy Roasted Chickpeas

**Makes** 5 portions (about 100 g roasted (3/4 cup)) **Active** 10 min **Total** 50 min

**Oven** 425 °F / 220 °C

| 230 KCAL | 10 g PROTEIN | 34 g CARBS | 7 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $0.50 | ALLERGENS<br>none |
| FRIDGE<br>5 days | FREEZER<br>3 months |

REHEAT

Re-crisp in a 400 °F / 200 °C oven or air fryer for 5 minutes. Counter: 2 days in a loosely closed jar. Fridge: 5 days, but they soften. Freezer: 3 months in a bag; re-crisp from frozen.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** P10 Smoky Spiced Chickpeas (a bigger, saucier version), V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (as a crunchy topper); stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed: 3 cans (15 oz) (720 g)
- olive oil: 1 tbsp (14 g)
- smoked paprika: 2 tsp (5 g)
- garlic powder: 1 tsp (3 g)
- ground cumin: 1 tsp (2 g)
- kosher salt: 3/4 tsp (4 g)

## STEPS

1. Heat the oven to 425 °F / 220 °C. Dry the chickpeas very well: roll them in a clean towel and rub off the loose skins. Dry chickpeas turn crisp; wet ones steam and stay soft.
2. Spread them on two sheet pans (don't crowd them). Toss with the oil until lightly glossy.
3. Roast 25-30 minutes, shaking the pans every 10 minutes. They are done when they rattle on the pan, look deep golden, and one cooled chickpea crunches when bitten.
4. Right out of the oven, toss with the paprika, garlic powder, cumin and salt so the spices stick to the hot oil.
5. Cool fully on the pans (15 minutes) before storing, or steam in the container will make them soft. Divide into 5 portions of about 3/4 cup / 100 g.
6. Store in a container that is not fully sealed for the first day, then close it. They are crispest the first 2 days.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Oven at 425 °F / 220 °C for 25-30 min on the second rack. Same heat as the sheet-pan proteins, so they ride along.

### SWAP

Sweet version: skip the paprika, garlic and cumin; toss with 1 tsp cinnamon and 1 tbsp honey after roasting. Swap the chickpeas for canned white beans (they roast softer).

### FIX IT

- Chewy, not crisp: not dry enough or the pan was crowded. Dry them again, use two pans, and roast 8 minutes longer.
- Burnt on the outside, soft inside: the oven runs hot. Drop to 400 °F / 200 °C and roast 5 minutes longer.

SNACK

# SN6 Turkey & Cheese Roll-Ups

**Makes** 5 portions (3 roll-ups (about 135 g)) **Active** 15 min **Total** 15 min

| 210 KCAL | 22 g PROTEIN | 4 g CARBS | 11 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.90 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>3 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |

REHEAT
Eat cold. Do not freeze (cheese and cucumber go grainy and watery).

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** B6 Wraps & Tortillas (roll a few inside a wrap for a lunch), V6 Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad; stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- low-sodium deli turkey breast slices: 10 oz (about 15 slices) (300 g)
- Swiss cheese slices: 5 oz (15 slices) (150 g)
- light cream cheese: 3 tbsp (45 g)
- cucumber, cut in thin sticks: 1 medium (150 g)

## STEPS

1. Lay out 15 slices of turkey on a clean board. Spread a thin layer of cream cheese (about 1 tsp) over each slice, leaving a 1/2 in / 1 cm border.
2. Top each with a slice of Swiss and a cucumber stick laid across one end.
3. Roll up tightly from the cucumber end. Done when the roll holds closed on its own without tearing the turkey.
4. Pack 3 roll-ups per container, seam side down, with a sheet of parchment between layers so they don't stick.
5. Keep cold at 40 °F / 4 °C or below and eat within 3 days. Deli meat is a higher-risk food; if you are pregnant or have a weak immune system, heat deli meat to steaming (165 °F / 74 °C) before eating, or choose another snack.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 15 minutes at the end of the session. Make it the same day you shop, since deli meat is best fresh.

### SWAP

Swap the Swiss for provolone or part-skim mozzarella slices. Dairy-free: skip the cheese and use a smear of hummus. Swap the turkey for roast chicken breast deli slices.

### FIX IT

- Rolls come undone: the cream cheese layer was too thin or the slices too cold and stiff. Let them sit out 5 minutes and spread to the edge.
- Cucumber leaks water: pat the sticks dry on paper towel, or use bell pepper strips instead.

SNACK

# SN7 Cottage Cheese Ranch Dip

**Makes** 5 portions (1/2 cup dip (120 g) + about 150 g raw veg) **Active** 10 min

**Total** 10 min

| 130 | 13 g | 14 g | 2 g |
|---|---|---|---|
| KCAL | PROTEIN | CARBS | FAT |

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.40 | ALLERGENS<br>milk |
| FRIDGE<br>5 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |
| REHEAT<br>Eat cold. Do not freeze: it splits and turns grainy. | |

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw, B6 Wraps & Tortillas (as a spread), P3 Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast (as a dip for sliced chicken); stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- 2% cottage cheese: 2 cups (450 g)
- plain nonfat Greek yogurt: 1/2 cup (125 g)
- lemon juice: 1 tbsp (15 g)
- garlic powder: 1/2 tsp (2 g)
- onion powder: 1/2 tsp (2 g)
- dried dill: 1 tsp (1 g)
- fresh parsley, finely chopped: 2 tbsp (8 g)
- kosher salt: 1/2 tsp (3 g)
- baby carrots: 10 oz (300 g)
- celery sticks: 5 stalks (250 g)
- cucumber, in rounds: 1 large (200 g)

## STEPS

1. Put the cottage cheese, yogurt, lemon juice, garlic powder, onion powder and dill in a blender or food processor.
2. Blend 45-60 seconds, scraping down once, until completely smooth and pourable like thick sour cream, with no visible curds.
3. Stir in the parsley and salt by hand. Taste: it should be tangy and savory. Add a pinch more salt or a few drops of lemon if needed.
4. Spoon 1/2 cup (120 g) of dip into each of 5 small lidded containers or jars. Chill at least 1 hour; it thickens as it chills.
5. Cut the veg (carrots, celery, cucumber) and divide into the 5 boxes, about 150 g each. Keep the dip and the veg in separate compartments.
6. Eat within 5 days. Stir before eating since a little liquid may rise to the top.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Cold. 10 minutes, any time. A blender and nothing else.

### SWAP

Lactose-light: use lactose-free cottage cheese. Spicy: add 1 tsp hot sauce. Swap the veg for whole-wheat pita triangles or the baked chickpeas from SN5.

### FIX IT

- Dip too thin: strain the cottage cheese 10 minutes before blending, or stir in 2 tbsp more yogurt.
- Tastes bland: it needs salt and acid. Add salt in pinches and a squeeze of lemon, then rest it 30 minutes so the flavor develops.

SNACK

# SN8 Edamame Snack Boxes

**Makes** 5 portions (about 90 g shelled edamame + 90 g veg + 14 g almonds)

**Active** 10 min **Total** 20 min

| 220 KCAL | 15 g PROTEIN | 15 g CARBS | 13 g FAT |
|---|---|---|---|

PER PORTION · USDA FoodData Central

| | |
|---|---|
| COST / PORTION<br>about $1.65 | ALLERGENS<br>soy, tree nuts, sesame, wheat |
| FRIDGE<br>4 days | FREEZER<br>not recommended (see Reheat) |

REHEAT
Eat cold, or warm the edamame alone 30 seconds in the microwave. The assembled box is not freezer-friendly (vegetables go limp); plain cooked edamame freezes for 3 months.

Cost: US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs, dairy: Sep 2026; fruit and vegetables: 2023 data); your store will differ.

**Goes with:** V5 Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw, A2 and A7 plates (a spoonful on top); stands alone as a snack

## INGREDIENTS (US + metric)

- frozen shelled edamame: 1 bag (16 oz) (454 g)
- cherry tomatoes, halved: 2 cups (300 g)
- red bell pepper, cut in strips: 1 medium (150 g)
- dry-roasted almonds: 1/4 cup (70 g)
- toasted sesame oil: 1 tsp (5 g)
- low-sodium soy sauce: 2 tsp (12 g)
- flaky sea salt (pinch per box): 1/4 tsp (1 g)

## STEPS

1. Bring a pot of water to a boil. Add the frozen edamame and cook 4-5 minutes until they are bright green and tender with a little bite, and taste fully warm all the way through.
2. Drain and cool in a colander under cold water for 1 minute. Shake dry and pat with a towel. Wet edamame turn the box soggy.
3. Toss the edamame with the sesame oil, soy sauce and half the salt in a bowl.
4. Divide into 5 containers (about 90 g edamame each). Add the tomato halves and pepper strips (about 90 g of veg per box), and pack the almonds (14 g) in a small cup or corner so they stay crunchy.
5. Done when the edamame look glossy, not wet. Lid and chill right away. Eat within 4 days. Keep at 40 °F / 4 °C or colder.

### SUNDAY-SHEET SLOT

Stovetop, 5 minutes of active time. Boil the edamame while the oven items rest.

### SWAP

Soy-free is not possible with edamame; swap for 1 1/2 cups of roasted chickpeas (SN5) per 5 boxes. Nut-free: swap the almonds for pumpkin seeds. Gluten-free: use tamari.

### FIX IT

- Edamame tough and bland: they cooked too little or are old. Cook 2 minutes longer, and salt while they're still warm.
- Watery box: dry the edamame well and put the tomato in a separate cup if you pack it more than 2 days ahead.

# 4

PART 4

# Reference

20 · Storage Chart · All 60 Recipes

21 · Macro, Cost & Allergen Index

22 · When Things Go Wrong

23 · Blank Templates

CHAPTER 20

# Storage Chart · All 60 Recipes

> **"is it fine to store my food like this for four-five days?"**
>
> — thread title, meal prep forum

One table to check in 5 seconds: how long it keeps in the fridge, how long in the freezer, and how to bring it back. Print it and tape it inside a cupboard door (it's in the printable pack too).

## The rules behind the numbers

All from USDA Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS):

1. **Fridge at 40 °F (4 °C) or colder.** Cooked leftovers keep **3-4 days**. Count from the day you cook (day

0).

2. **The day-5 rule (this book):** anything you'll eat on day 5 or later goes in the freezer on cooking day. Move it to the fridge the morning before.
3. **2 hours max at room temperature** after cooking, **1 hour** if the room is above 90 °F (32 °C). Spread food shallow so it cools fast.
4. **Freezer at 0 °F (-18 °C).** Frozen food stays safe as long as it stays frozen. The months below are for **quality** (taste and texture), not safety.
5. **Thaw in the fridge,** never on the counter. Or on defrost in the microwave, then reheat and eat right away.
6. **Reheat leftovers to 165 °F (74 °C).** Cover, stir halfway, check the thickest piece.
7. **When in doubt, throw it out.** If it smells off or you don't know how old it is.

"Freezer: no (texture)" means the recipe is safe frozen but comes out watery, grainy or limp. Eat it from the fridge.

# The chart

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| B1 | Hands-Off Oven Rice | 4 | 2 | Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of water, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| B2 | Fluffy Quinoa | 4 | 3 | Microwave 60-90 sec with a splash of water, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| B3 | Crispy Roasted Baby Potatoes | 4 | no (texture) | Oven or air fryer, 400 °F / 205 °C for 8-10 minutes. Microwave makes them soft. |
| B4 | Roasted Sweet Potato Cubes | 4 | 3 | Microwave 60-90 sec, covered, or 8 minutes in a 400 °F / 205 °C oven to re-crisp. |
| B5 | Reheat-Ready Pasta | 4 | 2 | Microwave 60-90 sec with 1 tbsp of water or sauce, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| B6 | Wraps & Tortillas (Store & Assemble) | 7 | 2 | Warm 15 seconds per side in a dry pan, or 10 seconds in the microwave wrapped in a damp towel. Assemble the wrap at lunch. |
| D1 | Spinach-Feta Egg Bites | 4 | 3 | Microwave 2 bites 30-45 sec, 3 bites 45-60 sec, until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). From frozen: 90 sec at 50% power, then 30 sec at full. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| D2 | Turkey & Pepper Egg Bites | 4 | 3 | Microwave 2 bites 30-45 sec, 3 bites 45-60 sec, until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). From frozen: 90 sec at 50% power, then 30 sec at full. |
| D3 | Greek Yogurt Overnight Oats | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold, straight from the jar. Or microwave 60-90 sec and stir. |
| D4 | Peanut Butter-Banana Overnight Oats | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Or microwave 60-90 sec, stir, and add a splash of milk. |
| D5 | Freezer Breakfast Burritos | 4 | 3 | From frozen: unwrap, wrap in a damp paper towel and microwave 2 min, flip, then 45-60 sec more until hot in the middle (165 °F / 74 °C). Or thaw overnight in the fridge and microwave 60-90 sec. |
| D6 | Cottage Cheese Baked Oats | 4 | 2 | Microwave a square 60-90 sec until hot in the middle. Or 350 °F / 175 °C oven 10 min, covered. Good cold too. |
| D7 | Freezer Protein Pancakes | 4 | 3 | Toaster or toaster oven (375 °F / 190 °C) 4-5 min until hot and crisp at the edges. Or microwave 3 pancakes 45-60 sec. From frozen: add 1 min. |
| D8 | Turkey Sausage & Sweet Potato Hash | 4 | 3 | Skillet over medium heat 3-4 min, or microwave 90 sec, stirring once, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FM1 | Turkey Three-Bean Chili | 4 | 3 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat covered in the microwave 3-4 min, stirring halfway, or in a pot over medium 6-8 min, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. |
| FM2 | Chicken Tikka-Style Curry | 3 | 3 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 3-4 min, stirring halfway, adding 1 tbsp water to the rice; or reheat the curry in a pan over medium 6-8 min. It must reach 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. |
| FM3 | Beef & Lentil Ragù | 4 | 3 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min (or microwave covered 3-4 min), stirring, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Meanwhile boil 1.75 oz / 50 g dry pasta per portion for the time on the package minus 1 minute, and toss it with the hot ragù. Nutrition below includes this pasta and the Parmesan. |
| FM4 | Chicken Enchilada Bake | 3 | 2 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave 2-3 min on a plate, covered, until steaming; or bake at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min covered with foil. Center must reach 165 °F / 74 °C. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FM5 | Turkey Sausage & Lentil Soup | 4 | 3 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min, adding 1/4 cup water or broth per portion because the barley keeps drinking liquid, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Microwave covered 3-4 min, stirring halfway. |
| FM6 | Chicken Tortilla Soup | 3 | 3 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Reheat in a pot over medium 6-8 min or microwave covered 3-4 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. Add toppings after heating. |
| FM7 | Teriyaki Chicken Fried Rice | 3 | 2 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered with 1 tbsp water 2-3 min, stirring halfway, until steaming and 165 °F / 74 °C in the center; or reheat in a skillet over medium-high 4-5 min. |
| FM8 | Turkey Meatball & Orzo Bake | 3 | 2 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 3-4 min with 1 tbsp water on top, or bake covered at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FM9 | Black Bean & Sweet Potato Burritos | 3 | 2 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave unwrapped, wrapped in a damp paper towel, 1.5-2 min, flipping once; or bake at 375 °F / 190 °C for 20 min. The center must reach 165 °F / 74 °C. Finish in a dry skillet 1 min per side for a crisp outside. |
| FM10 | Creamy Chicken & Broccoli Pasta Bake | 3 | 2 | Thaw overnight in the fridge (never on the counter). Microwave covered 2-3 min with 1 tbsp milk drizzled on top, stirring once; or bake covered at 350 °F / 175 °C for 15-20 min, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the center. |
| P1 | Lemon-Garlic Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs | 4 | 3 | Microwave 60-90 sec, covered, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| P2 | Slow-Cooker Salsa Shredded Chicken | 4 | 3 | Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of its cooking juices, stir halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| P3 | Never-Dry Baked Chicken Breast | 4 | 3 | Microwave at 70% power for 60-90 sec, or slice and warm in a covered pan with a splash of water. Never full power for long. |
| P4 | Turkey Taco Crumble | 4 | 3 | Microwave 90 sec, stirring halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| P5 | Beef & Lentil Power Mince | 4 | 3 | Microwave 90 sec, stirring halfway, until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| P6 | Freezer Turkey Meatballs | 4 | 3 | Microwave 6 meatballs 60-90 sec, or 12 min at 350 °F / 175 °C from frozen, until 165 °F / 74 °C in the centre. |
| P7 | Oven Pulled Pork Shoulder | 4 | 3 | Microwave 90 sec with 1 tbsp of its juices until steaming hot (165 °F / 74 °C). |
| P8 | Simple Baked Salmon | 3 | 2 | Eat cold, or microwave at 50% power 60-90 sec. Do not boil it; it dries and smells. |
| P9 | Crispy Baked Tofu | 4 | 2 | Oven or air fryer, 400 °F / 205 °C for 6-8 minutes to bring back the crisp. Microwave makes it soft. |
| P10 | Smoky Spiced Chickpeas | 4 | 2 | Microwave 60 sec, or 5 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer to bring back the edges. |
| S1 | Chipotle-Lime Yogurt | 4 | no (texture) | Serve cold. Don't heat it. Stir before using. |
| S2 | Tomatillo Salsa Verde | 4 | 3 | Eat cold or at room temperature. For a warm sauce, simmer 3 min in a small pan. |
| S3 | Quick Red Enchilada Sauce | 4 | 3 | Warm in a small pan or microwave 30-45 sec until steaming. |
| S4 | Lighter Teriyaki | 4 | 3 | Warm in a pan or microwave 30 sec. Stir; it thickens as it cools. |
| S5 | Peanut-Ginger Sauce | 4 | 2 | Serve cool or room temperature. Thin with 1 tsp warm water if it has set firm. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| S6 | Gochujang-Honey Sauce | 4 | 3 | Serve cool or warm 20 sec in the microwave. It thickens in the fridge; stir in a splash of water. |
| S7 | Tzatziki | 4 | no (texture) | Serve cold. Don't heat. A little water on top is normal; stir it back in. |
| S8 | Lemon-Tahini Sauce | 4 | 2 | Serve cool. It sets firm in the fridge; whisk in 1 Tbsp water per portion. |
| S9 | Chimichurri | 4 | 3 | Thaw in the fridge overnight, or at room temperature 20 min only, then stir. |
| S10 | Smoky BBQ Sauce (Less Sugar) | 4 | 3 | Warm in a pan or microwave 30 sec. Stir. |
| S11 | Honey-Mustard Yogurt | 4 | no (texture) | Serve cold. Don't heat. |
| S12 | Creamy Tomato-Garlic Sauce | 4 | 2 | Warm in a pan over low heat, whisking, or microwave at 50% power 45 sec. Stir. |
| SN1 | Greek Yogurt Protein Cups (3 flavors) | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Do not freeze. Keep at 40 °F / 4 °C or colder; do not leave out more than 2 hours. |
| SN2 | Hummus & Veg Boxes | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Not freezer-friendly (the vegetables turn limp). |
| SN3 | Perfect Hard-Boiled Eggs | 7 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Do not microwave in the shell (they can burst). Do not freeze: the whites turn rubbery. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SN4 | Peanut Butter Oat Bites | 7 | 3 | Eat cold or at room temperature. To freeze, set the bites on a tray for 1 hour, then bag them. Thaw 15 minutes on the counter or overnight in the fridge. (No raw egg or meat, so counter thawing is safe here.) |
| SN5 | Crunchy Roasted Chickpeas | 5 | 3 | Re-crisp in a 400 °F / 200 °C oven or air fryer for 5 minutes. Counter: 2 days in a loosely closed jar. Fridge: 5 days, but they soften. Freezer: 3 months in a bag; re-crisp from frozen. |
| SN6 | Turkey & Cheese Roll-Ups | 3 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Do not freeze (cheese and cucumber go grainy and watery). |
| SN7 | Cottage Cheese Ranch Dip | 5 | no (texture) | Eat cold. Do not freeze: it splits and turns grainy. |
| SN8 | Edamame Snack Boxes | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold, or warm the edamame alone 30 seconds in the microwave. The assembled box is not freezer-friendly (vegetables go limp); plain cooked edamame freezes for 3 months. |
| V1 | Charred Roasted Broccoli | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold in bowls, or 10 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer. Microwave makes it soft but it is safe. |
| V2 | Sheet-Pan Fajita Peppers & Onions | 4 | 3 | Microwave 60 sec, or a hot dry pan for 3 minutes for better texture. |

| ID | Recipe | Fridge (days) | Freezer (months) | Reheat |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| V3 | Roasted Zucchini & Red Onion | 3 | no (texture) | Eat cold, or microwave 45 sec. Best on the first 3 days; it gets watery after. |
| V4 | Garlic Green Beans | 4 | no (texture) | Eat cold in bowls, or microwave 45-60 sec. |
| V5 | Sesame Cabbage-Carrot Slaw (raw) | 4 | no (texture) | Not reheated. Eat cold. Keep the dressing in a jar and toss on the day for crunch. |
| V6 | Chopped Cucumber-Tomato Salad (raw) | 3 | no (texture) | Not reheated. Eat cold. Add the dressing on the day. |

*Fridge days come from the recipe cards, set within the FSIS 3-4 day guidance for cooked leftovers. Raw-vegetable and dairy items (V5, V6, sauces, snacks) use their own card times. Hard-boiled eggs (SN3) and tortillas (B6) keep longer: 7 days, following FSIS for eggs and the package for tortillas.*

To print: this chart is pages 12-13 of the printable pack. Tape it inside a cupboard door.

**YOUR ACTION**

- [ ] Check your fridge thermometer now: _____ °F. Freezer: _____ °F.
- [ ] Circle this week's recipes in the chart. Find the shortest fridge time: _____ days. Those boxes are eaten first.

---

*Sources: USDA FSIS (fsis.usda.gov): "Leftovers and Food Safety", "Refrigeration and Food Safety", "Freezing and Food Safety", "The Big Thaw: Safe Defrosting Methods", "Danger Zone (40 °F-140 °F)", "Shell Eggs from Farm to Table".*

CHAPTER 21

# Macro, Cost & Allergen Index

> **"Presenting the macros is a great plus."**
>
> — reader review

Looking for the plate with the most protein? One without milk? This index lists all 48 signature plates, sorted by protein, highest first. Then it lists which plates are free of each allergen.

## How the numbers were made

- One box = one standard portion of each of the 4 parts (protein, base, vegetable, sauce), as on the recipe cards.

- Calculated from **USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy** with the gram weight of every ingredient, sauce included. Kcal rounded to 10, protein, carbs and fat to 1 g.
- Your boxes in the plan weeks can differ, because some batches are shared by more or fewer boxes. The week chapters show those numbers.
- These numbers describe the food. They are not advice on how much to eat. For that, talk to a registered dietitian or your doctor.

**At a glance:** plates run from 510 to 850 kcal. 42 of 48 have 40 g of protein or more. The 6 under 40 g are the beef-and-lentil plates (M4, D-6, C5) and the chickpea plates (M7, D-2, D-9). Their real number is shown, not rounded up.

## All 48 plates, by protein

| Plate | Name | kcal | Protein | Carbs | Fat | Fridge | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A12 | Peanut Pulled Pork Power Bowl | 850 | 70 g | 57 g | 39 g | 4 d | peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat |
| C2 | Smoky BBQ Pulled Pork & Sweet Potato | 800 | 63 g | 68 g | 32 g | 4 d | fish |
| C11 | BBQ Pulled Pork Rice Plate | 790 | 61 g | 70 g | 29 g | 4 d | fish |

| Plate | Name | kcal | Protein | Carbs | Fat | Fridge | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A3 | Gochujang Pulled Pork Rice Bowl | 800 | 61 g | 68 g | 31 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| M5 | Pulled Pork Salsa Verde Bowl with Crunch Slaw | 780 | 60 g | 66 g | 30 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| A5 | Peanut Chicken Sweet Potato Bowl | 700 | 57 g | 61 g | 27 g | 4 d | peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat |
| D-11 | Tahini Chicken & Crispy Potatoes | 650 | 56 g | 49 g | 26 g | 4 d | sesame |
| C4 | Honey-Mustard Chicken Rice Plate | 630 | 55 g | 63 g | 17 g | 4 d | milk |
| C9 | Honey-Mustard Chicken Wrap | 560 | 55 g | 41 g | 18 g | 3 d | milk, wheat |
| D-4 | Chicken Tzatziki Wrap | 540 | 54 g | 36 g | 20 g | 3 d | milk, wheat |
| M11 | Enchilada Chicken Fajita Wrap | 560 | 54 g | 49 g | 18 g | 4 d | wheat |
| C8 | BBQ Chicken Fajita Wrap | 570 | 53 g | 55 g | 16 g | 4 d | fish, wheat |
| M9 | Salsa Chicken & Crispy Potato Bowl | 570 | 53 g | 51 g | 18 g | 3 d | — |
| M2 | Salsa Verde Chicken Rice Bowl | 600 | 52 g | 62 g | 15 g | 3 d | — |
| C7 | Creamy Tomato Chicken Pasta | 730 | 52 g | 69 g | 28 g | 4 d | milk, wheat |
| A11 | Sweet-Heat Chicken & Sweet Potato | 620 | 52 g | 58 g | 20 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| C3 | Creamy Tomato Meatball Pasta | 790 | 52 g | 74 g | 33 g | 3 d | egg, milk, wheat |
| A10 | Teriyaki Meatball Noodle Bowl | 770 | 51 g | 79 g | 28 g | 4 d | egg, milk, sesame, soy, wheat |
| A8 | Peanut-Ginger Chicken Pasta Salad | 760 | 50 g | 73 g | 31 g | 4 d | peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat |
| C6 | Honey-Mustard Salmon & Potatoes | 750 | 50 g | 53 g | 39 g | 3 d | fish, milk |

| Plate | Name | kcal | Protein | Carbs | Fat | Fridge | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D-5 | Chimichurri Meatball Quinoa Bowl | 810 | 49 g | 55 g | 45 g | 4 d | egg, milk, wheat |
| A4 | Teriyaki Salmon & Green Bean Quinoa | 750 | 48 g | 52 g | 39 g | 3 d | fish, sesame, soy, wheat |
| M10 | Turkey Taco Rice Bowl with Charred Broccoli | 700 | 48 g | 66 g | 29 g | 4 d | milk |
| C12 | Honey-Mustard Meatballs & Sweet Potato | 720 | 48 g | 68 g | 30 g | 4 d | egg, milk, wheat |
| D-12 | Turkey Meatball Gyro-Style Wrap | 630 | 47 g | 45 g | 30 g | 3 d | egg, milk, wheat |
| D-3 | Chimichurri Salmon Quinoa Bowl | 850 | 47 g | 44 g | 54 g | 3 d | fish |
| M8 | Chipotle Salmon Slaw Bowl | 780 | 47 g | 60 g | 38 g | 3 d | fish, milk, sesame, soy, wheat |
| A9 | Gochujang-Glazed Salmon Rice Bowl | 780 | 47 g | 64 g | 38 g | 3 d | fish, sesame, soy, wheat |
| D-7 | Lemon-Tahini Tofu & Broccoli Bowl | 730 | 47 g | 59 g | 40 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| D-8 | Lemon Chicken, Sweet Potato & Tahini | 680 | 46 g | 58 g | 31 g | 4 d | sesame |
| A1 | Teriyaki Lemon Chicken & Broccoli Rice | 650 | 46 g | 66 g | 23 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| A6 | Gochujang Meatball Rice Bowl | 720 | 46 g | 72 g | 28 g | 4 d | egg, milk, sesame, soy, wheat |
| D-10 | Salmon Tzatziki Rice Bowl | 750 | 46 g | 56 g | 38 g | 3 d | fish, milk |
| M1 | Chipotle Lemon Chicken Fajita Bowl | 640 | 46 g | 63 g | 23 g | 4 d | milk |
| M6 | Chipotle Tofu Fajita Quinoa Bowl | 690 | 45 g | 60 g | 34 g | 4 d | milk, soy, wheat |
| A2 | Peanut-Ginger Tofu Crunch Bowl | 760 | 45 g | 64 g | 41 g | 4 d | peanuts, sesame, soy, wheat |
| D-1 | Greek Lemon Chicken Rice Bowl | 620 | 45 g | 56 g | 24 g | 3 d | milk |

| Plate | Name | kcal | Protein | Carbs | Fat | Fridge | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| M3 | Turkey Taco Sweet Potato Bowl | 690 | 44 g | 64 g | 32 g | 4 d | milk |
| C1 | BBQ Lemon Chicken & Crispy Potatoes | 600 | 43 g | 55 g | 25 g | 4 d | fish |
| A7 | Sticky Gochujang Tofu & Broccoli | 710 | 42 g | 74 g | 32 g | 4 d | sesame, soy, wheat |
| C10 | Creamy Beef & Lentil Pasta | 760 | 40 g | 90 g | 27 g | 3 d | milk, wheat |
| M12 | Chipotle Beef & Lentil Potato Bowl | 660 | 40 g | 74 g | 26 g | 4 d | milk |
| D-6 | Spiced Beef & Lentil Tahini Rice Bowl | 710 | 34 g | 83 g | 28 g | 3 d | sesame |
| M4 | Red Enchilada Beef & Lentil Wrap | 600 | 34 g | 64 g | 25 g | 3 d | wheat |
| C5 | BBQ Beef & Lentil Potato Bowl | 670 | 34 g | 83 g | 25 g | 4 d | fish |
| D-2 | Smoky Chickpea Tahini Bowl | 640 | 22 g | 81 g | 28 g | 3 d | sesame |
| D-9 | Roasted Veg & Chickpea Tzatziki Wrap | 540 | 20 g | 71 g | 21 g | 3 d | milk, wheat |
| M7 | Smoky Chickpea Salsa Verde Wrap | 510 | 17 g | 72 g | 19 g | 3 d | wheat |

— = none of the 9 major US food allergens.

## Plates without…

Use this when you cook for someone who avoids an allergen. It's based on the recipes as written. **Brands differ and products can be made on shared lines:**

**read the label of every package you buy.** No plate contains crustacean shellfish or tree nuts (tree nuts appear only in two snacks, SN1 and SN8).

**Without milk** (27): M2, M4, M5, M7, M9, M11, A1, A2, A3, A4, A5, A7, A8, A9, A11, A12, D-2, D-3, D-6, D-7, D-8, D-11, C1, C2, C5, C8, C11

**Without egg** (42): M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, M6, M7, M8, M9, M10, M11, M12, A1, A2, A3, A4, A5, A7, A8, A9, A11, A12, D-1, D-2, D-3, D-4, D-6, D-7, D-8, D-9, D-10, D-11, C1, C2, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8, C9, C10, C11

**Without wheat** (19): M1, M2, M3, M9, M10, M12, D-1, D-2, D-3, D-6, D-8, D-10, D-11, C1, C2, C4, C5, C6, C11

**Without soy** (32): M1, M2, M3, M4, M7, M9, M10, M11, M12, D-1, D-2, D-3, D-4, D-5, D-6, D-8, D-9, D-10, D-11, D-12, C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8, C9, C10, C11, C12

**Without sesame** (29): M1, M2, M3, M4, M6, M7, M9, M10, M11, M12, D-1, D-3, D-4, D-5, D-9, D-10, D-12, C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8, C9, C10, C11, C12

**Without fish** (37): M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, M6, M7, M9, M10, M11, M12, A1, A2, A3, A5, A6, A7, A8, A10, A11, A12, D-1, D-2, D-4, D-5, D-6, D-7, D-8, D-9, D-11, D-12, C3, C4, C7, C9, C10, C12

**Without peanuts** (44): M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, M6, M7, M8, M9, M10, M11, M12, A1, A3, A4, A6, A7, A9, A10, A11, D-1, D-2, D-3, D-4, D-5, D-6, D-7, D-8, D-9, D-10, D-11, D-12, C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8, C9, C10, C11, C12

**Without any of the 9:** M2 and M9.

**Swaps that open more plates** (each recipe card lists its own): coconut aminos instead of soy sauce in the teriyaki (S4) removes soy and wheat. Sunflower seed butter in the tahini sauce (S8) removes sesame. Dairy-free plain yogurt in S1 removes milk. Macros change with any swap.

## Cost per plate

| Plate | Cost per box |
|---|---|
| M7 | $1.80 |
| D-9 | $2.00 |
| D-2 | $2.10 |
| A2 | $2.45 |
| A8 | $2.55 |
| D-1 | $2.70 |
| M1 | $2.85 |

| Plate | Cost per box |
|---|---|
| M6 | $2.85 |
| A7 | $3.00 |
| D-6 | $3.15 |
| D-4 | $3.20 |
| A3 | $3.20 |
| M5 | $3.25 |
| C1 | $3.25 |
| A1 | $3.25 |
| D-7 | $3.35 |
| M4 | $3.40 |
| C9 | $3.40 |
| C4 | $3.40 |
| M2 | $3.45 |
| C10 | $3.45 |
| C5 | $3.50 |
| C7 | $3.55 |
| C11 | $3.60 |
| M11 | $3.70 |
| C8 | $3.70 |
| A11 | $3.70 |
| D-12 | $3.75 |
| D-8 | $3.80 |

| Plate | Cost per box |
|---|---|
| A6 | $3.80 |
| C3 | $3.85 |
| A10 | $3.85 |
| M9 | $3.95 |
| A5 | $4.00 |
| D-11 | $4.00 |
| M3 | $4.15 |
| A12 | $4.25 |
| M12 | $4.25 |
| D-5 | $4.30 |
| M10 | $4.30 |
| C12 | $4.40 |
| C2 | $4.40 |
| M8 | $5.50 |
| D-10 | $5.60 |
| A4 | $6.10 |
| D-3 | $6.10 |
| A9 | $6.20 |
| C6 | $6.65 |

*US average retail prices, USDA ERS (meat, eggs and dairy: latest month available; fruit and vegetables: 2023 annual averages) plus reference prices for pantry items. Your store*

*will differ.*

**YOUR ACTION**

Pick the 3 plates you'd eat most often from this list. Write their numbers here so you don't have to look them up again.

| Plate | kcal | Protein | Allergens |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

*Sources: USDA FoodData Central SR Legacy (nutrition). FDA, "Food Allergies: What You Need to Know" (9 major food allergens).*

CHAPTER 22

# When Things Go Wrong

> **"If only someone had properly proofread this work and written better instructions."**
>
> — reader review

Something will go wrong on one of your Sundays. The rice will come out crunchy or the tofu will be soft. That's not a reason to stop. Most fixes take 5 minutes, and the next batch comes out better because you know why.

Each problem below has three parts: **why it happens**, **fix it now**, **next time**.

## Proteins

**1 · Chicken is dry or rubbery** (P1, P3)

- *Why:* it went past 165 °F / 74 °C, or the pieces were uneven so the thin ones overcooked.
- *Fix it now:* slice it and toss with a spoon of pan juices or 1 Tbsp water before it goes in the box. Reheat at 70% power, covered.
- *Next time:* pound breasts to an even thickness. Pull it when the thermometer says 165 °F, not when the timer ends.

**2 · Salmon has white goo on top, or smells strong by day 3** (P8)

- *Why:* the white is albumin, pushed out by hot, fast cooking. The smell is age: cooked fish fades fastest.
- *Fix it now:* scrape the white off; it's safe. Past day 3 or if it smells off: throw it out.
- *Next time:* bake at 375 °F and check a few minutes earlier. Eat salmon on days 1-2 only and freeze any extra the same day.

**3 · Meatballs fall apart, or come out dry** (P6)

- *Why:* falling apart = the mix was too wet. Dry = overmixed or overbaked.
- *Fix it now:* warm dry ones in a covered pan with a spoon of sauce.
- *Next time:* 1 more Tbsp breadcrumbs and 10 minutes in the fridge before rolling. Mix with your hands only until it holds.

**4 · Pulled pork won't shred** (P7)

- *Why:* it's safe at 145 °F but only shreds at 195-205 °F, when the tough tissue melts.
- *Fix it now:* re-cover and give it 30-45 more minutes. Check again.
- *Next time:* start it earlier. Week 4 puts it in 4½ hours before the session.

**5 · Tofu is soft, not crispy** (P9)

- *Why:* not pressed enough, too crowded, or reheated in the microwave.
- *Fix it now:* 6-8 minutes at 400 °F / 205 °C in the oven or air fryer.
- *Next time:* press the full 20 minutes, pat it dry, use 2 pans so cubes don't touch.

**6 · Lentils are still hard after 30 minutes** (P5)

- *Why:* old lentils take longer.
- *Fix it now:* add ½ cup water and simmer 10 more minutes.
- *Next time:* buy a fresh bag and check the date. Too wet instead? Simmer uncovered 5 minutes.

## Bases & vegetables

**7 · Rice is crunchy, or gummy** (B1)

- *Why:* crunchy = steam leaked through the foil. Gummy = too much water, or it wasn't rinsed.
- *Fix it now:* crunchy: 2 Tbsp hot water, re-cover tight, 10 more minutes. Gummy: spread on a pan, 5 minutes in the oven to dry.
- *Next time:* crimp the foil hard all round. Rinse 30 seconds.

**8 · Pasta is mushy by Wednesday** (B5)

- *Why:* it was fully cooked on Sunday, then cooked again in the microwave.

- *Fix it now:* reheat it with the sauce, briefly, and eat it. It's safe, just soft.
- *Next time:* drain it 1-2 minutes before the package time and toss with oil.

**9 · Roasted vegetables or sweet potatoes are soggy and pale** (V1-V4, B3, B4)

- *Why:* the pan was crowded, the pieces were wet, or the oven was too cool. Crowded food steams.
- *Fix it now:* drain any liquid. 5 minutes in a hot oven or air fryer before eating.
- *Next time:* dry the vegetables, one layer, pieces not touching. Use a second pan. It's the most common fix in this book.

**10 · Potatoes went soft in the microwave** (B3)

- *Why:* the microwave steams them.
- *Fix it now:* air fryer or oven, 400 °F / 205 °C, 8-10 minutes.
- *Next time:* if you only have a microwave at work, pick sweet potatoes (B4), rice or quinoa for that box.

## Sauces & breakfasts

**11 · A sauce split, went grainy, or set solid** (S1, S5, S7, S8, S12)

- *Why:* yogurt sauces split when heated. Tahini and peanut butter tighten when cold. A cream sauce splits over high heat.
- *Fix it now:* yogurt sauces: never heat them; stir in 1 Tbsp yogurt. Tahini or peanut: whisk in 1 tsp water at a time. Creamy tomato: whisk in 1 Tbsp warm water off the heat.
- *Next time:* keep sauces in their own cups, cold, and add them after reheating.

**12 · Egg bites are wet in the middle, or rubbery** (D1, D2)

- *Why:* wet = underbaked or too much spinach water. Rubbery = overbaked.
- *Fix it now:* wet: back in the oven 3-5 minutes until a knife comes out clean and the center reads 160 °F / 71 °C. Don't eat them underdone.
- *Next time:* squeeze the spinach hard. Start checking at 20 minutes.

## The week itself

### 13 · THURSDAY'S BOX TASTES FLAT

- *Why:* flavors fade in the fridge. It's not spoiled, it's tired.
- *Fix it now:* a squeeze of lime or lemon, a pinch of salt, fresh herbs or scallion, right before eating. The sauce goes on cold or warmed, never stored on the food.
- *Next time:* store sauce, slaw and salad apart (Chapter 4).

### 14 · YOU'RE RUNNING LATE ON THE SUNDAY SHEET

- *Why:* the first run is always slower. Or the oven runs cool.
- *Fix it now:* never skip a done signal to catch up. Skip a cold sauce instead (make it Monday night; it takes 5 minutes) or roll the burritos later.
- *Next time:* read the sheet the night before. Put an oven thermometer in the oven: if the dial says 425 °F and the oven is at 390 °F, every tray runs long.

#### 15 · FRIDAY'S BOX IS STILL FROZEN, OR YOU FORGOT TO MOVE IT

- *Why:* it needed the full day in the fridge.
- *Fix it now:* thaw it in the microwave on defrost, then reheat to 165 °F / 74 °C and eat it right away (FSIS). Never thaw it on the counter.
- *Next time:* set a phone reminder for Thursday morning. The printable fridge card has one too.

## The rule above all of them

If a box smells off, looks slimy, or you're not sure how old it is: **when in doubt, throw it out.** One lost lunch costs less than a sick week. (USDA FSIS)

YOUR ACTION

### Your fix log

When something goes wrong, write it here. After a month, you'll have your own fixes.

| Date | Recipe | What went wrong | What I'll change |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

*Sources: the "Fix it" notes on each recipe card. USDA FSIS: "Safe Minimum Internal Temperature Chart", "Leftovers and Food Safety", "The Big Thaw: Safe Defrosting Methods" (fsis.usda.gov).*

CHAPTER 23

# Blank Templates

> **"The grocery list and meal plan made everything so much easier."**
>
> — reader review

After Week 4, the book has done its job if you can plan a week without it. These templates are the tools for that. They're in the printable pack (PDF, Letter and A4, works in black and white). Print a stack, or fill them on a tablet.

# What's in the printable pack, and when you use each page

| Template | Use it when | What you fill in |
|---|---|---|
| **Blank Sunday Sheet** | Saturday night, planning your own week | Header (week, ×1/×2, oven temps). Timeline rows: clock, station (OVEN / STOVE / COLD / ASSEMBLY), task, done-when, recipe. Assembly table: part, box count, grams per box. Friday box. Real time. |
| **Blank shopping list by aisle** | Before you shop | Meat & fish · Produce · Dairy & eggs · Bakery · Pantry & canned · Condiments · Spice check. Two columns: ×1 and ×2. A "leftover from last week" box at the top so you don't rebuy it. |
| **Build Your Plate** | Trying a combo that isn't one of the 48 | 4 rows (protein, base, vegetable, sauce) × kcal, protein, carbs, fat, allergens, fridge days. A total row. A check: does it pass the Mix & Match rule? |
| **Cost per box** | Once a month, or when prices jump | Item, package price, package size, amount used, cost used. Totals per week and per box. Store and date. |
| **Storage chart** | Every day, on the cupboard door | The 60 recipes from Chapter 20 on 2 pages. |
| **Mix & Match poster** | Planning | The four ✓ tables from Chapter 16 on one page. |
| **Pantry checklist** | Once, then each month | The basics from Chapter 7 with a tick box. |
| **Box labels** | Sunday, while you pack | Mon-Fri "eat by" labels, plate ID, cook date, a ❄ box for frozen ones. |
| **Fridge cards** | On the fridge door | The day-5 rule and Thursday reminder · reheating by part · the 12 sauces at a glance. |

The four filled Sunday Sheets and shopping lists from Weeks 1-4 are in the pack too, one page each, so you can repeat a week you liked without this book open.

All these templates are in the printable pack: *the-sunday-sheet-printables.pdf* (US Letter).

## How to fill a blank Sunday Sheet (5 steps)

1. **Write your parts.** 2 proteins, 2 bases, 2 vegetables, 3 sauces, 1 breakfast. Check them on the Mix & Match chart.
2. **List the oven items by temperature, hottest first.** Each recipe card has a "Sunday-sheet slot" line with its temperature and minutes. Copy it.
3. **Fill the gaps with stove and cold tasks.** Anything marked "Stovetop" or "Cold" goes in the ⏱ rows while the oven runs.
4. **Assembly table.** For each part, count how many boxes use it. Weigh the batch on Sunday and divide.
5. **Friday.** Choose the plate whose hot parts all freeze (storage chart). Write it in the freezer row.

**YOUR ACTION**

- [ ] Print 4 blank Sunday Sheets and 4 blank shopping lists now. That's a month.
- [ ] Put the storage chart and the fridge cards where you'll see them.

---

*The templates contain no new data. Every number you write in them comes from the recipe cards, the storage chart (Chapter 20) and the index (Chapter 21).*